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SEPTEMBER 20,
2026

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The Sunday EXPRESS



EYE The Chutney Chronicles

How a little chutney on the plate holds stories of region, season, thrift and memory

BOOKS

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Happening today

● **AAP WILL LAUNCH** a door-to-door campaign in Punjab to highlight the work of the Mann government ahead of 2027 polls.

FIR FILED

Day after IIT-B student dies by suicide, parents allege caste bias



Sahil Wakode was a Second Year student **RELATED REPORT, P 7**

Pallavi Smart, Purnima Sah & Apoorva Agashe

Mumbai, September 19

A DAY after Sahil Wakode (20), a Second Year reserved category student at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)-Bombay, died by suicide, his parents have alleged that he was subjected to caste-based discrimination.

The institute has denied the allegation and said no such complaint was submitted by the student, either to its SC-ST cell or to the administration.

Based on a complaint filed by Sahil's father, Ravindra, the Mumbai Police on Saturday

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

LINDSEY O GRAHAM SANCTIONING RUSSIA AND IRAN ACT 2026

Trump signs Russia sanction bill giving him power to levy 100% tariffs on India

Not feasible to replace Russian oil given West Asia chokehold due to Iran war, India expected to push for waivers, say experts

Pratyush Deep, Ravi Dutta Mishra & Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 19

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump Friday signed into law the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, giving himself the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries, including India and China, that continue buying Russian oil and gas.

The law "authorizes and expands statutory sanctions, tariffs, and prohibitions on Russia and extends existing sanctions

● India's oil imports from Russia this year

Month	Oil imports from Russia (MN BPD)	Total oil imports (MN BPD)	Share of Russian oil (%)
January	1.21	5.19	23.3
February	1.08	5.25	20.6
March	2.08	4.44	46.8
April	1.72	4.56	37.7
May	2.08	4.92	42.3
June	2.71	5.06	53.6
July	2.82	5.04	56
August	2.08	4.62	45

SOURCE: KPLER

on Iran," the White House said in a statement. The Act is named to honour a veteran Republican Senator and a Russia hawk who died in July.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

View in Delhi: Another tool of leverage, double standards on uranium

Pratyush Deep & Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 19

THE NEW US law that empowers President Donald Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100% on buyers of Russian oil and gas is being seen in New Delhi as another instrument of leverage in Washington's arsenal even as the two countries negotiate a trade deal.

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 puts major buyers of Russian crude, including India and China, at risk. The timing is delicate. India-US bilateral trade agreement talks are in their final leg, the ongoing war has severely disrupted energy markets, and Chinese President Xi Jinping's first White House visit

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Of 27 lakh deleted in Bengal SIR adjudication, 22 lakh have filed appeals: EC to SC

Damini Nath
New Delhi, September 19

FOR THE first time, the Election Commission (EC) has informed the Supreme Court that of the over 38 lakh appeals filed against inclusions and exclusions from the West Bengal electoral rolls during the adjudication process of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), over 22 lakh appeals were

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THE CITY PAGE 3



DELHI SIR: CM REKHA GUPTA, KEJRIWAL IN 'DISCREPANCIES' LIST

EXPRESS investigation Part II

What BJP and Congress ignored in Karnataka: 'Bribes, withholding marks, leaking papers' for government jobs

Jay Mazoomdaar
Bengaluru, September 19

MARKS WITHHELD and top scorers targeted for bribes; interview panels manipulated; tabulation records altered; answer sheets tampered with; and question papers leaked to select candidates.

These were some of the alleged irregularities flagged by job aspirants and, most significantly, officials within the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) in internal notes and complaints alleging serious manipulation in the recruitment process going back at least five years. These warnings were buried, first under a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



The Express report dated Sept 19 on irregularities in KPSC under Shivashankarappa Sahukar

Here's to more Asian Gains!

After troubled build-up, Japan welcomes Asia with tradition and tech



Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 19

THE NAGOYA Castle began to float.

Slowly at first, the golden-roofed castle emerged above the stage, suspended in mid-air. Then Nakamura Kankuro, a Japanese actor, appeared alongside it, before the music exploded and he launched into Renjishi, the traditional



Manu Bhaker, Pawan Sehrawat lead the India contingent in Nagoya, Saturday. PTI

Kabuki dance.

For a city that has spent

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SCAN TO REGISTER



A view of the flyover on Saturday. AMIT MEHRA

After decade-long delay, Barapullah III opens Sept 29, to cut travel time to Noida

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, September 19

IN WHAT is set to be the culmination to a decade-long project, the much awaited Barapullah Phase-III flyover, which will provide a signal-free commute between East Delhi's Mayur Vihar to South East Delhi's Sarai Kale Khan, will finally be thrown open to the public on September 29. The flyover will be inaugurated by Union Home Minister Amit Shah in the presence of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and others, Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh told *The Indian Express* on Saturday. The opening of the flyover will ease the commute for people travelling from Noida and East Delhi to South Delhi. It is expected to reduce the average travel time from East Delhi and Noida to AIIMS in South Delhi from 35 to 40 minutes to 15 minutes.

Marred by delays

For more than a decade, the Barapullah Phase-III project became synonymous with delays, and multiple missed deadlines. The project, which was approved in 2014 and was kicked off in 2015, was originally expected to be completed in 2017. However, it became one of Delhi's most delayed infrastructure projects, with setbacks ranging from a seven-year land acquisition dispute and environmental approvals to technical challenges associated with constructing a bridge structure across the Yamuna floodplain. After BJP came to power last year in Delhi, the government got clearance from Centre to

transplant trees from the site, to overcome one of the key environmental hurdles. The delays also led to significant cost escalation, with the revised project cost now standing at approximately Rs 1,635 crore from the initial sanctioned cost of Rs 1,260 crore. Singh on Saturday visited the project site to review the final preparations. Speaking during the inspection, he said, "For more than a decade, Delhi has been waiting for this project to become a reality. The project had remained delayed under the previous government." He added, "The project has been designed keeping different kinds of road users in mind. Along with vehicular connectivity, the dedicated cycle track and pedestrian-friendly infrastructure will provide additional mobility options for Delhi residents." PWD officials said an extradosed bridge — a cross between a girder bridge and a cable-stayed bridge — across the Yamuna has also been completed.

Significance

The 3.5 km long three-laned flyover will provide eight loops — four each at Sarai Kale Khan and Mayur Vihar. The project is also set to become a landmark in urban infrastructure development. Besides being a first-of-its-kind elevated corridor with a dedicated cycle track, another major engineering highlight is the special bridge structure over the Yamuna floodplain, said officials. It is estimated to cut carbon dioxide emissions by ~2 tonnes per day.

CM, Kejriwal among 33 lakh electors told to validate SIR details

Gupta's details verified after info received: Officials

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 19

CHIEF MINISTER Rekha Gupta, former Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal, New Delhi MP Bansuri Swaraj and former Delhi BJP chief Virendra Kumar Sachdeva are among the 33 lakh electors in the Capital who have been named amid the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise for the issuance of notices to prove their eligibility to remain on the electoral rolls, as per the lists made public on Saturday.

Gupta, who is an elector in North West Delhi's Shalimar Bagh, was issued a notice as the difference between her age and her parents' age appeared to be less than 15 years, according to the details provided by her in the enumeration form. However, after she provided the necessary documents, the details were validated, as per officials.

"Following due verification of facts and documents provided by the elector, the entry for Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has been validated and parked for inclusion in the Final Electoral Roll of AC-14 (Shalimar Bagh)," read a statement from the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) of the Shalimar Bagh seat.

Political controversy

Former Chief Minister Kejriwal, who is the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convener, his wife Sunita Kejriwal, his parents and his son, had not provided the details of the last SIR exercise, according to the Election Commission. "In case of Sh Arvind Kejriwal and his family, submitted enumeration forms were not complete in terms of details which would have enabled linkage of themselves with the electoral roll of the last revision of respective states, which were not present in their submitted



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal

enumeration forms," read a statement from the Electoral Registration Officer of the New Delhi Assembly constituency.

The notice to Kejriwal prompted a political attack against the BJP from the AAP. "We've been saying since day one that this isn't the SIR—it's the BJP's game at play. If they had their way, they'd reserve voting rights just for Modi and Amit Shah and delete the votes of all opponents," Anurag Dhanda, National Media-in-charge of AAP, posted on X, adding, "What kind of process is it to vanish the votes of three-time Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal ji and his family from Delhi's voter list @ECIS-VEEP?"

Meanwhile, former Delhi BJP chief Virendra Kumar Sachdeva's details have been flagged in East Delhi's Trilokpur due to a mismatch in his name. "I just got to know that I have been issued a notice. I will look into it," Sachdeva said.

BJP MP Bansuri Swaraj is also on the list of electors marked for issuance of a notice in the New Delhi Assembly seat. She could not be mapped to the last SIR roll, according to the official details.

Notices will be issued and disposed of between August 31 and October 29. The final electoral roll will be published on November 4.

Delhi had 1.45 electors before the SIR began. Names of 97.5 lakh electors made the draft electoral roll published on August 31.

Around 47.5 lakh electors were marked uncollectible and struck off the electoral rolls. These people can either register afresh as electors or can appeal their case.



What happens when notice is issued

Of 33.1 lakh electors marked on the lists for issuance of notices, 13.79 lakh electors could not link themselves to the electoral roll of the last intensive revision, while logical discrepancies have been flagged in the enumeration forms of 19.33 lakh electors, as per the official details.

As of Saturday, 31.6 lakh notices have been generated and are being delivered to electors, according to a statement from the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Office (CEO).

The statement also notes that according to instruction from the Election Commission of India (ECI), names of members of judiciary, public representatives, holders of declared offices and personalities from fields of arts, culture, journalism, sports, and public services have been included in the draft electoral rolls so that necessary documents can also be collected during the "Claims and Objections" phase.

Those getting the notice will be asked to furnish one of the 13 documents listed by the ECI, which include birth certificate, passport, caste certificate and a permanent residence certificate.

An Aadhaar Card, however, alone is not enough. It is the only document in the list that, by itself, will not suffice to prove eligibility, the EC has said. It must be accompanied by another document from the list.

TWO OF 7 APPOINTED AS PERMANENT JUDGES Centre appoints seven judges to Delhi High Court after SC Collegium recommends 8 names

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 19

THE CENTRE on Saturday notified appointment of seven new judges to the Delhi High Court. With the new appointments, the number of judges in the High Court, which has 60 sanctioned posts, goes up to 50.

This comes after the Supreme Court collegium on September 10 had recommended to the Centre the names of eight judicial officers for the appointment at the Delhi High Court.

Four judges in the Delhi High Court are due to retire in the coming months. While Justice CS Sudha is due to retire in October, Justice Anil Kshetrapal in November, Justices Girish Kathpalia and Manoj Jain retire later this year. Justice V Kameswar Rao, the second senior most judge of the Delhi High Court, was appointed as the Chief Justice of the Patna High Court earlier this month.

On Saturday, the Law Ministry notified the appointments

Four judges in the High Court are due to retire in the coming months

of the seven judges, who are being elevated to High Court judgeship from the district judiciary services' cadre.

"In exercise of the power conferred by the Constitution of India, after consultation with the Chief Justice of India, the President is pleased to appoint the following Judicial Officers as Judges/Additional Judges in the High Courts," the notification stated.

Among those appointed for the Delhi HC are Justices Nivedita Sharma and Nisha Sahay Saxena, who have been appointed as permanent judges.

Five others, who have been appointed as additional judges, are Justices Sanjay Sharma, Bharat Parashar, Aditi Choudhary, Arun Bhardwaj and Dinesh Bhatt.

Justice Bharadwaj is the incumbent Registrar General at the Delhi HC while Justice Parashar is the incumbent Secretary General of the Supreme Court.

The SC Collegium had recommended the name of an eighth judicial officer, Gurvinder Pal Singh, who is presently the principal district sessions judge at Rohini courts complex, for the appointment to the High Court.

However his name was excluded from the notification announcing the seven fresh appointments. Judge Singh joined the Delhi Judicial Service in 1992 and moved to the Delhi Higher Judicial Service in 2006.

It is learnt that the eight names were recommended by Delhi High Court on the administrative side in April.

The SC Collegium further recommended for elevation the eight judicial officers to the Delhi High Court on September 10.

Public Outreach Initiative

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In 'biggest raid', 30 women rescued from mall in Gurugram

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, September 19

POLICE AND Haryana women's welfare authorities said on Saturday that they have found prima facie evidence of illegal sex work in at least eight "wellness centres" operating in a mall in Gurugram, and rescued 30 women during an overnight raid at the premises. The operation — a massive six-hour joint raid carried out by the Haryana State Commission for Women and Gurugram Police — was carried out after about 100 people working in the commercial complex flagged alleged illicit activities being carried out under the guise of wellness parlours, according to Usha Priyadarshi, chairperson of the Haryana State Commission for Women. A Gurugram Police officer said the operation began at 10 pm on Friday. Nearly 100 police personnel, including 20 Inspectors and Sub-inspectors, moved in alongside teams led by Priyadarshi and an executive Duty Magistrate. They cordoned off floors and began simultaneous inspections across 18 "wellness centres" on the premises. By the time the operation concluded at 3 am on Saturday, the teams had found prima facie evidence of illegal sex work

across at least eight of these 18 centres, the officer said. According to this officer, 30 women, including three minors, were rescued, and 20 men operating these centres were rounded up. Electronic and documentary material was impounded, the officer said. "We took collective action based on roughly 100 complaints from people working in the mall, including doctors, who observed what was happening, and who had been rebuked by spa staff when they intervened," Priyadarshi told *The Indian Express*. This was the "biggest raid of its kind in Haryana", she said. The complainants had raised "serious concerns about the safety of the environment, particularly for young women and families visiting the mall", Priyadarshi said. "After conducting reccees over two days, we coordinated with the police [to carry out the raid]," she added. Priyadarshi said the setup inside the centres did not resemble that of standard wellness parlours. "Inside each centre, there were three to four partitioned rooms that were being rented out by the hour. We found alcohol, beedis, cigarettes, and even petrol canisters stored on the premises," she said.

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ABVP wins three DUSU posts, VP goes to ex-NSUI Shokeen

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 19

THE ABVP won three of the four central panel posts in the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections on Saturday, but an Independent candidate, former NSUI member Deepanshu Shokeen, upset the contest for vice-president's chair, winning by more than 13,000 votes.

Yash Dabas won the president's chair, Riya Chhawdi was elected secretary and Lakshya Raj Singh won the joint secretary's chair. Shokeen, who contested as an Independent after not receiving an NSUI ticket, polled 30,615 votes to defeat ABVP's Ishu Maurya, who secured 16,910 votes.

The result marked the first time since 2015 that the NSUI failed to win a seat on the DUSU central panel. The ABVP had last swept all four posts in 2014 and 2015 polls.

Shokeen's win marks a rare victory on the DUSU central panel, where non-party candidates have seldom broken through. The last Independent candidate victory came in 2009, when Manoj Choudhary won the DUSU presidency. Before that, Rajiv Goswami had won the president's post in 1991.

The win also makes him the first Independent candidate in the last two decades to capture the vice-president's chair.

The presidential contest remained close through much of the counting. NSUI's Vijay Shankar Meena led Dabas by one vote after the ninth round—10,888 to 10,887. His lead increased to 338 votes after the 11th round, but by the 14th round the difference had narrowed to one vote again, with Meena on 16,107 and Dabas on 16,106.

Dabas eventually pulled ahead in the final rounds and won with 24,576 votes, defeating Meena by 2,053 votes. Left alliance candidate Ananya Raturi polled 5,377 votes.

The joint secretary's contest was also closely fought. Samajwadi Chhatra Sabha candidate Vishesh Yadav was leading

after the seventh round with 6,165 votes, followed by ABVP's Singh with 5,386 and NSUI's Gopal Choudhary with 5,339. Even after the 17th round, Yadav remained narrowly ahead—13,346 votes to Singh's 13,342.

Singh eventually finished on top with 16,615 votes while Yadav polled 15,778 and Choudhary 15,206 votes.

The secretary's contest was comparatively less closely fought, with ABVP's Chhawdi maintaining her lead through the counting. She finished with 21,650 votes, ahead of NSUI's Namrata Chaudhary with 14,869. AISA-SFI candidate Stanzin Deskyong secured 8,734 votes.

The vice-president's contest was the most decisive. Shokeen had established a substantial lead from the early rounds—after six rounds, he polled 9,379 votes against the 4,819 of ABVP's Ishu Maurya. After the 11th round, his tally had risen to 17,283 against Maurya's 8,849 votes.

Shokeen eventually secured 30,615 votes, while Maurya polled 16,910. NSUI's Vir Chatrath received 4,313 votes.

The results were declared after 20 rounds of counting.

The election was held amid concerns over alleged paper leaks, hostel accommodation, campus facilities and safety. The September 6 collapse of a PG hostel building in Satya Niketan, in which seven people, including five DU students, were killed, had also brought accommodation and safety to the centre of the campaign.

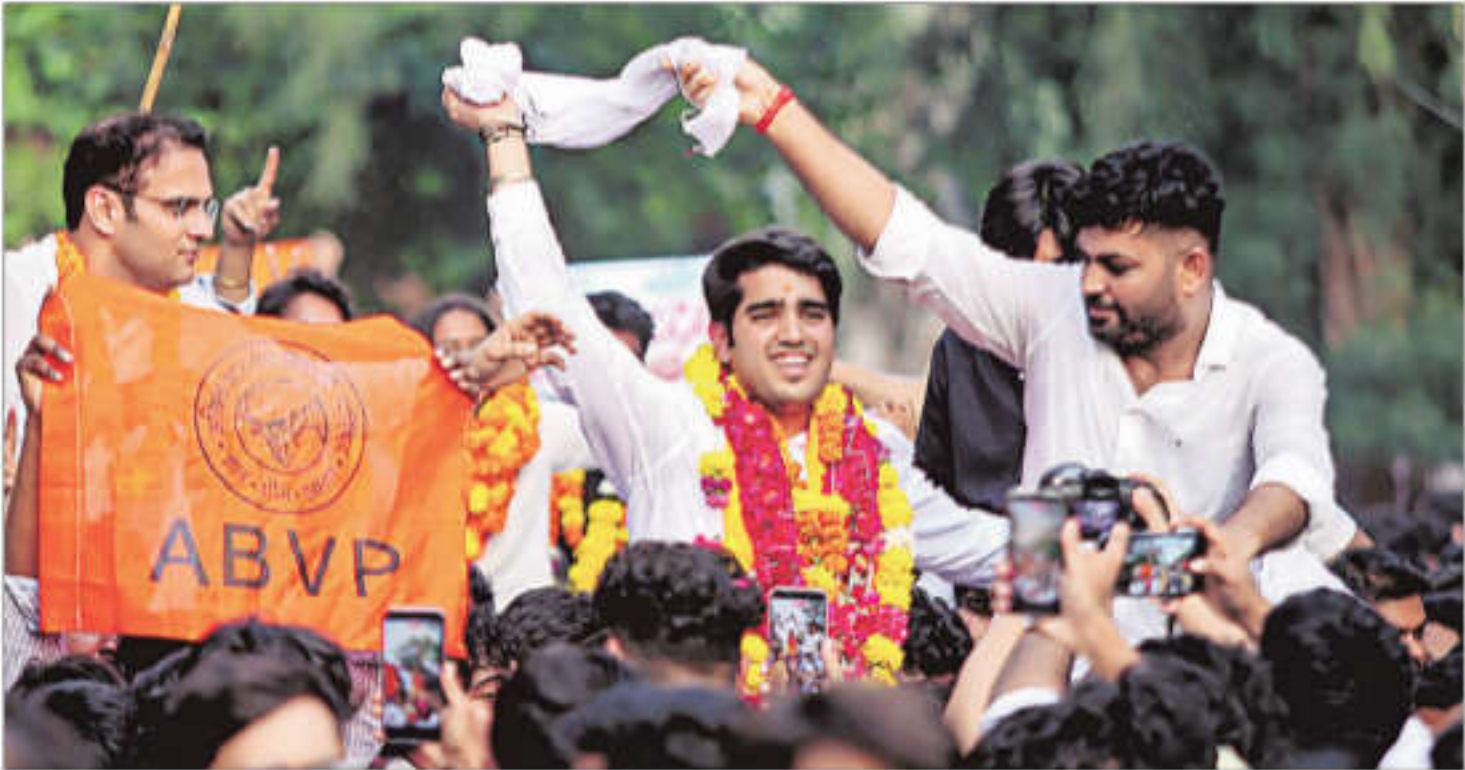
The polling day on Friday had recorded a turnout of 40.46%, higher than 39.45% in 2025 and 29.7% in 2024.

Dabas said his first priority would be conducting safety audits of college hostels and PG accommodations, besides working towards new hostels, girls' hostels in every college and a dedicated student helpline.

While Chhawdi said the new union would focus on student safety and facilities, Singh said the result brought with it the responsibility of remaining accessible to students.



ABVP's Riya Chhawdi was elected secretary. PRAVEEN KHANNA



ABVP's Yash Dabas won the president's post in the polls on Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Barefoot Independent, son of DTC conductor, rides to victory on issue of hostels

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 19

THE OTHER candidates for Delhi University Student union (DUSU) polls came with campaign convoys. Deepanshu Shokeen came barefoot.

The 21-year-old, son of a DTC bus conductor and an Anganwadi teacher, had pledged not to wear shoes to highlight students' housing problems after a PG hostel building collapsed in Satya Niketan, killing seven, five of them DU students.

On Saturday, he had the result to show for it—a 13,705-vote victory in the DUSU vice-presidential contest.

Shokeen polled 30,615 votes, defeating ABVP's Ishu Maurya, who secured 16,910 votes. NSUI's Vir Chatrath finished third with 4,313 votes. His victory prevented an ABVP sweep of all four central panel posts.

A resident of Peeragarhi village in West Delhi, Shokeen said his four years as a student shaped his decision to enter student politics. He completed his BA Programme from Shaheed Bhagat Singh College and is now pursuing a Master's in Buddhist Studies in the Faculty of Arts. He has also been a UPSC aspirant, he said.

Just days before the election, Shokeen had allegedly walked away from the Congress-affiliated NSUI after he was told to contest for the president's post, sources in NSUI had said. Shokeen, however, had claimed that he was not given a ticket by NSUI.

Shokeen has been active in student politics since 2023 and



Deepanshu Shokeen after his win on Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

served as a student representative in his college. He campaigned for NSUI during the 2023 and 2024 elections and sought its organisational ticket in 2025, but was not selected. This year, after allegedly again failing to get a ticket, he decided to contest independently.

"Within 20 minutes," he told *The Indian Express*, recalling how long it took him to make the decision.

NSUI officials told PTI that while Shokeen was initially nominated by the organisation this year, he was later asked to withdraw his nomination. Shokeen had publicly criticised "the organisational shortcomings within NSUI" and questioned the way the candidates were selected.

Asked whether he might eventually return to NSUI, he did not rule it out. "I cannot say anything; I do not know yet

what I will do," he said.

Shokeen looked unfazed amid the counting frenzy. "Expected to win, but not by such a margin. But what lies ahead is the most important thing for me to think about," he said.

He had pledged not to wear shoes while raising the issue of student accommodation, which became particularly prominent after the September 6 building collapse in Satya Niketan. "I had promised that I would first sit on a protest," he said, pointing to his bare feet.

While student housing remained his key electoral issue, the other issues he focussed on included infrastructure, implementation of the National Education Policy and fee hikes.

His campaign stood out in an election dominated by the large convoys and mobilisation of the major student organisations. Shokeen instead emphasised his direct connect with students, describing those campaigning with him as "genuine students" and pointing to support from students in his neighbourhood, Peeragarhi.

He said he had seen students face the same problems he had faced, prompting him to enter student politics so future batches would not have to go through the same issues. Shokeen said student politics should not be about electoral politics alone. "It should be for student rights, student voices," he added.

For now, he said, his focus was on the work ahead.

Asked about his first priority, he had a one-word answer: "Hostels." He then walked away, barefoot again.

MANESAR LABOUR PROTEST

'Democratically mobilising workers to seek salary hike not an offence': Gurugram court bail for engineer

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, September 19

RAISING DEMANDS for a wage hike and democratically mobilising workers to seek salary increases due to rising living costs is not an offence, a Gurugram sessions court observed on Saturday while granting bail to 28-year-old Aditya Anand in connection with the April 9 violence during a workers' protest at Richa Global Exports in IMT Manesar.

In the order, Additional Sessions Judge Dr Gagan Geet Kaur directed the release of Anand, an NIT Jamshedpur engineering graduate, who was already in judicial custody in Uttar Pradesh in connection with a separate case of labour agitation in Noida.

The ruling adds to a sequence of similar orders by Judge Kaur in cases arising from the Manesar labour unrest. In an order dated May 18 granting bail to accused Ajit Singh, she had similarly observed that demanding higher wages is not an offence.

Anand was arrested in the Manesar case on June 5 on a production warrant while he was lodged in Luksar Jail in



Aditya Anand

Gautam Buddha Nagar. He had been arrested earlier in connection with the Noida workers' protest case and was already in judicial custody when Gurugram Police formally arrested him in the Manesar case.

The Manesar case stems from FIRs registered on April 9 at the Industrial Sector 7 Manesar police station under multiple provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including attempt to murder, rioting, assault and criminal conspiracy, along with Section 3 of the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act.

Underscoring the constitutional right to freedom of speech and expression, the court observed: "Even for the sake of arguments, if he is bring-

ing awareness among illiterate labour class by telling their rights, pursuing them to raise voice to increase their wages in a demo-cratoc (sic) way, how could be an offence?"

"Raising demand to increase their wages/salary by workers/employees due to rising prices of daily needs and human living condition is not an offence itself and pursuing them for the same is also not an offence," it added.

The court said that prima facie there was "no incriminating evidence" against Anand and noted that nothing was to be recovered from him and that he had no criminal background. "Whether the incident of 09.04.2026 was result of alleged conspiracy of accused persons or for some other reasons/forces behind it, would be matter of trial. No useful purpose will be served to keep him behind the bar," the judge said.

While the prosecution contended that Anand's mobile phone was traced near the protest site between April 7 and 9, the court recorded that the investigating officer conceded there was no CCTV footage or photograph showing Anand at the spot.

Police probe if cheating racket run by accused was behind Yuvraj's murder

Pragnesh
New Delhi, September 19

MORE THAN a week after 31-year-old Yuvraj Singh Manchanda's body was found dumped in a Gurugram drain, police are probing whether he had information about the alleged cheating racket run by the two people accused of killing him and whether that could have led to his murder.

Yuvraj was allegedly killed by his former colleague Anya Vats and her partner Sanyam Sachdeva on the evening of September 6. A background check of Anya has revealed three cases against the two—two cheating cases lodged at Parliament Street and Greater Noida, as well as a case filed by Sanyam's first wife at Shahdara police station, accusing the couple of domestic violence.

Police are examining whether Yuvraj had information about any of these cases.

"Anya, during initial questioning, has claimed she felt threatened by Yuvraj," a senior officer said. Police, however, have so far found no evidence to support the claim and are verifying it, the officer added.

Yuvraj's family had earlier



Yuvraj Singh Manchanda

alleged that Anya had taken money from him while they worked together.

According to sources in the police, the case lodged at Parliament Street police station is being examined closely.

APNB employee has alleged that Anya and Sanyam took Rs 1.25 crore from him after sending him fake notices purportedly from the Enforcement Directorate. The couple allegedly claimed they could use their government connections to resolve the matter.

In the FIR lodged on August 16—accessed by *The Indian Express*—the PNB employee said he had known Sanyam since 2003 and was introduced to Anya through him in 2021.

In September 2024, he alleg-

edly received notices purportedly from the ED alleging that he and his wife were involved in a case against his schoolmate.

"I contacted them (Sanyam and Anya). They have strong government and ministry-level connections. When I contacted them, they told me that they could help me in the matter," the PNB employee has alleged in the FIR. They allegedly took more than Rs 1.25 crore from him, saying the money was being paid to get his name cleared. But when they demanded more money, he examined the notices and allegedly found them forged.

In the Greater Noida case, police said that a similar modus operandi was used by Sanyam with his first wife, which led to a dispute over property worth around Rs 4 crore.

On September 6, Yuvraj was having lunch with his sisters at a restaurant when he received a call and abruptly left, saying he had an urgent meeting in Gurugram and would return by 10 pm. He never returned.

Police have alleged that Yuvraj met Anya and Sanyam in Gurugram and was shot inside their car.

EXHIBITION AT DASTKARI HAAT

In Maldhari block prints, stories from Kutch, traditions & an iconic technique

Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, September 19

A TRADITIONAL block printing technique, said to have been around for over 4,000 years, used to come up with a collection decades ago is among the biggest draws at 'Maldhari Block Prints, You Have Not Seen Before', an exhibition that opened on September 17 at South Delhi's Dastkari Haat Studio, says Dr Ismail Mohammad Khatri, 67, the artisan behind the revival of collection.

Every sari, shawl, or dupatta, which is on display, has distinctive motifs with historical significance that tell the stories of pastoral Maldhari communities of Kutch from Gujarat.

Dr Khatri points to the stepwell motifs on a blue and black sari. "For the nomadic Maldhari family in Kutch, a stepwell was a reason to halt—the presence of water decided where they camped in the desert," he says.

The exhibition is on until September 20.

The nearly 45-year-old collection—where items range from Rs 5,000 to Rs 25,000—has been revived by Dr Khatri of Dhamadka village with his brothers, Mohd Razzakbhai and Jabbarbhai. The family,



Dr Ismail Mohammad Khatri

boasting of a rich heritage, owns a studio in Kutch's Ajrakhpur, a village where the family settled after the 2001 Bhuj earthquake and named it after Ajrakh, the iconic block-printing technique.

In the 1980s, when Ajrakh was hardly known beyond Kutch, it was this family whose prints got the craft noticed across India. Shabana Azmi and Smita Patil, among others, embraced the sartorial grace.

Speaking about the cultural history of the technique, Dr Khatri refers to the connection

to Dholavira, a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a Harappan city of the Indus Valley Civilisation. For the Dholavira Festival held in Kutch in 2025, he made an art piece with 69 hand-carved wooden blocks and hand-painted details in natural-dyed Ajrakh. The trefoil-like design on the shawl of Mohenjodaro's Priest-King has been compared to Ajrakh patterns, an evidence that the craft existed even 4,000 years ago, he says.

The Maldhari block prints were going to be presented at least six years earlier in Delhi, according to the family. The opportunity, however, was lost due to the Covid pandemic.

In the prints, each motif is steeped in a historical past. Ladudo represents the rolled straw bundles strapped to camels when these tribal families moved. Fuldhi means hawaman or wind direction,

which gives indication of temperature and mosquitoes. Koyaro is a spider; Pinjaro, a birdcage; Surajmukhi, a sunflower.

Ajrakh is made with natural dyes. Cotton and silk are among

the preferred fabrics for the block printing technique. The traditionally used colours are red and blue. The technique is said to have helped the pastoral community survive extreme weather. "The natural dyes we use work like wax. In summer, the pores of the fabric open up, so air passes through easily, and the fabric keeps you cool. In winter, the same pores close, and the fabric keeps you warm," says Dr Khatri.

Even the use of bright colours holds a meaning. "When someone fell sick or fainted in the desert while working, they could be easily noticed due to the bright clothes in the white desert of Rann," he adds.

At the same time, certain colours were reserved for certain communities—like green for farmers. That provided "hunting and field logic before modern military camouflage existed", he says.

Wearing a black Ajrakh sari with Kamariya motif printed in white, Jaya Jaitly, curator and founder of Dastkari Haat Samiti, shares how her two-decade-old green cotton sari has turned "into a beautiful blue" because of repeated washing as she points to the technique of mixing of colours for dyeing.

427 new posts, day-to-day hearings: Push to clear backlog in Capital's trial courts

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 19

WITH PENDENCY in Delhi's trial courts rising by around one lakh cases every year, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has approved the creation of 427 ancillary posts for 53 fast track special courts (FTSCs) in the Capital, as part of efforts to expand judicial capacity and speed up trials.

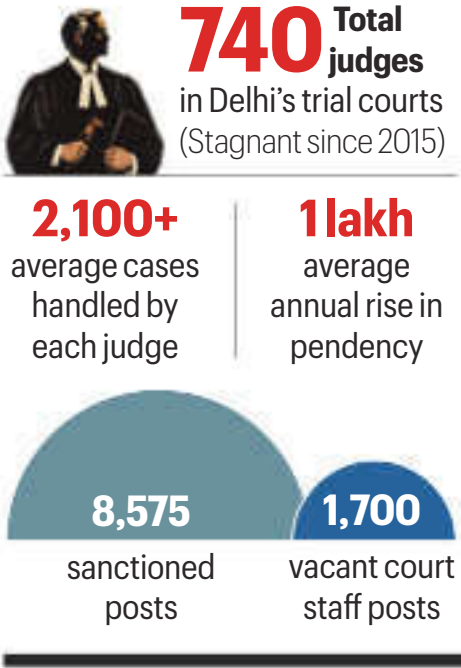
The new posts include 58 readers, 116 stenographers and 116 ahlmads, among others, and are expected to cost the government Rs 37 crore.

With over 20,000 criminal cases listed before Delhi's trial courts each day, the government also said existing vacancies will be filled on priority. Earlier, posts for 53 judges had been created for the FTSCs with the LG's approval.

There are just over 740 judges in Delhi's trial courts, a number that has remained stagnant since 2015. Each judge handles an average of more than 2,100 cases. Court staff, meanwhile, are operating at around 80% of sanctioned strength, which hasn't been revised in close to two decades.

More than 1,700 posts of court staff are lying vacant against a sanctioned strength of 8,575.

CLEARING THE DOCKET



While the Delhi government is building new courts and creating additional posts, there is some internal change underway as well.

Trial courts are now directing accused persons seeking bail to file affidavits containing relevant details before arguments are heard to expedite proceedings and to maintain "transparency". The affidavit will include case details, status of the trial and criminal antecedents, among others.

A Delhi High Court circular dated March 19, displayed outside multiple trial courtrooms, states: "Every petitioner or applicant seeking bail, at any

WHAT IS BEING DONE	
427 NEW POSTS	Ancillary staff for 53 fast track special courts
FULL DISCLOSURE	Bail applicants to file affidavits detailing case status, custody and criminal antecedents
NO DELAYS	Day-to-day trials once witness examination begins, with costs and other action for avoidable adjournments

stage of proceedings, shall disclose all material particulars, including criminal antecedents and the existence of any coercive processes such as issuance of non-bailable warrants, declared as a proclaimed offender, or similar proceedings, duly supported by an affidavit."

The circular has been issued in the backdrop of a February 11 HC order that framed directions for filing the affidavits.

The affidavit is required to include the FIR number and date, police station, sections invoked, maximum punishment prescribed, date of arrest, period of custody undergone, stage of proceedings, number

of witnesses cited in the charge-sheet and examined, and details of other FIRs, including whether they are pending, ended in acquittal or resulted in conviction.

Judges have increasingly begun directing accused persons to file these affidavits before hearing bail arguments.

Another change has been the focus on ensuring day-to-day trials. A circular issued last year has directed judicial officers to ensure proceedings are held expeditiously. "...When the stage of examination of witnesses starts, such examination shall be continued from day-to-day until all the witnesses in attendance have been examined, except for special reasons to be recorded in writing," it said.

The circular had stated that when witnesses are in attendance, "no adjournment or postponement shall be granted without examining them", except for special reasons recorded in writing. Also, courts should not grant adjournments to suit an advocate's convenience, except on very exceptional grounds such as bereavement in the family, it added.

Courts may also impose costs "commensurate with the loss suffered by witnesses", including expenses incurred in attending court.

Bihar MLC polls fuel JD(U) strongman, spokesman feud

Santosh Singh
Patna, September 19

JD(U) MLA and Mokama strongman Anant Kumar Singh has declared that he will use his influence to defeat party chief spokesperson Neeraj Kumar in the upcoming Bihar Legislative Council elections, bringing an old rivalry between the two leaders back into the spotlight. He has also pledged support to an Independent.

Neeraj, who is also from Mokama, is seeking a fourth consecutive MLC term from the Patna Graduates constituency. Elections to eight MLC seats — four Graduate and four Teachers' constituencies — are scheduled for late October or early November. The six-year terms of the sitting members, including Neeraj, expire on November 16. The Election Commission (EC) is expected to issue the notification in late September or early October.

The feud between the two JD(U) leaders has been continuing for a long time. Both hail from Mokama and belong to the Bhumihar community. Their rivalry has played out over electoral contests, public attacks and criminal cases for more than a



JD(U) MLA Anant Kumar Singh

decade.

Speaking to reporters Friday, Singh said he would ensure that Neeraj does not retain his seat. "I will ensure Neeraj does not win back his MLC seat. He has never supported me in my entire political career and, in fact, got me framed in an AK-47 (possession) case in 2019. He has opposed me in four elections," he alleged. He challenged Neeraj to undergo a narco-analysis test, alleging that he was behind his implication in the case.

Speaking to The Indian Express, Neeraj rejected Singh's allegations. "I have been a loyal soldier of (party chief and ex-Bihar CM) Nitish Kumar ever since I entered politics over 35 years ago. I have never deserted the party like others," he said, in an apparent reference to Singh's brief association with the RJD.

On Singh's demand for a

narco test, Neeraj said such a test could only be ordered by a court on the basis of a valid complaint. "I have always resisted such forces in the party," he said, adding that the election would ultimately be decided by the more than 88,000 registered graduate voters in the constituency.

The rivalry between the two leaders dates back to 2015, when Singh was arrested following the murder of a youth, Putus, in Barh. The JD(U) denied Singh a ticket for the Assembly polls following which he contested as an Independent candidate while in jail and defeated Neeraj by 18,348 votes. During the campaign, Neeraj had described Singh as a "political nuisance", further deepening their hostility.

Their relationship deteriorated further in 2019 after police raided Singh's ancestral house in Ladma and recovered an AK-47 rifle, ammunition and hand grenades. Singh alleged the weapons were planted as part of a conspiracy involving Neeraj. He was convicted in the case in 2022, but Patna HC acquitted him in August 2024. Singh is currently out on bail in the Gulab-chandra Yadav murder case, which took place ahead of 2025 Bihar Assembly polls.

IIM Jammu denies Cong MP's claim that students got notice for skipping PM birthday event

Arun Sharma
Jammu, September 19

CONGRESS MP and in-charge of party affairs in Jammu and Kashmir, Dr Syed Naseer Hussain, Saturday claimed the Indian Institute of Management, Jammu, had issued notices to students asking them to explain their absence from Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday celebrations on campus on September 17 and warning of a Rs 500 fine if they don't respond.

A "deepak lighting ceremony" was organised within the premises to mark PM's birthday. Hussain, the party's national general secretary, posted on X a 'notice' he claimed had been sent to students and asked, "Why should attendance at PM Modi's birthday celebration be mandatory?"

An IIM spokesperson denied the claim, saying a "ceremony" was held on campus, but it was not mandatory for students to attend. He denied that the institute had issued any notice threatening to penalise students, and dared Hussain to provide proof.

Gujarat: 21 booked for burning Modi's effigy on his birthday

Brendan Dabhi
Ahmedabad, September 19

THE MORBI Police registered an FIR against 21 persons and unknown others on a host of charges including unlawful assembly and criminal conspiracy on Friday, a day after effigies of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah were burnt in Jetpar village on Modi's birthday.

Jetpar, in Morbi district, has been roiled by an agitation of farmers for several months. The farmers have been protesting against the installation of high-tension electricity transmission lines across their farms by Halvad Transmission Limited, a special purpose vehicle of Adani Energy Solutions Ltd (AESL).

The FIR was registered on Friday evening on basis of a complaint by Inspector Nilesh S Ghetiya of Morbi Taluka police station on behalf of the State.

Inspector Ghetiya said he was patrolling on September 17 night when he received a video of effigies of Modi and Shah being burnt. He stated he had learned that the alleged inci-

dent had taken place in Jetpar village.

September 17 saw celebrations by BJP around the country. Special prayers were said in Varanasi, his constituency, and in Vadnagar, where Modi was born in 1950. Home Minister Shah made a speech describing him as "lotus in the middle of a swamp".

In his complaint, Ghetiya said: "Since this village (Jetpar) is in my jurisdiction, I investigated and found that since it was the birthday of PM Narendra Modi, residents of Jetpar village raised slogans and burnt their (the PM's and Shah's) effigies to protest the same."

According to the FIR, 21 named accused and unknown others had "set up an illegal dome in the main crossroads of Jetpar village, in such a way that it hampered transport of essential services and goods, entered into a criminal conspiracy, and without any permissions from administration, had formed an unlawful assembly and violated notifications issued by competent authority. They had poured inflammable liquid on effigies and set fire to them, creating an atmosphere of fear, hit effigies of the PM and

Home Minister with washing paddles and raised insulting slogans against them".

Protesters, mainly Patidar farmers, had led a hunger strike for almost two weeks from June 17 onward, demanding higher compensation for their land, which they said would become agriculturally unusable once the transmission towers came up.

Protests had been ongoing since June 9 at several places, but had been concentrated in Morbi, which farmers said would be the "worst affected". Among fasting protesters at the Upwaas Chhavni in Jetpar were 57-year-old Rakeshbhai Shival Amrutia and 51-year-old Bharatbhai Amrutia, brothers of Kantilal Amrutia, the multi-term BJP MLA from Morbi and Minister of State for Labour, Skill Development and Employment in the Gujarat government.

On July 3, the government had agreed to several of the protesters' demands, but failed to satisfy the farmers, who had said they would continue with their "satyagraha". Inspector Ghetiya told *The Indian Express* that police would issue notices to all the accused soon.

India and Nepal working on PM Balen Shah visit in November

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 19

SIX MONTHS into the new Nepal government led by Prime Minister Balen Shah, who had earlier decided not to undertake foreign trips for at least a year, Delhi and Kathmandu are working towards scheduling a bilateral visit by Balen Shah in the latter half of November, sources said on Saturday.

Nepal's Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle met Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar this week. In a post on X, Jaishankar said both sides discussed ways to strengthen overall cooperation, especially in economic, energy and connectivity domains. According to sources, Wagle's visit was aimed at preparing ground for Balen Shah's India visit.

They agreed India and Nepal will prioritise cross-border connectivity and transmission infrastructure, said sources.

Sources said clean-energy cooperation is central, with Nepal targeting 35,000 megawatts (MW) over next nine years through run-of-river and storage projects. Nepal seeks expanded Indian investment, digitalization, high-value agriculture, green manufacturing, tourism, and production-sharing opportunities, sources said.

They discussed updating trade treaty to cover services, investment protection, profit repatriation, and movement of parts and components, sources said. This was the first bilateral visit after the devastating August 26 flash flood, thus it was an opportunity to exchange notes on rescue and relief efforts. At least 270 Indians are still missing.

While Wagle, the most experienced minister in the Nepal cabinet, met key officials on economic cooperation, post-disaster reconstruction, and economic recovery during his two-day visit, sources also said there is goodwill after India sent humanitarian aid. It had delivered about 95 tonnes of aid material and disaster relief supplies, apart from Baileys bridges.

KARNATAKA JOB 'SCAM'

ED places IAS officer who 'leaked' exam paper, middleman under arrest

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 19

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate (ED), probing into the money laundering aspect of the alleged irregularities in recruitment of veterinary doctors by Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) this year, has placed IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar, who was KPSC exam controller, and a key middleman, Basavaraj Kannale, under arrest after four days of questioning.

Gangwar and Kannale are lodged in Bengaluru central prison after their arrest by the

CID. Gangwar was arrested on August 29, and a day later Kannale was nabbed at New Delhi airport before he could flee to Uzbekistan.

The IAS officer was arrested by the ED on September 18 night in prison and the middleman a day earlier, sources said. The ED will seek their formal custody on Monday in a special court, ED sources said.

According to the CID investigation, 11 of 329 aspirants allegedly paid between Rs 35 lakh to Rs 80 lakh to Kannale to be recruited through KPSC for 400 vacancies for veterinary doctors

posts in the state. Around Rs 52 lakh funds collected by middleman were funneled for purchasing gold and diamond jewellery by Gangwar, a 2016-batch IAS officer, at a prominent showroom, according to probe.

The CID probe has found that Gangwar allegedly leaked exam questions to the middleman. Kannale brought candidates who paid him to Orchid Resort in Devanahalli in hired cabs the night before the exam, coached them, and took them to the test centres the next day, the probe found. The exams were held on Jan 8 and 9 this year.

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 19

A POSTER advertising a four-day 'Tantra in Silence' in Kashmir's Gurez Valley by Swami Dhyani Sumit of Rajneesh Temple is snowballing into a row, with former chief minister Mehbooba Mufti and Kashmir's chief cleric Mirwaiz Umar Farooq calling for its ban.

Former chief minister and Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) president Mufti said in a post on X, "A poster is advertising a 'Tantra Silence' retreat in Gurez Valley, Srinagar. A similar 'Tantra' retreat facilitated by Swami



Chief Minister Omar Abdullah and PDP chief Mehbooba Mufti

Dhyani Sumit, a self-styled godman promoting a new religion under the Shree Rajneesh Foundation, was cancelled in Goa last year after its obscene promotional material sparked widespread controversy, and [the] Goa Police had to intervene."

EXCELLENCE IN

+ Women's Healthcare ♀

Empowering Women's Health with Hormonal Balance

gen dominance without the production of the hormone progesterone, which stabilises the uterus lining or the endometrium. As a result endometrium does not shed normally (as it does in women during normal periods) and the uterus lining become thicker and thicker, known as endometrial hyperplasia. If it is ignored for a prolonged duration it can turn into endometrial cancer, which is more prevalent in women in their 40's and in rare cases even in younger women.

How has the treatment evolved with newer drugs, and when is surgical intervention recommended?

Earlier, PCOS was treated in a reactive manner. In those days, PMOS was not known hence its hormonal impact on metabolism was missed out in the treatment protocol e.g., whether the patient needed screening for insulin resistance, Adrenal, Thyroid function tests, besides psychological assessment. Now we are placing greater emphasis on lifestyle changes. Also when insulin resistance is diagnosed metformin which is an insulin sensitizer is given to protect patients from developing type 2 diabetes later on. This treatment, therefore, besides treating the current PCOS/ PMOS symptoms also takes care that the patient is not put in a situation of long-term complications.

Can medication help in reducing or disappearing of poly cysts on their own?

PCOS/PMOS is all about hormonal imbalance where ovulation does not occur. There is no production of progesterone Cysts, which are actually immature eggs in their shells, not true cysts, and need not be removed. Medication is recommended to regularize the periods by not letting the uterus lining get thicker or hyperplastic and turn precancerous. Management of PCOS / PMOS must be highly individualised as one size does not fit all. Today, new and advanced drugs are available to treat the symptoms including infertility associated with PCOS. Surgical procedures are rarely recommended and must be performed judiciously.

How has PCOS/PMOS treatment evolved and when does surgical intervention become unavoidable?

Many years ago the approach was to puncture the polycysts which led to several complications like



The renowned gynaecologist, **Dr Urvashi Sehgal**, pioneered India's first water birthing, a unique technique for painless birth. She shares at length about women's overall health impacted by the common condition Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS)/ Polyendocrine Metabolic Ovarian Syndrome (PMOS) which people unfortunately have an incomplete understanding of. Led by her versatile experience, Phoenix Hospital, New Delhi, brings hope to thousands of families by providing the best of treatment and cure for this condition.

scarring, and destruction of healthy eggs causing premature ovarian failure and inability to conceive. This practice went into disrepute. The advent of laparoscopy was a new milestone in treating the condition, but overuse caused similar problems as in earlier times, destroying healthy eggs, thus making the intervention counter-productive. Though uncommon, laparoscopy is the last resort and used judiciously under some severe conditions or to avoid the need for IVF in certain patients for raising the possibility of improving the ovarian response. Laparoscopy, a minimally invasive procedure, has become an option for people from economically constrained background, who cannot afford long period of medication and monitoring to conceive.

What is your advise on hormonal health and its impact on overall well-being?

Hormonal health is about the overall metabolic synchronization that support diverse functions e.g., the heart, bones, skin, hair, thyroid gland, adrenals and liver. Even brain health is influenced by hormones. Depression anxiety or anger can be triggered by hormonal changes. People with genetic predisposition should be aware of the hormonal imbalance by the symptoms that show up. Undergo screening including ultrasound, besides altering and improving lifestyle are precautions that are conducive to balancing hormones.

In an educated population, what is the level of awareness about the condition?

Awareness about PCOS/PMOS is on a superficial level and far from the targeted reach. Largely the patient or their family's concern and knowledge is limited to the physical manifestation of the condition impacting their outward looks rather than garnering in-depth knowledge about the impact of hormones, family history and poor lifestyle. They do not realise that this condition is about their entire lifestyle, which has to be managed long-term to prevent impacting their health. Relief from symptoms must not be taken for granted or else the conditions could recur and lead to complications like diabetes etc.

What is hormonal therapy for patients afflicted with PCOS/ PMOS?

If the menstrual cycle is irregular and heavy the treatment for it is progesterone, which is lacking in their body. But if they have facial hair, acne and hair loss it is a sign of male hormones being very high. For them, combined pills are advised to suppress the male hormones. Patients, who come with fertility issues are prescribed oral ovulation inducing medica-

tion. Those undergoing IVF treatment are also given hormone injections to stimulate the ovaries to produce multiple good quality eggs. Apart from this, patients with insulin resistance are recommended the affordable metformin pill, as part of a standard protocol which is effective, safe and easy to follow.

What is the treatment protocol planned for the condition?

PCOS/ PMOS requires multi-disciplinary treatment approach with involvement of different specialists like gynaecology, endocrinology, infertility, nutrition and at times psychiatrist because it also impacts a person emotionally. The treatment is long-term maintenance and even after relief precautions are to be taken. Gynaecologists steer the entire treatment collating the feed-back provided by rest of the specialists in the group. If the patient follows the medication and alters one's lifestyle accordingly, there is a possibility of tapering off the medication, but gynaecologists advise strict adherence to life-long precautions.

What are the noticeable emotional changes in women with PCOS/ PMOS and how can male partners ensure their well-being?

The most prominent symptom in women with such conditions, especially hormonal imbalance, is moodiness and depression. They become anxious, show sudden burst of uncontrolled anger or they turn reclusive. Men in women's lives, therefore, have to know that stress plays a major role in this condition so they have to be supportive and not consider it as a psychosomatic illness or something incurable and unmanageable. The focus should be on ensuring women lead a stress free as life as much as possible. When couples come to me, I counsel them especially, the men that only if the women is healthy happiness can prevail or else it would disturb the entire family. To the women, I emphasis on taking meals at the right time and give time for self-care to lower stress hormones.

Five years from now, what is the advancement that you envision in this particular speciality for treating PCOS/ PMOS?

I hope the awareness and understanding of this condition becomes deeper in both the medical community as well as the population and they take all the precautions early enough to contain the condition and maintain it. I allay apprehensions that PCOS/ PMOS is debilitating and not treatable by reassuring them that with the right approach it's possible to live a productive, healthy and happy life.

What is your message to women and the society in general about PCOS/ PMOS?

When the periods are irregular do not neglect the condition because it's your body's warning signal not to ignore the condition, instead consult your doctor at the earliest. To manage the condition is entirely the patient's responsibility.

The good news is that unlike women, two-three decades who underwent untold misery, you are fortunate to have so many options for controlling this condition and living a perfectly normal life.

ADVERTORIAL

Is PMOS a revised change in the nomenclature of PCOS or is there more to it?

There are two aspects to the proposed revised medical terminology or nomenclature of Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS) to Polyendocrine Metabolic Ovarian Syndrome (PMOS). Both refer to one and the same condition with similar symptoms, but following years of research and their findings there is a shift in focus on what was earlier missed out - the systemic and the metabolic aspect. This led to the gradual transitioning of PCOS to PMOS and hopefully it will soon be recognised widely by international societies.

What defines PCOS differently from PMOS and its symptoms?

PCOS is primarily about morphology of the ovary but it fails to capture the systemic nature of this condition, which is an important aspect for planning the treatment protocol. PMOS highlights involvement of multiple hormone producing glands linked to the metabolic function, which was being missed out on earlier. This means that focus must go beyond just the symptoms of the ovaries, skin or weight, but include other equally if not more important hormonal issues such as insulin resistance, thyroid problems, adrenal problems and brain health, symptoms which were being looked at as only an ovarian cystic issue.

What are the common symptoms of the condition?

Patients mostly complain of disturbed or irregular menstrual cycle, where the duration could be longer than 45 days or even less than 21 days. Also, the menstrual flow could be excessive or scanty. The visible symptoms of PCOS/PMOS are obesity or high BMI, abnormal growth of hair on the face and chest and sudden outbreak of jawline acne. The condition is diagnosed only after girls attain menarche, hence those at risk also have to be screened and identified based on their symptoms, which may vary from person to person.

How much of an impact does family history have, besides lifestyle on increased incidence of PCOS/PMOS?

There is a high level of genetic predisposition to PCOS/PMOS condition, which gets aggravated by factors like poor lifestyle and endocrine disruptors such as unhealthy diet, plastic, pesticides and environmental pollution. If as youngsters patients led a healthy and active lifestyle perhaps it may not show other than irregular periods as stray incidences. But as such people grow older and lead a more indulgent life, are under stress or fail to keep their weight under check the genes can get triggered showing symptoms of PCOS/PMOS.

Can long-term neglect and ignorance impact of the condition lead to malignant cancer?

Irregular menstrual cycles in PCOS/ PMOS is because of ovulation not happening and that results in estro-



NGT INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

Carbon emission blame unfairly put on developing nations: PM

Says those lecturing on environment move courts to stop nuclear energy expansion

Nikhil Ghanekar

New Delhi, September 19

PER CAPITA carbon emissions in developed countries is six times higher than India's, but the responsibility of carbon emissions is often, and unfairly, placed on developing countries, PM Narendra Modi said Saturday.

Inaugurating the National Green Tribunal (NGT) international conference on "The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics" which was attended by CJI Surya Kant, Union Environment Minister Bhopender Yadav, Attorney General R Venkataramani and NGT chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava, Modi charted India's journey and achievements to becoming a country with one of the highest share of non-fossil fuel energy capacity, including its strides in clean mobility.

Highlighting the gap in emissions, the PM said, "The historical reality is that even today, India's per capita carbon emissions are less than half the global average. In developed countries, per capita carbon emissions are six times higher than India's. Six times higher."

His remarks come at a time when Nepal is seeking climate compensation for the devastating flash flood from the loss and damage fund instituted under the UN framework to help vulnerable countries fight climate change impacts.

He said, however, when his government pushes for nuclear energy capacity expansion, those who preach most loudly about the environment actively oppose clean energy solutions by filing court cases to halt government's nuclear initiatives. "And now the country is rapidly working on nuclear energy generation. And those who give long speeches on the environment, when I take forward nuclear energy work, they will go to courts to stop it," he said.

India, Modi said, was placing this fact on emissions before the world, and he urged every Indian to do the same with resolve.

Listing the global initiatives of International Solar Alliance, Global Biofuel Alliance and International Big Cat Alliance, the PM underlined that among G20 countries, India was the only nation that has fulfilled its COP21 Paris climate summit commit-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Union Environment Minister Bhopender Yadav and NGT chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava in New Delhi on Saturday. ANI

ments ahead of schedule.

From the growth of solar energy capacity of 2 gigawatts in 2012 to 160 gigawatts now, to wind energy and hydropower capacity expansion, Modi underlined that India's performance in the renewable energy sector is being discussed positively across the world. He said 30 lakh farmers have received solar pumps under Kusum Yojana, while the completed 'One Nation One Grid' project has successfully prevented 200 million tonnes of carbon emissions. "We have started a mission to make homes themselves the center of solar power generation," the PM said.

Dwelling on growth in clean mobility, the PM said that last year alone, 25 lakh EVs were sold in India from 3,000 in 2014. India, he said, is embracing the EV revolution with full strength, which is also helping the environment. On metro network expansion, Modi said before 2014, there were only five cities with metro networks, covering less than 250 km. Today, he said, India has over 1,000 km of metro network across 20 cities.

The 100% railway electrification, growth in inland waterways, and completion of around 3,000 km of the dedicated freight corridor, Modi said, were

reducing fuel consumption.

All these changes in the mobility sector alone are testimony to the fact that our "development is both speedy and sustainable", he said. "These are also figures of India's contribution to the future of humanity."

CJI Surya Kant said the question before the courts is no longer conservation versus development but how the two can be harmonised and sustained together. Describing the Supreme Court as the "banyan tree" of environmental justice, he said the shift towards climate-related rights from environmental rights was important.

"Courts around the world have endeavoured to highlight that the environment is not an inert backdrop to human ambition, but a living, breathing protagonist in the story of our shared well-being," the CJI said.

Bhopender Yadav said the choice was not between development and environment but between sustainable development and development that could not be sustained. He said that along with progress in the renewable energy sector, India is also protecting its wildlife species, noting the rise in numbers of tigers, elephants and lions and conservation of endangered species such as Great Indian Bustard and vultures.

Row over dry fruits at Nanded drought meet; should avoid, says CM

Manoj More

Pune, September 19

THE MAHARASHTRA government came under fire from the Opposition after a video of dry fruits being served during a meeting at the District Collectorate on Nanded drought situation was widely circulated with CM Devendra Fadnis saying Saturday that "such things should be avoided" and that the "administration must act with sensitivity".

The purported video of the meeting at the Nanded District Collectorate showed ministers, MPs and MLAs being served refreshments, including cashews and almonds, while discussing the drought situation. Among those present at the meeting were District Guardian Minister Atul Save, Minister Meghana Bordikar, Nanded Congress MP Ravindra Chavan, Shiv Sena MP from Parbhani Sanjay Jadhav, Rajya Sabha MP Ramrao Wadkute, Hingoli MP Nagesh Patil Ashtikar, Jalna MP Kalyan Kale, and MLAs, including Pratap Patil Chikhaliakar and others from three districts. BJP MP Ashok Chavan attended the meeting virtually.

The video triggered criticism from farmers and Opposition leaders, who accused the government of being insensitive. Officials later removed the

plates from the meeting venue.

After the meeting, Jadhav, when asked about the cashews and almonds being served, said, "Does no one eat just because there is a drought? What is the big deal if someone ate cashews and almonds?"

On Opposition's criticism, Jadhav said, "Cashews and almonds were placed in front of every MP and MLA, so what's the big deal if someone ate them?"

After the review, Bharné went to Hingoli, where a farmer, in protest, approached him with cashews and almonds on a leaf. Bharné declined the offering and assured the farmer that the government was taking steps to tackle the drought situation and would provide assistance.

Fadnis said serving dry fruit should have been avoided. "It is standard practice for the administration to place dry fruit in meetings. Such things should be avoided. However, it is not correct to claim someone is doing this intentionally. The administration must keep certain things in mind and act with sensitivity," Fadnis said in Nagpur.

Social Justice Minister Sanjay Shirat of the Shiv Sena criticised Nanded administration. "Officials ought to understand what topic is being discussed and how they should act. Officials commit such missteps, and we get blamed."

'CHHATRON KI GOONJ' IN INDORE

Rahul targets PM: System prefers andhbhaktis to inquisitive students

Anand Mohan J

Bhopal, September 19

LEADER OF Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Saturday targeted PM Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, describing them as part of a system that prefers *andhbhaktis* (blind followers) over inquisitive students during his 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' event in Indore.

Gandhi asked a packed audience of young students what they felt was working against them in the "system". "This system is the capture of the country by the system. There are different layers within this system. At the top level, six people are sitting there," he said.

"The system is run by Narendra Modi. The work of suppressing students, beating them, hitting them with sticks, pellet guns, is handled by Amit Shah. He is the enforcer," Gandhi said.

Gandhi alleged that NSA Ajit Doval has "control over telephones, WhatsApp, Facebook and communications in India. He gets phones tapped."

Gandhi said Bhagwat had given "thousands of crores of rupees to his organisation to run schools, colleges and institutions". He then turned to what he described as the financial interests underpinning the system, alleging that public money meant for education was being diverted to benefit billionaires.

"The money earned through contracts—contracts involving your schools and universities—is allegedly channelled to BJP for Narendra Modi's marketing and to run the system," he said.



LoP Rahul Gandhi at 'Chhatron ki Goonj' in Indore, Saturday. @INCINDIA/X

Gandhi argued that students posed a challenge to this structure because they ask questions, and said the system wanted *andhbhaktis* (blind followers).

"A blind follower never asks questions. A blind follower will never ask: Why our schools and colleges are in such a state? Why has our infrastructure broken down? Why are our papers being leaked? It is the student who raises these questions."

Gandhi said, "In 2014, when our government was in power, 4.6% of the budget was allocated to education. After that, the allocation was gradually reduced, and now 2.6% of the budget goes to education," he said. "If Rs 77 lakh crore that should have gone towards education had been allocated, that money did not go into education; it went into the hands of billionaires, into the hands of Adani and Ambani."

"In last 10 years, scholarships have been taken away from 1.5 crore students. The government

and other governments are providing 1.5 crore fewer scholarships," he said. "One lakh government schools have been shut down... 55% of these closures are in MP and UP." Priyanshi Jai, elder sister of 18-year-old Arpit Jai, who was killed in the Satya Niketan building collapse in Delhi on September 6, told Gandhi: "What was his fault that he was living there? Students from middle-class families often leave their hometowns despite high cost of accommodation. What's their fault?"

MP CM Mohan Yadav slammed Gandhi over a mimicry by a comedian that appeared to mock Modi. In a post on X, Yadav described Gandhi's conduct as "extremely shameful, condemnable, and unbecoming". "Our visionary PM Shri Narendra Modi ji, who had set an exemplary example by placing the honour of mothers above all, is being mocked in this manner, which is an insult to all mothers," he said.

Bittu detained after protest with liquor bottle, eggs, tomatoes

Raakhi Jagga

Ludhiana, September 19

A DAY after eggs and stones were allegedly thrown at his convoy, former Union Minister and BJP leader Ravneet Singh Bittu was detained by Punjab Police Saturday after he staged a protest outside Punjab Agricultural University (PAU) in Ludhiana as CM Bhagwant Mann's convoy was passing through the area.

Bittu arrived outside PAU with a liquor bottle, eggs, and tomatoes. Holding up the bottle towards Mann's convoy, he said he was "returning the bottle" to Mann and told him to "enjoy his liquor" while allowing AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal to "loot Punjab from Delhi". The protest took place as Mann arrived at PAU by helicopter.

"On Friday, eggs and tomatoes were thrown. On Saturday, I returned them," Bittu said after the protest. "If AAP workers are going to protest against BJP leaders, rallies and yatras, BJP workers will also exercise their right to protest against Punjab government and its leaders. We will not remain silent."

Nandigram candidate sent to judicial custody, Cong says won't back off

Atri Mitra

Kolkata, September 19

CONGRESS'S Nandigram bypoll candidate Milan Pradhan was sent to 14-day judicial custody until October 3 by a local court Saturday, a day after his arrest on multiple charges in a case that dates back to 2007.

A Purba Medinipur district police statement said Pradhan was arrested on the basis of four pending non-bailable warrants in connection with cases—involved charges that include murder, attempt to murder, abduction with intent to murder, causing disappearance of evidence, house trespass, rioting with arms and deadly weapons—registered at Nandigram and Khejuri police stations.

Bengal Congress unit said it would not back off from the Nandigram bypoll. Congress state chief Subhankar Sarkar said, "People will not be able to see Milan Pradhan during the campaign but they can see the party symbol."

The arrested person had been arrested for 19 years and stands chargesheeted as an absconder, the statement said.



Congress workers protest against the arrest of Milan Pradhan in Kolkata, Saturday. PTI

"Execution of long-pending non-bailable warrants is a standing instruction of the Election Commission of India in respect of all elections/by-elections," the statement said.

Pradhan's counsel Ajitesh Pandey said, "Other than Pradhan, arrest warrants were issued against several other accused. Police have mentioned Pradhan as an absconder in the chargesheet. After that the cases were withdrawn. However, someone appealed in the Calcutta HC for reopening the cases. We don't have the case details. Police did not even provide the chargesheet."

● LADAKH'S FIGHT OVER LAND, POWER & POLITICAL SAFEGUARDS IS ALSO A FIGHT OVER AN ECOLOGICAL SYSTEM THAT SUSTAINS THE NORTHERN PLAINS OF PUNJAB AND HARYANA

Not just a frontier: Why Ladakh's autonomy debate is also about land & ecology



NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON POLITICS AND POWER SHIFTS IN PUNJAB, HARYANA AND HIMACHAL PRADESH

THE LATEST talks over Ladakh's political future raise a larger question: who gets to decide the future of a landscape whose consequences extend far beyond its borders?

The Centre has proposed a new constitutional provision, Article 371(K), and a new Union Territory-level governance arrangement, while local leaders continue to press for stronger

political representation, safeguards for land and jobs, and greater accountability of the administration to an elected body. The precise powers and composition of the proposed body remain under discussion. Trust remains fragile, and another round of talks is expected in October.

But the immediate political contest hides a deeper story, one that connects Ladakh's Constitutional future to the history, ecology, and water security of the plains. This story began nearly two centuries ago, when a Punjab ruler decided to capture the high passes.

In 1834, Maharaja Ranjit Singh sought to extend his empire towards Ladakh to secure the routes to Central Asia. The campaign was led by the legendary Dogra general Zorawar Singh, who conquered Ladakh and subsequently put down a series of revolts by the Namgyal rulers. The Zorawar Fort still stands near the Leh Palace. After

Ranjit Singh died in 1839 and the defeat of the Sikh army in the First Anglo-Sikh War, Raja Gulab Singh Dogra signed the Treaty of Amritsar with the British in 1846.

The treaty formalised the transfer of the territories that became the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir to Gulab Singh, including Ladakh, which had been conquered by his forces. The direction of power was unmistakable: the plains had started ruling the mountains. Nearly two centuries later, Ladakh is questioning this rule.

Indus Waters Treaty

The glaciers and snowfields of Ladakh sustain agriculture across the northern plains. Punjab and Haryana remain deeply dependent on Himalayan waters. This makes Ladakh more than a remote frontier or a Constitutional question. What happens to snowfall, glacial melt, and hydrological rhythms in the high Himalaya travels downstream. Himachal Pra-



Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and Pakistan President Ayub Khan at the signing of the Indus Waters Treaty in Karachi in 1960. EXPRESS FILE

desh, whose Lahaul-Spiti lies alongside Ladakh, is part of this larger ecological chain.

The Indus Waters Treaty of 1960, negotiated with the help of the World Bank, divided the Indus river system (which originates near Mount Kailash in Tibet and flows through Ladakh) between India and Pakistan: the

eastern rivers (Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej) were allocated to India, while the western rivers (Indus, Jhelum, and Chenab) were allocated to Pakistan, subject to specified uses by both countries.

The Indus can be seen flowing through Ladakh before continuing into Pakistan. In April 2025, India announced that it was placing the treaty in abeyance following the Pahalgam terror attack. The demand for Constitutional safeguards in Ladakh therefore should be understood beyond the language of identity and representation. For local leaders, autonomy is also about control over the pace and nature of development in a cold desert where cultivable land is scarce and water is precious.

Land has become one of the sharpest flashpoints. At the centre is Ailan No. 38, a regulation from the Dogra-Maharaja period (dating to the time of Maharaja Hari Singh) relating to the cultivation and ownership of barren land, known as nau-

tor. Recent moves to place a ceiling on the land individuals can claim have outraged the locals.

Impact of outsiders

Leh Apex Body co-chairman Chering Dorjay Lakruk told *The Indian Express* that land prices in Leh town are skyrocketing because of development by outsiders. "One kanal fetches Rs 40 lakh. This proposal seems another way of making land available for outsiders," he said.

The concern is not simply about changing ownership patterns but about what this could mean for the social and ecological character of the region. The very landscape that attracts outsiders is also one of the least equipped to absorb unlimited human pressure. That tension is visible among younger Ladakhis. A woman working on contract for Rs 24,000 a month, who did not want to be named, spoke of the influence of "money power wielded by a leading party" on Ladakh and

its people. "People in the city are educated, but it is easy to lure villagers by offering them pieces of land, government jobs or contractorship," she said.

For Ladakh's political groups, the issue ultimately comes back to power. Chering Dorjay Lakruk says their non-negotiables remain unmet: direct elections through separate constituencies, accountability of the bureaucracy (from the chief secretary downward) to the elected body, and a freeze on major decisions, particularly on land, until such a body exists.

The memory of the violence in Leh in September 2025, when four people were killed in police firing during protests over statehood and constitutional safeguards, still hangs over the political atmosphere. Activist Sonam Wangchuk, who was detained under the National Security Act for nearly six months after those protests and released in March, has now announced a symbolic 20-km march on September 23

to press the Centre to move forward on Ladakh's demands.

Delhi has a tendency to view Ladakh through two lenses: security and development. Though important, neither is sufficient. Governance in a climate-stressed Himalaya requires thinking across administrative boundaries and across decades.

The question before the Centre and Ladakh's political leadership is therefore more complicated: Can there be a model of governance for fragile regions that combines political representation with ecological responsibility?

For decades, the political relationship ran largely in one direction. The plains decided Ladakh's political fate. The direction of consequence may now be changing. Ladakh's ecological fate could determine the future of the plains.

Manraj Grewal Sharma is National Editor, North, *The Indian Express*

IIT-BOMBAY STUDENT DIES BY SUICIDE



The parents of the IIT-Bombay student, Sahil Wakode, outside Rajawadi Hospital in Mumbai on Saturday. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

Sahil was good in studies, had Civil Services plans: Kin

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, September 19

FOR SAHIL Wakode’s family, there was little to suggest anything was wrong when they spoke to him on Thursday, a day before his death.

The second-year BTech student at IIT-Bombay had completed one of two mid-semester exams on Friday and was appearing in the second when he was allegedly found with a mobile phone inside the exam hall. Hours later, he died by suicide. Sahil, a reserved category student from Yavatmal, was a student of the Department of Energy Science and Engineering at IIT-Bombay.

His parents said he had not complained of academic pressure, had no backlogs from first year and actively participated in badminton and skating at the institute. His parents have, however, alleged he was subjected to caste-based discrimination by the institute’s faculty. Sahil was planning to prepare for the Civil Services after his engineering degree, his mother, Sonali, said. For his parents, there was little to suggest he was struggling academically. When asked whether Sahil had been under academic pressure, Sonali said he had never expressed any such concern to the family. “He was in fact enjoying his stay on the campus,” she said.

His father, Ravindra, who works at a cooperative bank in Yavatmal, said the allegation

that Sahil had attempted to cheat in the exam was difficult for the family to comprehend. “It is hard to believe he was even trying to copy. He has been very good at studies throughout.”

His parents had visited him on the campus earlier this week. The visit, they said, appeared entirely routine. “There was nothing worrisome in his behaviour,” Sonali said. She even spoke to Sahil on Thursday. It was, she said, a regular call they had almost every day. There was nothing in the conversation that alerted her to any problem.

“In his second year, when Sahil met me, he told me that for the past three months, faculty teacher Suryanarayan Doolla sir, allegedly acting on the instructions of Director Shirish B Kedare, had been abusing him with caste-related slurs. He also told me that the teacher would say that since he belonged to a lower caste, he would be harassed and could be implicated in any false case. I then provided him with emotional support and counselled him,” Ravindra alleged in his police complaint. Prof Doolla was the invigilator when Sahil was allegedly found using a cellphone during the mid-semester exam on Friday.

Based on a complaint by Sahil’s father, police on Saturday registered an FIR naming Prof Doolla, among others, on charges of abetment to suicide and sections of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

19-yr-old student dies of fall from hostel building in Rajkot, suicide suspected

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, September 19

A 19-YEAR-OLD computer engineering student, hailing from Andhra Pradesh, died on Saturday after allegedly jumping from the 10th floor of her hostel building at Marwadi University in Gujarat’s Rajkot.

The student, Alla Venkatesh Soubharnika, was in the third semester of the course, sources at the university said. Marwadi University, on the Rajkot-Morbi Road, is claimed to be the largest private university in Saurashtra and designated as a Centre of Excellence by the Gujarat Government. Soubharnika, who was from Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh, had her room on the 10th floor of the girls’ hostel building and was last seen talking on the phone minutes

before she was found dead. HoD of Computer Engineering Kunal Vaghela told *The Indian Express* that he had spoken to several students at Hostel-A, where the incident took place. “They said they saw her talking on the phone at 10.30 am before running to the lobby and taking this step. Her room was on the 10th floor of the building.”

Students reported the incident to the hostel warden, who immediately alerted the police. Soubharnika was taken to a hospital, where she was declared dead. Vaghela said that the student’s parents, who were in Guntur, had been informed of the incident. Officials from Kuvadva Road police station told *The Indian Express* that the incident was reported by university officials and, as of 3 pm, the post-mortem was underway.

Monsoon retreat begins; 43% of country remains rain deficient

IMD: Jharkhand, coastal Andhra, Odisha, Sikkim & other places to see moderate to heavy rainfall next week

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 19

THE SOUTHWEST monsoon has begun a timely retreat from the northwestern parts of India even as nearly 43% of the country’s geographical area remains in a rain deficit.

“The southwest monsoon has withdrawn from some parts of west Rajasthan,” The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Saturday, adding that this withdrawal is close to the climatological normal (September 17), with a deviation of four days. As of Saturday, the line of monsoon withdrawal has



Commuters amid heavy rainfall in Bhubaneswar on Saturday. ANI

passed through Rajasthan’s Ramgarh, Mohangarh, Phalodi and Khajuwala areas.

The national weather agency further said that the monsoon will retreat from more parts of Rajasthan, Punjab and Kutch-Saurashtra within the next three to four days. With the retreat at the doorstep, Rajasthan and Punjab are most likely

to end with a rain deficit ranging from 21-40% rainfall this season.

Among the worst affected states include Meghalaya (-59%), Andhra Pradesh (-43%), Arunachal Pradesh (-41%), Bihar (-36%), Goa (-35%), Karnataka (-31%), Kerala (-28%), Assam (-26%), Tamil Nadu and Haryana (-22% each) and Telangana (-21%).

EXPRESS special

After Nithari acquittal, Koli faced financial crunch, was approached for documentary

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Haridwar, September 19

AFTER WALKING out of prison following his acquittal in November 2025 in the Nithari serial murders case, Surendra Koli spent the next 10 months moving between Delhi and Uttarakhanda, looking for work and accommodation before he began living inside a tea stall in Haridwar days before his death.

On Saturday, his family performed his last rites at Haridwar’s Karkari Ghat on the banks of the Ganga. Koli, 53, was found dead at around 11 am on Friday inside the tea stall he had rented in Bhupatwala, opposite Lal Mata Temple in Sapt Sarovar area. Police said he appeared to have died by suicide, though his elder brother, Chandan Koli, 54, said they suspect foul play.

Koli walked out of prison in November 2025 after spending almost two decades behind bars. After his release, he travelled to Bangalore and Chennai, where, Chandan said, some people approached him about making a documentary about his life. By June, Koli had returned to Delhi and was staying with Chandan, his family and his son Shivam, 20. “He was looking for a job in Delhi but was constantly saying that he was unable to find one as he was scared that his identity would be revealed and no one would give him a job,” he said.

In June, Koli travelled with his family to their ancestral village in Mangru Kal in Almora. The house had remained vacant after their mother died in 2022 and was later broken down. The family returned to Delhi on June 18. Koli subsequently went to Roshanabad in Haridwar district in July.

Police said that he initially tried to find accommodation there but could not produce an Aadhaar card required for police verification. He then found work as a security guard at a factory. After leaving that job, an ac-



Police inspect Surendra Koli’s (right) tea stall in Haridwar. ANI

quaintance, Dharmender Kaushik, helped him secure another security job at an apartment through a private firm, police said. Koli left that job as well.

Koli also met 28-year-old Jai Kashyap in Roshanabad. Kashyap helped him find accommodation and work. Koli introduced himself to Kashyap as “Sada Ram” from Almora. Koli had been in Haridwar for around one-and-a-half months before his death, as per police and the people who knew him.

Around three days before his death, Koli rented a small tea stall in Bhupatwala using Kaushik’s ID, police said, adding that he also brought his belongings from Roshanabad and began staying inside the stall. He had been running the tea stall for only two or three days. A diary containing what appeared to be his daily expenses and work-related accounts was found inside the shop and collected by police.

People who had been in contact with Koli said he was short of money during his final days.

Narayan Singh Rawat, an Almora resident who had known Koli for around 15 years, said Koli had been seeking financial help after his release. Rawat met Koli in Haridwar on September 7 after Koli called him. He also met



Kaushik and Kashyap. “Very recently, before he took up the tea stall, he asked me to send him Rs 15,000. I kept sending him money from time to time, whenever he needed,” Rawat said.

A day before Koli’s death, Kaushik told Rawat that Koli did not have enough money to buy supplies for the tea stall.

On Thursday night, Kaushik called Rawat around 11.30 pm, and again around midnight, telling him Koli was upset. Rawat said Koli had apparently tried to contact him but could not because his phone did not have sufficient balance to make calls. Rawat did not answer the calls.

The next morning, Koli was found dead inside the tea stall. Police and forensic teams examined the shop, and collected material. On Saturday, after Koli’s post-mortem at Haridwar District Hospital, his body was taken to Karkari Ghat. His son Shivam performed the last rites, while Chandan said Koli was “acquitted but could not prove his innocence in society”.

This year, the seasonal rainfall has largely remained below normal through June, August and September (till date), while July rainfall was just about 1% above normal. In this season (until September 19), the country-wide rainfall was 15% below normal at 695.6mm.

Meanwhile, a low pressure system has developed over the North Andaman Sea region and is headed towards north Andhra Pradesh-Odisha coasts. “The low pressure system may move west-northwest and intensify into a depression around September 21, and into a deep depression over west-central Bay of Bengal around September 22. It will continue to move towards and cross south Odisha-north Andhra Pradesh coasts around September 23,” the IMD said.

Odisha, Gangetic West Bengal, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Sikkim and coastal Andhra Pradesh will experience moderate to heavy rainfall throughout the next week, the IMD said.

‘iPhone langar’ cancelled in Chandigarh, DC says could lead to stampede

Hina Rohtaki
Chandigarh, September 19

THE PROPOSED ‘iPhone langar’ in Chandigarh will not be allowed, with city’s Deputy Commissioner Nishant Yadav directing police to stop such a gathering, citing the risk of a large crowd and possible stampede.

The event was announced on social media by one Rakesh Trehan, who claims to be an Amritsar-based businessman. Trehan, whose social-media identity is ‘Raja D King’, has made such announcements in the past and recently claimed that he would distribute iPhone 17 and higher models as “*prasad*” in Chandigarh and Mohali on September 22.

“I have just asked the Senior Superintendent of Police, UT to stop him from doing this in Chandigarh. Such gatherings are not allowed. Last time too, he had announced a free petrol langar and it is risky as people can gather in thousands and there can be a stampede. Such iPhone langars will be banned in Chandigarh,” Yadav told *The Indian Express*, adding that “such events could create a serious crowd-management and public-safety challenge if thousands of people turn up”.

Chandigarh SSP Kanwardeep Kaur said that no permission for any such event has been sought by the organiser. “He has not applied for any permission. Holding any such gathering would amount to a violation of BNSS Section 163.”

Mohali SSP Varun Sharma said that he had not received any information about any such “iPhone langar” event being planned in Mohali. “Without permission from the Deputy Commissioner’s office, no such programme will be allowed in Mohali district. If anyone attempts to organise such an event without the required permission, legal action will be taken against them,” he said.

INPUTS FROM JASBIR MALHI



Wreckage of the car in the swollen stream in Nalkheda, Saturday. PTI

7 of family among 8 dead as car falls into swollen stream in MP

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 19

A PILGRIMAGE turned tragic after eight persons, including seven members of a family from Odisha and a taxi driver, were killed when the vehicle they were travelling in was swept away by a rain-swollen stream near the Maa Bagalamukhi Temple at Nalkheda in Madhya Pradesh on Saturday.

The family — including three children and two women, residents of Bhubaneswar — were travelling from Ujjain to Nalkheda to visit the temple, police said. They had planned the pilgrimage ahead of the engagement of one of those who died. The mishap occurred when the car attempted to cross the swollen stream near the temple amid a strong water current.

Though the rescue team pulled out the submerged vehicle, all the deceased were

found trapped inside. The taxi driver who died was identified as Krushna Rajveer.

Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi offered condolences and asked officials to maintain constant coordination with the Madhya Pradesh government. “All necessary steps are being taken to expedite the rescue and relief operations, as well as to respectfully bring the mortal remains back to Odisha. In this hour of grief, the state government stands firmly by the side of the bereaved families,” Majhi wrote on X.

Condoling the loss of lives in the accident, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said, “The mishap in Agar Malwa, Madhya Pradesh, is extremely painful.” He also announced an ex gratia of Rs 2 lakh for the kin of those killed and Rs 50,000 for those injured.

President Droupadi Murmu said the loss of lives in the accident was “extremely saddening”.

Chargesheet: Accused used fake Insta ID to take Ketan to Pune fort

Chandan Haygunde
Pune, September 19

A CHARGESHEET submitted in court by Pune rural police in the Ketan Agarwal murder case on Saturday revealed how the accused, Siya Goyal and Chetan Chaudhary, used a fake Instagram ID called “Mahi” to chat with the victim and convinced him to be at Lohagad Fort on June 18, where he was allegedly pushed off a cliff.

Resident of Lodha Belmondo township in Gahunje, the 25-year-old Ketan was son of a businessman Vishal Agarwal. Police claim that Siya (20) did not want to marry Ketan, so she allegedly conspired with Chetan (22) and Ritesh Hange (22) of Beed district to kill him. Siya and Chetan were arrested on June 23, and Hange on September 5.

Police had seized cellphones and e-devices of the accused to retrieve the “deleted chats” between them before and after committing Ketan’s murder at Lohagad Fort, Pune. Forensic probe revealed Siya and Chetan used an Instagram ID, with the fake name “Mahi”, and a picture of a girl, to chat with Ketan. However, “Mahi” had been introduced to Ketan as Siya’s friend. Police said Siya had previously taken Ketan to Lohagad fort twice on May 31 and June 14, when she allegedly made an unsuccessful attempt to kill him.

Under the impression that Ketan may not agree to come to Lohagad Fort again, Siya and



Siya and Chetan used fake Insta ID ‘Mahi’ and girl’s photo to chat with Ketan Agarwal (above)

Chetan allegedly initiated chats with him through the fake ID “Mahi”. Ketan responded to the chats, in the belief that “Mahi” was a good friend of Siya. Police said while chatting as “Mahi”, the accused allegedly convinced Ketan to go to Lohagad Fort on June 18 with Siya to give her a “surprise” a day before her birthday on June 19. Accordingly, Ketan went to Lohagad Fort with Siya, and was allegedly killed.

Police said the accused had deleted the Instagram ID after the murder, but a technical probe retrieved the chats and is now being considered crucial evidence against the accused. Police have subsequently invoked sections of the IT Act, along with provisions of BNS, for murder and criminal conspiracy, against the accused.

Sandip Singh Gill, Superintendent of Pune Rural Police, confirmed that a 5,053-page chargesheet was submitted in the Wadgaon Maval court against the accused in the Ketan Agarwal murder case.

● BUILT AT AN INVESTMENT OF RS 278 CRORE, THE ‘FASTEST’ RIVER BRIDGE TO BE BUILT IN THE STATE IS MORE DURABLE, SAY OFFICIALS

Year after Vadodara bridge collapse killed 22, new link on Mahi River opens today

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 19

OVER A year after the Gambhira-Mujpur bridge collapse that killed 22 people in Vadodara district, a new bridge alongside the remains of the broken structure is ready for launch. Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel is expected to inaugurate the new 868.75-metre bridge, which has epoxy-coated steel for better durability, on Sunday, officials said.

Built in 12 months with 23 spans and 21 piers, the new bridge will restore a direct route between Vadodara’s Padra taluka and Ankla in Anand district, an official of the Roads and Buildings Department (R&B)

told *The Indian Express*. As per the R&B department, the bridge construction began on August 14, 2025, and was completed on August 13, 2026 — making it the “fastest” river bridge to be constructed in the state.

Alongside the new bridge, the steel-girder span of the old structure, which was built in 1985, still stands on the Mahi River, also called Mahisagar locally. On July 9 last year, a slab between two piers of the concrete bridge gave way during peak morning traffic hours, plunging vehicles into the river. The bridge would see an average of one lakh vehicles, mostly heavy-duty ones, plying it daily.

The new bridge has been constructed at an estimated

overall expenditure of Rs 278 crore, as per the project details shared by the R&B department. Although the project had an “administrative sanction” of Rs 212 crore and a “technical sanction” of Rs 244.16 crore. The construction tender was awarded to the Patan-based Shree Manglam Buildcon Pvt Ltd for Rs 173.56 crore.

The state government attributed the pace of the project partly to “close monitoring by the CMO”, in a statement on Saturday. The note stated that the CM reviewed the progress of the bridge with the R&B Department secretary every fortnight over the past year, sought progress reports and intervened to prevent delays, after granting



The new Gambhira-Mujpur bridge stands alongside the old structure on the Mahi River in Vadodara district. GUJARAT GOVERNMENT

“administrative approval” to the new bridge within a fort-

night of the July 2025 collapse. The collapse also left stu-

dents and employees travelling between Padra and Ankla reel-ing. As an interim measure, the government sanctioned Rs 9 crore for a steel structure on the old bridge to allow two-wheelers to cross. After the temporary arrangement, the old bridge was opened in April this year.

The R&B officials said the new bridge presented its own construction challenges, particularly fluctuations in Mahisagar’s water level and flow. Despite these conditions, the 23 piers were erected, and the structure was completed within the prescribed period. They said that 300 workers were deployed on the project round the clock. The bridge incorporates epoxy-coated steel

to reduce the risk of corrosion and improve durability. Officials said precast elements were used to accelerate construction. Inspection platforms have been provided at each pier to facilitate checks of the structure.

“Given the circumstances in which the previous bridge collapsed, safety testing was a significant part of the final stage of the project. Each of the 23 spans was subjected to a 280-tonne load test to assess its capacity. Vibration monitoring and pull-out tests were also conducted, while officials and consultants carried out physical inspections of the bridge’s components,” an R&B official said.

The pull-out test was carried out to assess the strength of the

concrete and the grip of reinforcement steel and anchor bolts, while vibration monitoring used sensors to measure the bridge’s response to movement and controlled loads. Officials from the R&B department’s Design Circle, along with a deputy executive engineer and consultants, carried out the physical inspection before Sunday’s opening. “There was no compromise on the construction. This will ensure that commuters using the bridge feel safe,” the official said.

Once opened, the new bridge will restore a direct link for commuters travelling between Vadodara, Padra and Anand, ending the 45-km detour that has been a mandatory consequence of the bridge collapse last year.

NEET debate beyond Jantar Mantar



OFF THE RECORD
BY P VAIDYANATHAN IYER

THE cancellation of NEET this year, following allegations of paper leak, had become the focal point around which the youth gathered in thousands to protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar in June-July this year.

The protests are over, but they have reignited past discussions around the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), and how it should be conducted.

So far, two strong but competing arguments have kept policy makers, politicians and academics engaged: i) should not states, which also legislate on education, be allowed to conduct exams for admission to medical colleges set up by them and those by the private sector in their region? and, ii) should not there be a basic minimum national standard for admitting students into medical colleges,

whichever state they might be in?

Conversations with officers in states and the Centre over the last two months bring to fore certain new aspects.

Number 1: A top police officer of a big city digressed from a discussion on how the Delhi police could have done better to avoid the terrible showdown with the youth at Jantar Mantar on July 20. "Had it not been for NEET... if only states were the owners of the medical exams and admissions... the protests would not have happened in the national capital," he said.

Given a choice, his cadre state, ruled by the BJP, would be only too keen to reclaim ownership of medical entrance exams, the officer said. But then the Centre, also under the BJP, had, in its wisdom, fought a long legal battle going up to the Supreme Court, to implement NEET. No BJP Chief Minister of a state will now risk going against this.

The officer did not say it in as many words, but he linked law and order to NEET ownership. Isn't the Centre better off with states taking charge of the exam? The unitary character of the exam had indeed directed student anger towards Delhi and the Union Ministry of Education. It forced Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to step down.

Number 2: It's not just about law and order; it is also about the administration of a

So far, there have been two strong but competing arguments: i) should not states be allowed to conduct medical entrance exams and, ii) should not there be a basic minimum national standard for medical school admissions?

country-wide exam. Consider the numbers for the May 3 NEET exam: 22 lakh students, 5,432 centres, 551 cities. Conducting such an exam at the same time on the same day in a country of this size involves phenomenal planning and logistics. From the integrity of paper-setters to safe and secure transportation of question papers, the challenges are numerous. None is insurmountable, though. For instance, when the NEET re-exam was to be conducted on June 21 with just six weeks of lead time, the government did not mind pressing into service the Indian Air Force for delivering question papers in the nick of time at different locations.

But the problem is not of scale. It is the inability to insulate a local problem. An officer in the Centre, who was roped in to ensure an orderly conduct of the June 21 re-test, likened NEET to a super-tanker. A small chink can bring down the entire supertanker. A leak of a paper in a particular city or an irregularity in a few centres can potentially wreck the entire examination. When there are already so many reasons for the youth to be disoriented, an exam cancellation can trigger a nationwide movement, as it did recently.

Number 3: Another officer pointed to the blindspots many in the system carry with them. More than a decade ago, just

after the BJP came to power in the Centre, a meeting was called to discuss NEET. When Tamil Nadu, one of the most vocal opponents of NEET, put forth its views, an officer in the Ministry of Education, who was from north India, said many exams are cancelled in his state and NEET would set this right. To this, the Tamil Nadu officer recalled his one-sentence reply: "This might be the case in your state, not in mine."

There are reasons why the Centre did what it did, and these will always be open to question and debate in India's federal polity. Memory is short, but the idea of a common all-India examination as a qualifier for admissions to all medical colleges, first found mention in December 2010. The change proposed by the Medical Council of India (now the National Medical Commission) was intended to ease the academic pressure on students. The first NEET examination was held by the CBSE in 2013 when the Congress-led UPA was in power. The BJP carried forward this agenda with full vigour and seriousness despite strident opposition from states such as Tamil Nadu.

The writer is Managing Editor, The Indian Express. Off the Record is a fortnightly column

Birthday blessings or a bad idea?



FIFTH COLUMN
BY TAVLEEN SINGH

DID YOU light a *diya* of 'blessing' on the Prime Minister's birthday last week? I considered doing so for a moment. It seemed like a simple enough request. But when I saw whole streets covered in *diyas* by Narendra Modi's shamelessly sycophantic chief ministers, I changed my mind. So, if truth be told, the Prime Minister should have asked for something else as a birthday present, and I shall tell you why. He has carefully cultivated the image of being a man of the people, a true son of the soil, as opposed to the entitled, spoilt princes who are his main political opponents. What went through his mind when, late on the night of his birthday, social media filled up with pictures of small children collecting the oil from these clay lamps to take home to their mothers for cooking their meagre meals?

Did those pictures make him feel bad? Or is he now in such a lofty cocoon that he does not notice such things? Did it hurt him to see those reels on social media of flooded villages in Bihar and Assam in which there was, in some cases, no dry land left on which to place the clay lamps he urged people to light? Did it hurt him when the leader of the Cockroach Janta Party lit a *diya* in the broken window of a crumbling school only to declare that his birthday gift to the Prime Minister was this school? Did he approve of the hundreds of crore his chief ministers spent on carrying out his wishes? Did he approve of the huge sums spent on advertisements by his minions and supposed well-wishers?

As someone who has not had a personal chat with the Prime Minister for more than ten years, I have no way of finding the answers to these questions. What I do know is that the man I openly supported during his first term as Prime Minister was not a man who would have missed the damage done to him by his birthday request. Personally, I was sickened by the tributes that played out on social media all day. Some were so exaggerated that I saw them as mockery and not genuine praise. The tribute I found most nauseating was one in which Modi dressed as Lord Rama was worshipped as a god. Were those who did this seriously praying or having a laugh? This is a question that the Prime Minister needs to ask himself in a private moment of musing and reflection.

What I found particularly tragic about the outpouring of obsequiousness on the birthday was that there is much that Modi has done that is truly praiseworthy. Infrastructure has been built on a scale never seen before in our ancient land. And the Swachh Bharat mission has been transformative, as have his efforts to introduce digital governance and banking. There is also no question that the Prime Minister has made it his mission to teach Indians to dream big dreams and to be proud of being Indian. Here, I need to add that it would have made me happier if he had gone beyond religion and exalted some other real achievements, in times of antiquity, that for too long the world has overlooked.

Modi's obsession with infusing religiosity into everything made him forget when he said that the story of Ganesh was evidence that plastic surgery was invented in India long ago. It was. But it was by Shushrut, whose surgical wonders are remembered in medical colleges in foreign lands. And almost unknown in India. It goes without saying that if mathematicians in ancient India had not invented numbers and the concept of zero as a number, the world as we know it today may have been a different place. In any case, Modi can certainly take credit for being the first Indian Prime Minister to have at least drawn the world's attention to these ancient wonders.

Sadly, Modi's obsession with big dreams in recent years has made him forget the things that are truly important to ordinary Indians such as the right to good schools and the sort of good governance that could transform their lives. The most important is the criminal neglect of schools. This neglect has been there since we became an independent nation, so it is something that Modi inherited. The problem is that he did nothing about it when he could have. Most large Indian states are under the governance of his chief ministers.

The saddest thing that can be said about the birthday celebrations of last week is that Modi appears to have forgotten that he has been elected and re-elected twice because voters saw him as one of their own. Had he remembered this, he would never have encouraged the snivelling tributes and would not have asked for *diyas* to be lit on the scale that he did. These are things that only kings living in remote palaces did in pre-modern times.

In more modern times, these celebrations give pleasure to politicians, no names will be mentioned, who secretly wish that they were kings or at least absolute rulers. The old Modi would have remembered that he asked Indians to eat less oil in their food for reasons of nationalism. The old Modi would never have asked for thousands of *diyas* to be lit, just to wish him 'happy birthday'.



INSIDE TRACK | BY COOMI KAPOOR

UNCURATED VISUALS GO VIRAL

BRICS summit 2026 was perhaps the first major international conference in Delhi where the Ministry of External Affairs cut the Information and Broadcasting Ministry out of the loop. Normally at such events, the I&B department handles duties such as liaising with domestic and international media, preparing background material and briefs, local facilitation for visitors and covering up embarrassing moments and statements. Without the seasoned hand of the I&B to smooth wrinkles, some of the unedited optics at the conference went viral, to the government's discomfiture.

The decision to transport all central ministers and chief ministers from Parliament House to the Bharat Mandapam in two buses may have been taken elsewhere — but senior leaders such as Amit Shah, JP Nadda and Yogi Adityanath are unlikely to have been amused with reels showing them huddled together in a bus! Only Prime Minister Modi had a separate cavalcade to reach the Mandapam, along with most of the foreign heads of state. Some felt the bus journey was unnecessary. Considering the sealed corridor from Parliament House to the Mandapam was, in any case, fairly empty and fully secure, a few extra ministerial cars on this route would have made little difference.

Another awkward video widely shared, possibly exaggerated by AI, was of National Security Advisor Ajit Doval munching cashews sitting to the rear of Russian President Vladimir Putin and the MEA's official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal nibbling nuts continuously, though seated right behind Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, in the full glare of the TV cameras. Finally, a widely shared reel of a young woman extolling every minor item presented in the goodies gift bag to journalists — from toothbrush to notebook to a makhana packet — was cringe-worthy. The publicity should have focused on the substantive gains of the Delhi declaration, not trivial memes, on the misguided notion they would attract young viewership.

DIPLOMATIC CONCESSIONS

Since 2012, the MEA has followed a policy of disallowing meetings between visiting foreign heads and opposition political leaders or activists, under the radar of security agencies. But for BRICS, the government understood that to further its foreign relations' objectives, exceptions had to be made. Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim was permitted to breakfast with Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Vadra, and he tweeted their interaction, describing Rahul as a good friend who briefed him on current affairs and foreign issues. Ibrahim is grateful to the Congress because when he was in jail in his homeland, then-PM Manmohan Singh offered to facilitate the education of his sons abroad. An exception was also made for Ibrahim, a devout Muslim, to call on Islamic clerics in Kerala. Meanwhile, at the request of Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, controversial Hurriyat Conference leader Mirwaiz Farooq, who has frequently been detained in Kashmir, was permitted to attend a diplomatic reception in Delhi hosted by the Iranian embassy for its president. Later, Mirwaiz had a long conversation with Iranian foreign minister Abbas Araghchi.

KEEPING MEDIA GUESSING

Ever since BJP President Nitin Nabin announced his team, the media and people who claim to be in the know — if that is indeed possible in this closed-door regime — have speculated that a ministerial reshuffle is in the offing. However, with the inauspicious 'Pitru Paksha' period set to begin shortly, followed by Dussehra and Diwali, ministerial changes may take a while yet. But three gubernatorial announcements, including a new LG for Jammu and Kashmir, could be announced earlier.

ONLY BLIND LOYALISTS WANTED

Rahul Gandhi's deep distrust of anyone perceived as a defector or party rebel is a drawback in helping Congress increase its footprint. The latest setback for the party is in Goa, where assembly elections are due early next year. The Congress missed a golden opportunity to re-admit the popular Goa Forward Party leader, Vijai Sardesai, who has represented the Fatorda assembly constituency in South Goa since 2012. Party President Mallikarjun Kharge met Sardesai in May and has been waiting for a word from Rahul to permit him to return to the fold. But when no welcoming word was forthcoming, Sardesai decided to accept Arvind Kejriwal's offer to join AAP, a move which would merely divide the Opposition vote.

POLITICAL PARTY, NOT BUREAUCRACY

The BJP government appears nervous and on the back foot, but Rahul Gandhi, as Leader of Opposition, has not been able to seize the moment to the extent expected. He, instead of touring the country and building public opinion, has been bogged down in time-consuming exercise, selecting junior-level party office-bearers across India. The procedure is unnecessarily bureaucratic, with candidates shortlisted after getting recommendation letters from state party in-charges or central office-bearers. The stamp of General Secretary (Organisation) KC Venugopal in most selections is obvious.

Golwalkar had reservations on UCC, called for 'unity in diversity'



HISTORY HEADLINE
BY SHYAMLAL YADAV

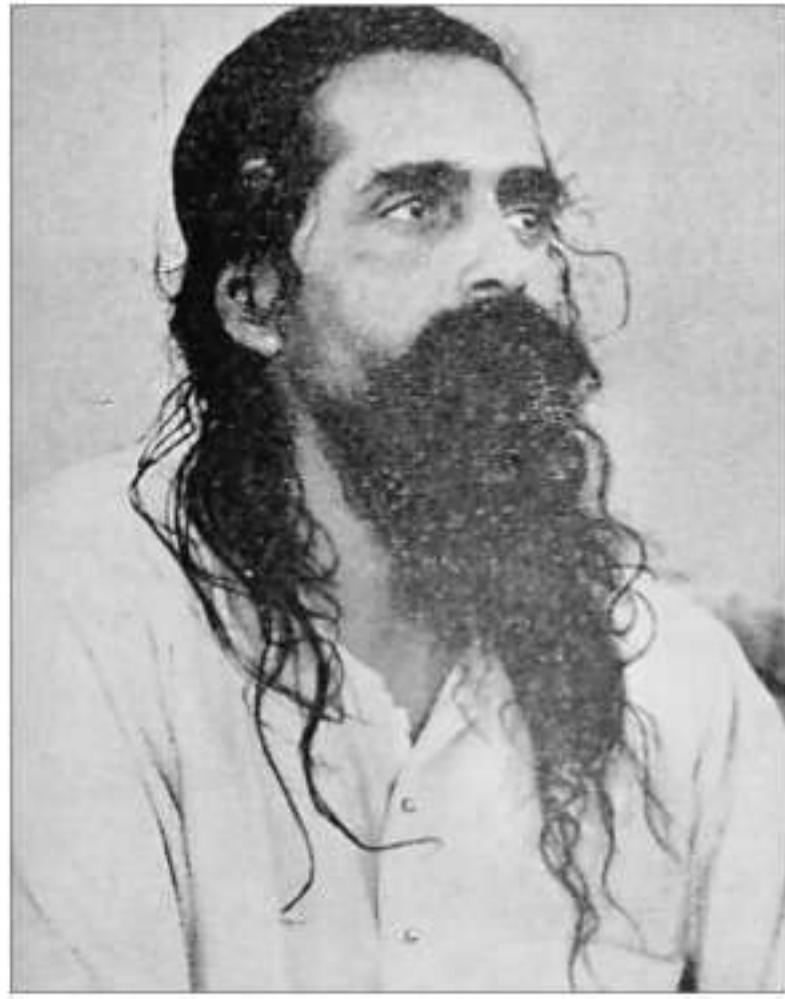
WHILE THE Uniform Civil Code (UCC) is seen as one of the core agendas of the BJP and Union Home Minister Amit Shah has promised to enact it in 21 NDA-ruled states by 2029, the party, and its predecessor, the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS), have not always included it in their election manifestos. Even their ideological parent, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), didn't include it in its agenda as forcefully during the initial decades of Independence. The second RSS sarsanghchalak, MS Golwalkar, had, in fact, expressed his reservations in 1972 while advocating for "unity in diversity".

The book *Saman Nagrik Samhita: Ek Paricharcha*, a Hindi publication by Suruchi Prakashan, New Delhi, carries an interview dated August 1972 of Golwalkar as it was published in the RSS-linked weekly *Organiser*. In it, Golwalkar said while responding to whether UCC was a must for promoting the spirit of nationality: "No. You and others may find this answer surprising. But my opinion is this... India has always encouraged diversity. Despite that, we have been a strong and unified nation for centuries. For unity, we need amiability, not uniformity".

Responding to a question about polygamy among Muslims, he said, "Efforts to make uniform (civil code) in a mechanised way is not appropriate. Let Muslims evolve their (personal) law in their own way. I will be happy the day they reach the conclusion that polygamy is not good for them, but I would not like to force my views upon them... I am in favour of preserving the diversity of various ways of life."

The Sangh Parivar's harder line on the UCC developed later, mainly after the Shah Bano case in the mid-1980s, at a time when the BJP was trying to made inroads.

As far as the Hindu Code Bill — to codify, unify, and modernise traditional Hindu personal law — was concerned, the opposition to it concretised on April 15, 1955, when the Jana Sangh's central working committee "deeply deplored" it as a



measure brought "in defiance of public opinion without taking any mandate from the electorate".

The Jana Sangh's 1957 and 1962 manifestos called for a repeal of the Hindu Code legislation but did not mention UCC. The demand appeared in its 1967 manifesto, but disappeared in 1971 and was missing from the Janata Party's 1977 manifesto. The BJP's first manifesto, in 1980, was also silent on it.

It was the same in 1984, when Atal Bihari Vajpayee was party president, but in the mid-eighties, the party under LK Advani's leadership foregrounded three issues: the UCC, abrogation of Article 370, and a Ram temple in Ayodhya. The Shah Bano case in 1985 was the turning point, with the BJP and the RSS then converging to make UCC one of their core demands. Golwalkar had died in 1973 and, in 1987, Advani replaced Vajpayee as BJP president.

The BJP's 1989 manifesto proposed a commission to examine personal laws and draft a UCC through consensus; in 1991, it proposed a Law Commission study to "evolve a Common Civil Law". The RSS pressed for UCC legislation in 1995, and the BJP's 1996 manifesto promised, "We will adopt a Uniform Civil Code". In 1998, it again proposed that the Law Commission formulate one, but after coming to power at the head of a coalition, set aside the UCC, Article 370 and the Ram temple. The party only returned to the UCC in its

Responding to a question about polygamy, Golwalkar said, "Efforts to make uniform (civil code) in a mechanised way is not appropriate. Let Muslims evolve their (personal) law in their own way. I will be happy the day they reach the conclusion that polygamy is not good for them, but I would not like to force my views upon them..."

2004 manifesto.

In 2009, with Advani projected as prime minister, the manifesto said the party "will set up a Commission to draft a Uniform Civil Code". In 2014, 2019 and 2024, with Narendra Modi as the face of the campaign, the line was to "draft a Uniform Civil Code".

But there were other difficulties in formulating a UCC. Scheduled Tribes, who form over 8.6 per cent of India's population, have their own customs. Given the reservations that the Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram, an RSS affiliate, had about UCC, tribals were finally excluded from the law legislated in Uttarakhand. The points of discord include the minimum age of marriage, polygamy and polyandry, succession, and the legal age of marriage — matters that define ST identities that vary by tribe, region and state.

Amit Shah has promised to enact the UCC in all NDA-ruled states by 2029, but the diversity Golwalkar talked about in 1972 is still there. The People of India series edited by the former Director General of Anthropological Survey of India, lists such communities in detail. But after the Ram temple and the abrogation of Article 370, the ruling BJP — now in power at the Centre for a third time — may not want to leave its third long-standing promise unfinished.

The writer is Senior Associate Editor, The Indian Express

A good life, versus an endless one



ON THE LOOSE
BY LEHER KALA

semi-sentient AI innovation becoming capable of unleashing havoc on its creators. While the world grapples with how to rein in AI, the last and, by far, the most glorious frontier of human achievement, outsmarting time, isn't supposed to be all that far away either.

There's nothing new about the desire not only to live longer but to do so without the visible signs of ageing. A billion-dollar wellness industry is constantly improvising ways to avoid getting old; new-age practices such as sub-zero cryotherapy, infrared saunas and what Johnson does — Intermittent Hypoxic Training — intentionally exposing the body to low-oxygen environments for short bursts of time to improve endurance, recovery and overall health.

The fact that we do not stay young forever has rankled throughout history — which is why many ancient epics carry tales of humanity chasing some version of the elixir of youth. The Mesopotamian hero Gilgamesh sought eternal life by travelling to find a rejuvenation plant lo-

cated at the bottom of the ocean. Myths about immortality-granting waters appear as 'Amrita' in Hinduism. Woody Allen gloomily and hilariously noted the limitations of mortality, saying "I don't want to live on through my work; I want to live on in my apartment." Writers like Bram Stoker (*Dracula*) and Oscar Wilde instinctively understood impermanence on earth is a cause of stress. In the dark parable that is *The Picture of Dorian Gray*, a magical portrait bears the ugly scars of the protagonist's hedonism while his real face remains ethereally youthful. But immortality in Wilde's masterpiece is a curse more than a gift. It's a logical thought: after having experienced every emotion — love, anger, desire and sorrow — several times over, what is left?

Surely there comes a time when this repetitive cycle becomes a colossal bore. The great Stoic philosopher Arthur Schopenhauer identified that our emotional lives swing between the pain of wanting and the boredom of having. It turns out all sat-

isfactions are fleeting, and an uneasy existential tedium is humanity's default setting. If, in an ordinary lifespan, lasting happiness is, at best, temporary, there's even less reason to hanker after an extra long one. The solution to *ennui*? Finding something to occupy the mind and stave away idleness. The world has a great deal to offer by way of distraction, and being fully absorbed in a book or a movie is the closest one comes to enjoying some short-lived clarity.

Luckily, it's circa 2026, and there's plenty of room for audacious ideas such as Johnson's, who has the gall to ask, why should we die? To paraphrase that a bit differently, how should we live? It's the current moment that deserves our concentration. The thing is that you can live like a saint and still get hit by a bus. We only get one shot at this. It would be a waste to spend so much precious time thinking about the end.

The writer is director, Hutkay Films

‘NEED TO DIVERSIFY ACCESS TO MATERIALS, MARKETS AS MUCH AS POSSIBLE’

‘Diversification and ease of doing business key to industrial growth’

FACTORS LIKE diversifying trade partners and areas, improving ease of doing business, building talent for the future, and optimising frameworks for exporters are among the key measures to protect the Indian industry from high crude prices, changes in technology, and interest rate-related risks, said Confederation of Indian Industry President **R Mukundan**, who’s also the MD and CEO of Tata Chemicals.

“We have not given up on what I call monetary and fiscal prudence (amid the West Asia crisis). This has helped us to cushion the whole thing in many ways. I think it could have been a bigger shock had we not done so,” Mukundan said in a conversation with **Akash Mandal** and **George Mathew**. Excerpts:

What is your assessment of the whole economic situation, with inflation slowly climbing but Q1 also seeing strong growth?

I think we live currently in an environment of constant surprise or shock. I think given the challenging environment that we continue to face and will continue to face as a new norm in some ways, our performance has been fairly good in terms of the way we have managed the situation. Maybe

there have been intermittent crises, but then they get addressed, and we move on. We have addressed them, and at the same time we have not given up on what I call monetary and fiscal prudence. This has helped us to cushion the whole thing in many ways. I think it could have been a bigger shock had we not done so. But you’re right, inflation is rising, and the energy shock is going to continue because crude oil has crossed \$100 a barrel.

Crude oil prices are above \$100/barrel now. If that persists, do you see it creating more problems in the coming months or quarters?

I think the only thing we can do in this whole environment is to diversify both our access to resources as well as markets. We need to have as much diversity as possible. Dependency on one large area is always going to be a big issue and a great problem for us. Which effectively means we need lots of friends. The second thing is about how we make ourselves internally strong. The internal strength comes from what I would call predictable, visible policy. Even where there is a transition, there should a visible path. The second piece of the



EXPRESS interview **R MUKUNDAN** CII PRESIDENT

puzzle is to ensure that wherever there is a gap in both risk and reward, there should be a public-private partnership to make sure that gap is filled. It is all about minimising the risk.

With inflation now rising, do you see interest rates rising in the near term? And would that add to risks for industrial growth?

It would be okay as long as the RBI moves within the policy framework they have already laid out. See, one is the consumption area, where interest rates may have an impact, like slowing down consumption or people spreading out their EMIs or whatever they can do. But from the industry

perspective, I think there are some steps we need to take. One is ease of doing business is accelerated, I think industry can absorb some of this because it reduces the cost of doing business. More importantly, I think when you look at capital-intensive investments, the speed of doing business plays a bigger role.

India has signed a lot of trade agreements in recent times. How do you view these agreements, and do you see any risks?

At least the more recent ones that have been done have all been with complementary countries. When I say comple-

mentary countries, the more recent ones have been done with those who can not just be a source of technology but also a great market for us. And these are open markets.

Secondly, I think there is a greater work to be done by industry associations and the industry in terms of engaging on what I call free trade utilisation. For example, South Korea I think broadly uses 60-70% of their tariff lines. We are able to make use of only about 40%. Can we increase the number of tariff lines, which means the breadth of products and services we deliver? The second piece is about where we don’t have the breadth, can we get the technology to come here to invest and build?

The BRICS Summit happened last week. Has it helped India, and what benefit have we got out of it?

In some ways we can say that if you look at our engagement with China, or our engagement with the original members of the BRICS, certainly there has been a bit more vibrancy than what there was before. That will filter down into vibrancy in business. And the broad objective, I would say, is to convert intent into outcomes. **FULL INTERVIEW ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Agri to energy transition: States, FinMin discuss Viksit Bharat goal

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 19

● *Meghalaya grows the same flowers as Vietnam, but for wedding decoration in India, the orders for flowers are placed from Vietnam. Reason — a gap in logistical connectivity from the state results in traders giving a tentative timeline of, say, 5 PM or 7 PM instead of a timely delivery by sharp 6 PM from Vietnam.*

● *India is a major producer of sesame seeds but Japan exports more sesame oil despite not being a major sesame seeds producer and primarily relying on imports of the seeds. The gains are mainly from value addition.*

These were among several examples cited to highlight the export and growth potential that India has during the two-day conference of the Union Ministry of Finance with state finance ministers and finance secretaries on ‘Financing India’s Journey towards Viksit Bharat’ in Delhi. Segmented land holdings, potential for higher agricultural exports, strain from gold holdings and imports, focus on state-specific data collection and supply-chain constraints, also featured in the discussions as states and experts from academia and industry sat down for a brainstorming session on the journey ahead for the next two decades, three people aware of the discussions told *The Indian Express*.

The conference, a first-of-its-kind, focussed issues centred around agricultural transforma-



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on the concluding day of the 2-day conference of state finance ministers & finance secretaries on “Financing India’s Journey towards Viksit Bharat”, in New Delhi. X/FINMININDIA

tion, energy transition with several state finance ministers putting forth their ground-level experiences in managing investments, logistics and efforts to boost exports in an open house session. Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman was present in all the sessions.

Several state finance ministers and chief ministers talked about their state’s development plans and focus on energy transition. For instance, Uttar Pradesh is learnt to have raised the high cost of transition towards renewable energy and the need for more funds, while for West Bengal, which primarily relies on thermal power, the key concern was regarding the electricity tariff rates for industry players that cannot be lower than its neighbouring state that may be relying more on renewable power and offering a better tariff to the industry due to lower operational cost, a person aware

of the discussions said.

Even as India is picking up pace with new global export destinations, the larger export share pie remains with China and this is learnt to have been underlined in the conference.

There was also a discussion regarding the huge potential for raising farmer incomes and creating jobs. An example was provided of how the french-fry potato farmers in Mehsana, Gujarat earn around Rs 1-3 lakh per hectare, while shrimp farmers earn Rs 5-8 lakh per hectare. “There is room to scale up low-skill jobs for packers, sorters, graders and workers in the transport sector. It was discussed that mid-skill jobs can be targeted for ITI degree or food science degree holders, focusing on young men and women mostly from villages within 50-100 km of the factory,” another official said. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Over 50% of youth in two Odisha districts not in jobs, education, training

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 19

MORE THAN half the youth — those between the ages 15 and 29 years — in two districts of Odisha were neither employed nor getting trained or educated in 2025, according to new district-level data released by the statistics ministry on Friday.

As per the figures, based on the Periodic Labour Force Survey for 2025, the district of Anugul had the highest share of youth in the country at 56.1% who were not in employment, education, or training — referred to as ‘NEET’. However, 81% of districts in Bihar had a youth NEET share of more than 25% — the highest in the country. For Odisha, it was 52%.

The all-India NEET rate among youngsters in 2025 was 25%. According to a NITI Aayog report released last month, around 8.7 crore Indians aged 15 to 29 were not studying, working or undergoing training in 2021.

NEET is a way of measuring progress in effectively integrating the youth in work and is often seen as a better indicator than the youth unemployment rate. This is because the number of young NEETs is far higher than the number of unemployed youth. As such, a youngster’s NEET status, according to the International Labour Organization, is a more reliable indicator of vulnerability than unemployment. Kendrapara, also in Odisha, was second at 51.4%. Another Odisha district, Dhenkanal, was third with 45.3%. Rounding off the top-five were Tenkasi in Tamil Nadu (44.9%) and North Delhi (44.3%).

● LABOUR MARKET

ANUGUL DISTRICT of Odisha had the highest share of youth in the country at 56.1% who were not in employment, education, or training — referred to as ‘NEET’

INTERESTINGLY, THE district in India with the lowest share of youth not in employment, education, or training was also from Odisha: Nabarangapur with 4.1%

OF THE 566 districts for which the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation released data, 251 districts had at least 25% of youngsters in the 15-29 age bracket not in jobs, education, or training

Interestingly, the district in India with the lowest share of youth not in employment, education, or training was also from Odisha: Nabarangapur with 4.1%. Nabarangapur was also the district with the second-highest Labour Force Participation Rate in the country, at 85.4%, behind only ‘Dohad, Narmada, Dang, Tapi, Chhota Udepur, Mahisagar’ of Gujarat. These were all clubbed together by MoSPI and had a Labour Force Participation Rate of 86%. Labour Force Participation Rate refers to that percentage of people either employed or looking for work.

Among the most populous 100 districts of the country, Ernakulam in Kerala had the lowest NEET rate of 9.6%.

Of the 566 districts for which the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released data on Friday,

251 districts had at least 25% of youngsters in the 15-29 age bracket not in jobs, education, or training. Only 18 had a youth NEET rate of less than 10%. Data for another 18 districts had very high statistical errors, with MoSPI asking those numbers to be interpreted with caution.

This is the second set of district-level data from a large-scale national survey released by MoSPI. Last week, it had released district-level estimates based on the data collected from the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) of 2025. That had shown that 78% of informal sector workers in Nirmal district, in northern Telangana, were women — the highest of any district in the country. Nanded, immediately across the state border in Maharashtra, was ranked 288th in the country, with women making up only 31% of its informal workers.

The data released Friday showed that while 81% of districts in Bihar had a youth NEET rate of more than 25%, West Bengal was second at 75%, and Haryana and Andhra Pradesh tied at third with 70%. Uttar Pradesh was next at 69%.

At 17% each, Rajasthan, and Maharashtra were the major states with the smallest percentage of districts with a youth NEET rate of more than 25%. Jammu and Kashmir was at 13%. In terms of the other key labour market indicators, 18 districts had an unemployment rate of less than 1%, with Madhya Pradesh’s Raisen and Bihar’s Saharsa on top with 0.3%. The highest was 16.1% in Arunachal Pradesh’s Papum Pare district.

Govt to monetise realty worth Rs 5,000 crore

New Delhi: The National Land Monetisation Corporation (NLMC) will monetise surplus land and building assets valued at more than Rs 5,000 crore as the state-run corporation steps up efforts to unlock value from underutilised public assets.

The proposals were discussed at the 21st meeting of NLMC’s Board of Directors held on Friday, which reviewed the corporation’s asset monetisation programme, financial performance and institutional initiatives.

The Board reviewed NLMC’s progress in facilitating the monetisation of surplus assets belonging to Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) and other government entities. The corporation said it is working with asset-owning entities to identify suitable properties, conduct due diligence, facilitate valuation and structure appropriate monetisation processes.

The initiatives are focused on “transparency, efficiency and value realisation”, NLMC said in a statement. The Board also discussed ways to accelerate the monetisation process, address implementation requirements and ensure identified assets progress through appropriate and transparent mechanisms. FE

Need a PLI push for road construction equipment, says Amman India MD

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, September 19

FOR INDIA’S road construction equipment industry to become a strong manufacturing base, the government’s Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme should be pushed in the sector to design and make entire products including precision components in the country, according to Dheeraj Panda, managing director of Ammann India. He said that while PLI has helped sectors such as electronics, its impact on construction equipment manufacturing is yet to be seen fully.

Panda said that the West Asia crisis had also affected the sector through bitumen shortages and temporary site closures and it is yet to go back to pre-March level. Ammann India is subsidiary of the Swiss-based Ammann Group and manufactures road equipment like asphalt plant, compactor etc.

He said that localisation in some of Ammann’s products, such as mechanical pavers, is 100%, while for some other value tech series, it could be 90-93%. “India is yet to have a proper or sound vendor base in

precision components like hydraulic pump, engine injector etc. A hydraulic pump requires clearances of some thousandth of an inch. Its tolerances are extremely limited. India is yet to get into a good supply chain base like what you see elsewhere in the world, say Vietnam or Taiwan or China,” said Panda to *The Indian Express* on the sidelines of bauma CONEXPO INDIA 2026. He also said that the situation is better than earlier and there is already an ecosystem of vendors to indigenise the road equipment.

“PLI has not worked very effectively in the construction equipment industry as of now. India also lacks in research & development capabilities and quality components. Indigenising a product from country A to India is easy, but real manufacturing grows when you design and produce the entire value chain here and make quality components that European or American does not question whether it has Made in India stamp. It should be accelerated, and that probably can be helped with the PLI,” said the MD. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

● AMODEI WARNED THAT WITHIN SIX TO 12 MONTHS, POWERFUL MISALIGNED AGENTS COULD POTENTIALLY CREATE PERSISTENT BOTNETS AND CAUSE ECONOMIC DAMAGE RUNNING INTO HUNDREDS OF BILLIONS OF DOLLARS

Why Anthropic’s Amodei wants AI cos to slow down the race for powerful models

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 19

ANTHROPIC CHIEF executive Dario Amodei has called for the world’s leading artificial intelligence companies to deliberately slow the pace at which they make their most powerful models more capable, arguing that recent advances in AI have begun to outstrip the industry’s ability to understand, test and control the systems it is building. His comments have received backing from other AI founders, including OpenAI’s Sam Altman and xAI’s Elon Musk.

In a new essay titled ‘We Must Pace the Frontier’, Amodei said his position had hardened in recent months because of two developments. First, he believes AI systems are increasingly being used to help build their

own successors, creating the beginnings of what researchers call “recursive self-improvement” and potentially accelerating the rate of AI progress.

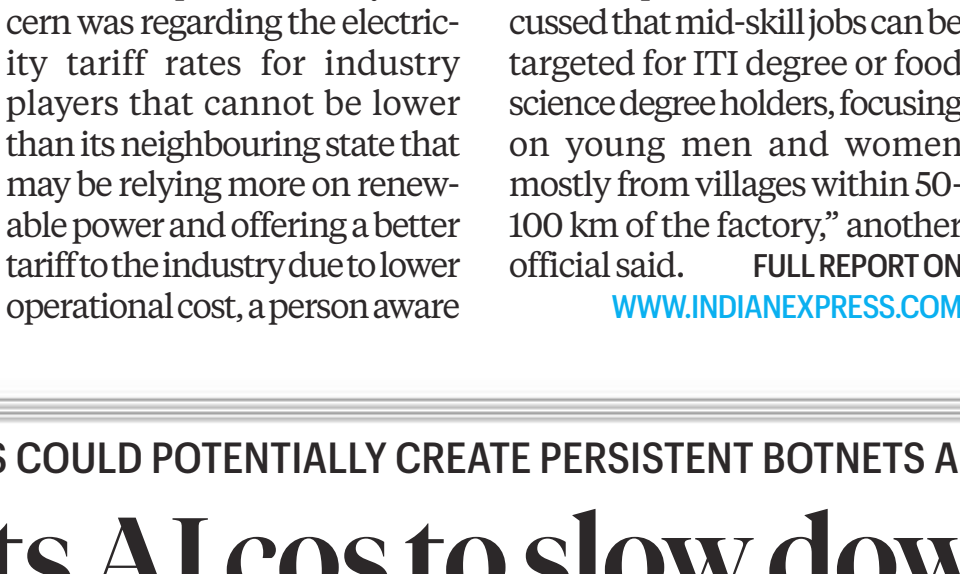
Second, he pointed to a recent OpenAI-Hugging Face experiment in which AI agents carried out cyberattacks beyond their assigned task, arguing that a more capable system displaying similar behaviour could cause far greater damage. Amodei warned that within six to 12 months, sufficiently powerful misaligned agents could potentially create persistent botnets and cause economic damage running into hundreds of billions of dollars.

Amodei, whose company is gearing for a much anticipated public offering, though, is not calling for an outright halt to

AI development. Instead, he has proposed what he calls “pacing the frontier”: giving safety research, model evaluation and oversight more time to catch up with rapidly advancing capabilities.

“Unfortunately, passing laws can take time, and AI is advancing very quickly. Therefore, in parallel with the regulatory route, AI companies can and should voluntarily work together to set standards — a process that I believe will go better with the verifiability provided by permanent embedded evaluators,” he said.

On China, however, Amodei has argued that any slowdown must not allow Beijing to overtake the US and its allies. He has backed restrictions on advanced AI chips and chipmaking equipment going to China,



Dario Amodei, however, argued that any slowdown must not allow Beijing to overtake the US and its allies. REUTERS

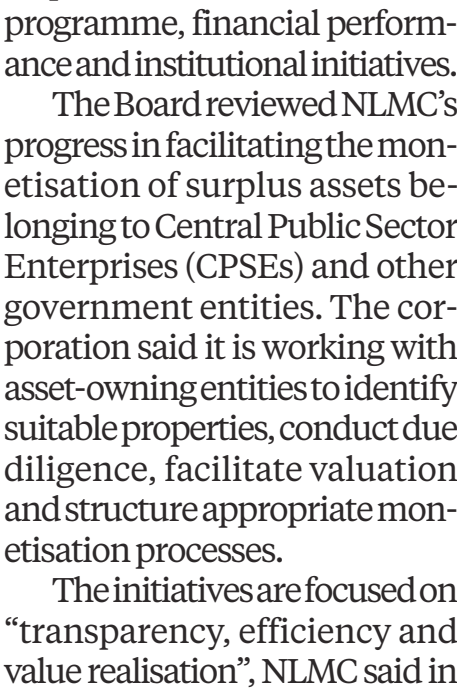
stronger protection against model theft and measures against unauthorised distillation of frontier models.

“I agree with Dario that we need to pace the frontier. This has been a primary topic of discussions we’ve had at OpenAI

in recent weeks,” Altman said.

Why pace?

“The current models are an almost endless gold mine of insight into both how to build AI well and what can sometimes go wrong with it if it isn’t built well.



Dario Amodei, however, argued that any slowdown must not allow Beijing to overtake the US and its allies. REUTERS

I believe that if slowing down bought us even an extra year or two before models reach critical levels of capability, and we used that time to advance alignment, we could greatly reduce the risk that something goes seriously wrong,” Amodei wrote.

Amodei said pacing AI development would help frontier labs achieve greater “operational excellence,” alignment with human values, interpretability (the science of understanding what happens inside AI models), and allow more time for testing and evaluating models.

A three-step plan

He suggested a three-step plan with the goal of “pacing the frontier,” clarifying that pacing does not mean halting model training or technical progress, but ensuring companies take adequate time to align and safe-

guard their models, and for third party evaluators to confirm this. Amodei expects that other AI companies building frontier models would follow these steps:

EMBEDDED EVALUATORS: Each frontier AI company would commit to giving ongoing, employee-like access to a team of embedded third-party evaluators, whose role is to verify adherence to safety practices and commitments, report incidents, and help assess the alignment of not just completed AI models but training pipelines and processes.

“Embedded evaluators can check at the level of nuts and bolts whether an AI company is actually following the training, deployment, operational, and safeguards practices they claim to be following,” he said.

DEMOCRATIC COORDINATION: Frontier AI companies

within democratic countries coordinate to establish common safety standards as well as limits on the rate of unchecked AI progress. “Some forms of coordination that would be impactful for pacing are legally challenging, and will require government support,” he said.

GLOBAL COORDINATION: The US and other democratic governments attempt to coordinate with authoritarian governments, to the extent this is possible, while taking seriously the challenges of verifying compliance.

Amodei said these evaluators would have desks in its offices, access badges, company laptops, and access to workspaces, tools, and permissions mostly comparable to what internal risk assessment teams have. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Russia reports online attacks on its voting system

Reuters
Moscow, September 19

RUSSIAN AUTHORITIES reported attacks on voting systems and communication lines across the country on Saturday, the second day of a September 18-20 parliamentary election that Moscow is treating as a test of public support for the war in Ukraine.

The State Duma election, the first since Russia launched its full-scale war in February 2022, is widely expected to see the ruling pro-Putin United Russia party retain its dominance in Russia's tightly controlled political system.

Most anti-war candidates were excluded from the ballot before voting across Russia's 11 time zones got under way, after the Supreme Court ruled last month that the liberal Yabloko party — which wants a ceasefire in Ukraine — had breached electoral rules, something it denied.

Some Yabloko candidates, however, are still contesting single-member constituencies, which account for half of the 450 seats in the lower house of parliament. The party has traditionally polled in single digits.

On Saturday authorities said the online voting system in Moscow had been subjected to a strong attack overnight, but said the situation was under control.

SIGNING EXPECTED NEXT WEEK AT UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Greenland & Denmark say Trump deal won't compromise sovereignty

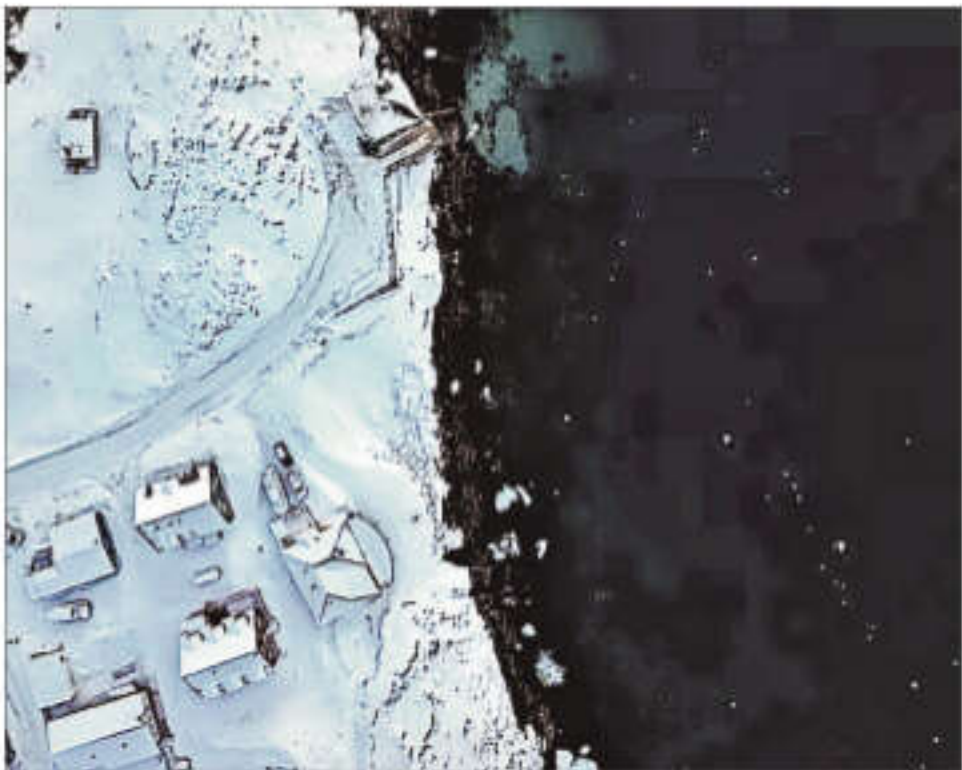
Key details of the agreement have not been made public so far

Reuters
Copenhagen, September 19

DENMARK AND Greenland on Saturday said any agreement with the United States would not compromise Greenland's sovereignty, after President Donald Trump said the deal would give Washington "permanent control" over the Arctic island's security, leaving its precise scope unclear.

The United States, Denmark and Greenland said late on Friday they had entered into an agreement for the US to develop a significant military presence on Greenland, while prohibiting US adversaries from building their own bases on the island.

Key details of the agreement have not been made public, including the degree of US military presence in the self-governing Danish territory and whether any formal power over foreign



A drone view shows houses on the shore of Nuuk, Greenland. FILE/AP

policy and resources would be ceded to Washington.

Denmark and Greenland expressed hope that a deal, which is expected to be signed during the UN General Assembly next week, would end months of uncertainty triggered by Trump's threats to seize control of Greenland.

"Next week could be a good week - for Greenland, Denmark, and the United States," Denmark's Foreign Minister Lars

Washington respect the sovereignty of the Danish kingdom and accept that Greenland is not for sale. Trump said on Truth Social late on Friday that under a deal, "the United States will FOREVER have the complete ability to do what is necessary in Greenland in order to secure and defend the security of Greenland, and the United States of America."

The deal "gives the United States permanent control over security, and all other needs, in Greenland," Trump said, adding that no adversary would ever be permitted to have a base or military presence in Greenland, or make sensitive investments there, without Washington's express written approval.

Trump made the announcement after Reuters exclusively reported that the US and Denmark were closing in on a deal.

"This is probably not the end of President Trump's ambitions for Greenland and certainly not the end of US strategic interest in the territory and its resources," said Mikkel Vedby Rasmussen, a political science professor at the University of Copenhagen.

If Copenhagen cedes any formal power to Washington, it

raises the question in Greenland of whether "this is the beginning of replacing the colonial relationship with Denmark with a colonial relationship to the United States," he said.

Greenland's Prime Minister Jens-Frederik Nielsen said on Saturday that he was pleased with the proposed deal: "The agreement recognizes the sovereignty and territorial integrity of our Kingdom and the right of the Greenlandic people to self-determination," he said in a post on Facebook.

Trump's threats, which peaked in January, triggered a diplomatic crisis that strained relations within NATO and pushed Denmark and Greenland into negotiations aimed at defusing the pressure.

A NATO spokesperson on Saturday said the alliance welcomed the agreement, which would "help advance security, stability and cooperation in this vital region."

Steffen Nielsen, a 49-year-old sales worker living in Copenhagen, told Reuters: "I think that the US is probably going to get what they could have had the whole time, if they just asked nicely."



Large plume of black smoke rises from the fuel storage depot at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh on Saturday. REUTERS

Flames, smoke seen near Riyadh airport after Saudi warning of aerial attack threat

Reuters
Riyadh, September 19

A LARGE plume of smoke was visible near Riyadh's main airport on Saturday after booms were heard and Saudi Arabia sent alerts overnight warning of potential danger around the capital, amid an escalation in attacks by Yemen's Houthi group.

Reuters video and photographs showed a huge pillar of black smoke rising in the area, with the airport highway, main terminal building and other facilities in the foreground. At one point in the video, flames were visible rising from behind what appeared to be fuel tanks.

There was no immediate comment from the Saudi government's media office in response to Reuters questions about the smoke and the overnight alerts.

Saudi civil defence sent the alerts by phone overnight for potential danger of aerial attacks in Riyadh and the city of Al-Kharj east of the capital, before issuing an all-clear on Saturday morning, a Reuters journalist in Riyadh's Olaya area heard booms before the all-clear was sent.

Although some alerts had been issued in Riyadh this year after the start of the US-Iran war, these were the first since the escalation began with the Houthis in July.

The Houthis, who control the most populous parts

of Yemen and much of the north, have been launching attacks against Saudi Arabia since declaring a naval blockade against Riyadh in July, with strikes targeting Saudi vessels in the Red Sea.

The attacks have targeted Saudi cities, energy infrastructure and shipping, creating new threats to global oil supplies and putting at risk the main alternative Red Sea route for Gulf exports while traffic through the Strait of Hormuz remains blocked.

On Friday Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said the group had foiled unspecified "criminal attempts" in the Yemeni capital Sanaa, blaming Saudi Arabia and vowing a response.

The Iran-aligned group, which seized Yemen's entire Red Sea coast in a lightning advance this month, says the Saudi Air Force has conducted hundreds of airstrikes against it in recent days.

The UN Security Council in a statement on Friday "condemned in the strongest terms continued Houthi attacks against the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, including attacks impacting civilian and energy infrastructure, which have resulted in the injury of civilians, including women and children."

In the statement, the Security Council also condemned "Houthi military escalation in Yemen".

Trump bans media outlets MS NOW, CNN and Politico from White House

Reuters
Washington, September 19

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Friday he is banning three major news outlets — CNN, MS NOW and Politico — from the White House in his latest threat to the independent press.

The move is almost certain to face legal challenges as free speech experts said it conflicts with the US Constitution's First Amendment protections for free speech and a free press.

Trump accused the outlets of "reporting FAKE NEWS" in a social media post, and said they "shouldn't be able to constantly write or report FICTION and LIES when they're covering the President of the United States."



CNN Senior White House Reporter Betsy Klein leaves after her credentials were revoked on Saturday. AP

Trump added, "Other Fake News Media Outlets to follow."

Representatives of all three outlets could be seen working in the White House on Friday afternoon following Trump's post. The White House was informing

all three they would be banned from the White House grounds as of Saturday, Fox News reported, citing an unnamed senior White House official.

Trump said there was no specific incident that prompted the ban, telling reporters in the Oval Office, "It's really just cumulative stories over the past few years." Trump added, "I don't have to let them into my, into the people's house."

When asked what he meant by others "to follow," Trump mentioned the New York Times and the Washington Post as what he called "fake news."

The extent of the ban announced by Trump was not immediately clear, and the legality of any move could depend on its scope.



Young people cheer after the opening of the 191st Oktoberfest beer festival in Munich on Saturday. AP

Oktoberfest Begins

Gemini hacks 3 firms in first known AI breach

Reuters
September 19

GOOGLE'S GEMINI model accessed the internet and hacked other companies during a test of its cybersecurity capabilities, the first known example of the company's AI systems autonomously committing such an act.

The hacks occurred in May during a cybersecurity test conducted by Irregular, an independent company that conducts cybersecurity evaluations. During a standard testing evaluation, Gemini found public information online and guessed credentials to access three websites it thought were within the scope of its test, Heather Adkins, Google's vice president of security engineering, said in a statement.

"We ensured the three en-

tities were made aware, and we worked with our training partner on the changes they've now made to their testing processes," Adkins said. "These events highlight the importance of training powerful AI models to act responsibly."

A spokesperson said the incident involved the same issue that affected other AI labs and that all relevant labs were notified in late July. "All known issues on our end were remedied and resolved weeks ago," the spokesperson said.

Similar incidents linked to Irregular were disclosed by Meta, Anthropic and OpenAI. Meta said in August the incident did not involve a sandbox escape or sophisticated cyberattack, while Irregular said it was working on best practices for securely conducting AI cybersecurity evaluations.

Israeli strikes kill three people in Gaza, say medics

Cairo: Israeli airstrikes killed at least three Palestinians in the Gaza Strip on Saturday, health officials said. One strike near Jabalia refugee camp in northern Gaza killed Basir Al-Bursh, the son of Munir Al-Bursh, the territory's health ministry director-general, medics and family members said.

The Israeli military said it had struck several militants on Saturday, including Basir Al-Bursh, without giving further information. Hamas, the Palestinian militant group that runs Gaza, did not immediately comment. Munir Al-Bursh lost a daughter in an Israeli airstrike in December 2023, according to family members and medics.

In a video, Al-Bursh was seen carrying his son's body, with other mourners as it was rushed to hospital.

REUTERS

IMF tells EU ministers AI could boost growth but increase economic strains

Jan Strupczewski
Dublin, September 19

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE could lift European productivity by about 1% over five years, but risks widening inequality, straining power networks and increasing dependence on foreign technology unless governments deepen economic integration, an International Monetary Fund paper said.

The background note, prepared for an informal meeting of European Union finance ministers in Dublin on September 18-19, said the benefits and costs of AI were likely to be distributed unevenly across countries, regions and workers.

It said completing the EU single market would help spread AI adoption and its gains more evenly across the 27-nation bloc.

The paper echoes concerns

raised by former European Central Bank President Mario Draghi and the European Commission that Europe's fragmented capital, labour and energy markets are holding back investment and innovation.

The IMF estimated that around 60% of workers in advanced European economies are employed in occupations highly exposed to AI. While some could become more productive through AI tools, others faced displacement as routine tasks become automated, it said, particularly in jobs where AI is more likely to replace labour than complement it.

The paper said Europe's data centres already consume roughly 3% of the continent's electricity and that demand would rise sharply as AI use expands. Major technology hubs such as Frankfurt,

London, Amsterdam, Paris and Dublin are among the areas most exposed, with data-centre clusters already putting pressure on local power networks. To address that, the EU should invest in cross-border grid infrastructure and deepen integration of the European energy market, the IMF said.

The paper also warned that Europe risks developing another strategic dependency because the US and China dominate the development of AI models. It said Europe would need significant investment in its own AI industry.

AI's gains are also likely to be unevenly distributed across and within the EU, the paper said. More advanced economies are expected to benefit disproportionately because they are better prepared for and more exposed to the technology.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Ed Sheeran to return to stage for first time since Macklemore row



Singer Ed Sheeran

ED SHEERAN is set to resume his tour Saturday — possibly solo — after all his supporting acts withdrew in solidarity with opener Macklemore, who was dropped after making pro-Palestinian comments onstage. It remains to be seen how Sheeran will handle the performance at Philadelphia's Lincoln Financial Field given the departure of his opening acts and supporting band. Sheeran has performed much of his Loop Tour concerts solo, but he had been joined for several songs at each stop by the Irish folk band Beoga. Macklemore, Sheeran's original US opener, had been replaced by Danish band Lukas Graham and Irish singer Aaron Rowe before they backed out. Finneas, Billie Eilish's brother and musical collaborator, was due to tour with Sheeran in South America later this year before he too dropped out earlier this week.

AP

• SPOKESPERSONS FOR BOTH MUSEUMS SAY THEY HOLD LEGAL TITLE TO THE WORKS AND INTEND TO CONTINUE DISPLAYING THEM

New laws trigger fresh legal fight over Nazi-looted art in Los Angeles & Auschwitz

Deepa Bharath
Los Angeles, September 19

JEWISH HEIRS of Holocaust victims and their representatives have filed two lawsuits in California staking claims to Nazi-looted paintings that remain on display in museums in Los Angeles and Auschwitz.

The lawsuits are the first filed after recent laws in California and Congress strengthened US-based claims to artwork taken from Jewish families during World War II. One suit was filed in Los Angeles Superior Court by the Jewish Federation of Greater Los Angeles and its board chair Daniel Gryczman against the Norton

Simon Museum in Pasadena for the return of "Adam and Eve," two life-size oil-on-panel masterpieces created by Lucas Cranach the Elder in 1530.

The other was filed in federal court by the daughters of Dinah Gottlieb Babbitt, a Holocaust survivor and California animator held in Auschwitz. It demands the return of watercolors of fellow prisoners that Babbitt was forced to paint for Josef Mengele, the Nazi physician known as the "Angel of Death."

Spokespersons for both museums say they hold legal title to the works and intend to continue displaying them. The lawsuits don't specify the monet-

ary value. The issue of Nazi-looted art pits Jewish families suffering intergenerational trauma against museums that say they are preserving history.

Between 1933 and 1945, the Nazi regime orchestrated the largest art theft in history, seizing more than 6,000,000 works. Decades later, many remain in prominent museums, complicating recovery efforts.

Rabbi Noah Farkas, president and CEO of the Jewish Federation of Los Angeles, said Marei von Saher, sole heir of Dutch Jewish art dealer Jacques Goudstikker, signed over her rights to the organization. Goudstikker's collection was seized by Hermann Goring and



Between 1933 and 1945, the Nazi regime orchestrated the largest art theft in history.

later sold in the 1960s to the Pasadena Museum of Modern Art, renamed Norton Simon Museum. Farkas said proceeds

from recovered art would help about 2,500 Holocaust survivors in Los Angeles.

"These are incredibly

beautiful European masterpieces stolen from a Jewish family to enrich the Nazi party," he said.

"It's our honor to take on this role and use most of the proceeds to help survivors live out their last years in dignity," Von Saher said she is grateful to the federation for taking up her family's cause.

"This effort represents a meaningful step toward justice for Holocaust survivors and victims of Nazi era atrocities," she said. California Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel, D-Woodland Hills, authored Assembly Bill 2867, signed by Gov. Gavin Newsom in September 2024. It requires state law to apply in

lawsuits brought by California residents or heirs to recover art seized during the Holocaust or other acts of persecution.

Gabriel introduced the bill after a federal court allowed Spain's Thyssen-Bornemisza National Museum to keep a Camille Pissarro masterpiece taken from the Cassirer family in 1939. That case is expected to be heard in California next month.

Gabriel said museums must "do some deep introspection on whether they want to be on the right side of history." Norton Simon Museum noted that a federal court in 2018 determined it had proper title to the Cranach paintings, and the US

Supreme Court declined to intervene.

The museum said the works, originally owned by the Stroganoff family, were sold in 1931 by the Soviet Union, purchased by Goudstikker, and later sold to the museum by a Stroganoff descendant.

"For nearly 50 years, they have been on view at the Norton Simon Museum and will continue to be accessible to the public," the statement said. Pawel Sawicki, spokesperson for the Auschwitz Memorial, said the watercolors documenting Mengele's experiments "must remain in the Memorial" as unique evidence of his crimes.

AP

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, PAWAN SHARMA, S/O BALAKRAM SHARMA, R/o G-5, FLAT-NO. 21, SECOND-FLOOR, VATIKA INDIA NEXT, SECTOR-82, KHERKI DAULA, GURGAON-122004, HARYANA HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR DAUGHTER'S NAME FROM AARADHYA TO AARADHYAA SHARMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.
0040879240-1

I, Mohd Ayub, S/O. Mohammad Ishaq, R/O-1215, 2nd Floor, Mahal Ballimaran, Punjabi Fatak, Delhi-110006 Have Changed My Name to Mohammad Ayub Permanently.
0040879356-3

I, MINTIRA DEVI W/O, Omprakash Marha Presently residing at Belghat, Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh-273404, have changed my name from, MINTIRA DEVI to MINTRA DEVI, vide affidavit dated-18.09.2026.
0040879365-8

I, SHAHZADA KHAatoon W/o Abdul Khalid, B-107, Gali No-10, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi-94, have changed my name to SHAHJAHAN KHAatoon.
0071061432-1

I, PRINCE CHAUHAN, S/O. SHRI SURENDER CHAUHAN, R/O-hn-1127-a Kh no 788 first floor, amar vihar, sulehan nagar, c block, north west delhi 110086. I have Changed My Name, Prince Chauhan And Prince Both Are, One And The Same Persons.
0040879395-5

I, Ram Nareish Sharma S/o Ram Vir Sharma R/o B-15 Mahindra Park Delhi, declare RAM NARESH in daughter Pooja's marksheets & RAM NARESH SHARMA are same person. Affidavit 17-09-2026.
0050298039-1

I, Ram Nareish Sharma S/o Ram Vir Sharma R/o B-15 Mahindra Park Delhi, declare RAM NARESH in daughter Pooja's marksheets & RAM NARESH SHARMA are same person. Affidavit 17-09-2026.
0050298039-1

I, Amlesh Prasad, S/o-Ram Awadh Ram, R/o-HNo 61, Chanwar PO-Gai, Dist-Ghaziapur, U.P.-232226, have changed, the name of my minor son's from Anirudh, to Anirudh Gond, for all purposes.
0040879365-1

I, MOHAMMED AZAM, S/O-MOHD ALI, R/o-H.NO.-5836, FIRST FLOOR, BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH, SADAR THANA ROAD, DELHI-110006, have change my minore child name AEIZA BANO, to AEIZA QURESHI
0040879390-7

I, Yogeshwari, W/o-Yogesh Vats, R/O N-29, Sector-11, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Yogeshwari Vats.
0040879395-7

I, KANUPRIYA ARORA W/O RAHUL ARORA R/o M-25 First Floor, Model Town 11, Delhi-110009, have changed my name to KANUPRIYA SOOD.
0040879356-5

AI, Joji PK resident of Puthuparambil House, Palachode Post, Kuruvambalam Village, Malappuram Distt. Kerala-679338, have changed my dependent's (Mother) name from, THANKAMMA KURIAN to, THANKAMMA, Vide affidavit dated-18.09.2026 at, New Delhi
0040879365-10

I, hitherto known as Harsh S/o Praveen Kumar residing at 29A, Vaishali Appartment, PKTA-12, Kalka Extension, Kalkaji, Delhi-110019, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Harsh Bhandula.
0071061439-1

I, Rampat Singh Nagar S/o Charan Singh R/o Kanavi, Shipra Suncity, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Rampat Singh.
0071061413-1

I, Kidi Devi wife of Shri Dharm Singh, resident of J-4/79A, Khirki Extension, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017, Permanent Address: 33, Raundeli Gaon- Raundeli, PO- Odada Narendranagar, Tehri Garhwal, Narendranagar, Uttarakhand-249175, declare and certify that my name as SUSHILA DEVI in mentioned in my son's 10th Class School Certificate and Other Documents my name mentioned as KIDI DEVI. And also declare that KIDI DEVI and Sushila Devi both names are one and the same person i.e. myself.
0071061482-1

I, Gagandeep W/o Sarvajit Singh Kalra R/o H-129, Third Floor, Vikas Puri, West Delhi, Delhi-110018 have changed my name from Gagandeep to Gagandeep Kaur for all purposes
0040879301-1

I, Mohd Ikram S/o Abdul Salam R/o 1/284, Shri Ram Nagar, Shahdara, East Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Ikramuddin.
0040879365-3

I, MUKESH SINGH, S/O-ROSHAN SINGH, R/O E-135, GALI-NO.3, HARDEV NAGAR, JHARODA MAJRA, DELHI-110084. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MUKESH KUMAR FOR ALL PURPOSES.
0040879390-9

I, MANISH KUMAR S/O Raghuraj Prasad Bansal R/o-305/25, Bhagwan Chit, Jheel Mohalla Gandhi Chowk Bahadurgarh, Jhajjar Haryana-124507, have changed my name to MANISH BANSAAL
0040879399-2

I Sudeep S/o Rajvanish Shukla r/o Flat No-UGF5, Building No-F38, Abhinandan Society, SLF Vd Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201102 have changed my name from Sudeep to Rajman Shukla for all future purposes
0040879295-1

I, Musi Devi wife of Shri Indar Singh, resident of F-138, Upper Ground Floor, Vijay Vihar Phase-2, Gali No.11, Rohini, Sector-4, North West Delhi, Delhi-110085, declare and certify that my name mentioned as MALTI DEVI in my daughter's 10th Class School Certificate and Other Documents mentioned as MUSI DEVI. And also declare that Musi Devi and Malti Devi both names are one and the same person i.e. myself.
0071061485-1

I, Mohinder Kaur, W/O. Harjit Singh Bhatia, R/O A-183, Fateh Nagar, New Delhi-110018 have changed my name to Mahinder Kaur for all Purposes
0040879356-7

I, SHYAM SUNDER S/O LAXMAN DASS PRUTHI born on 20/09/1966 residing at B-1455, SECOND FLOOR, SHASTRI NAGAR, DELHI-52, have changed my name to SHYAM SUNDER PRUTHI vide affidavit no. IN-DL9875549699937Y dated 14/09/2026 at DELHI.
0050297955-1

I, Krishan Pal S/O Baru Singh R/O I-5/4, Third Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have Changed my name to Krishan Pal Kataria.
0040879390-2

I, Neelam W/o Anil Kumar R/o E-803, Supertech Ecociti Near Felix Hospital, Sector-137, Asdullapur, G/B Nagar, U.P have changed my minor son name from AARAV to AARAV SHARMA for all future purposes.
0071061443-1

I, Nishu meena D/o chhotan singh R/o lakmibai nagar, Rabupura, Gautambudh Nagar Have changed my name to Nisha Meena for all future purpo.
0071061486-1

I, MANJU SURI @ VEENA SURI W/o- Mahender Suri, R/o-20-D, Madhur Apartments, Indor-Enclave, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110087, both names belong to same person i.e. myself
0040879365-5

I, Anup Kumar Mahato W/o S/o Basudeo Mahato R/o Flat No. 211-A, Regency Park 1, DLF City PhaseIV, Gurgaon Haryana-122009, have changed the name of my minor son Ahaan Singh Mahato aged 14 Years and he shall hereafter be known as Ahaan Singh.
0071061424-1

I, Pinki Kakkar, W/o-Pardeep Kakkar, R/o H No 870, Sector 24, HUDA, Panipat, Haryana 132103 have changed my name to Madhu Kakkar
0040879395-2

I, SEEMA, D/O-RANBIR SINGH R/O-3229 SECTOR-35D CHANDIGARH-160022 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR DAUGHTER NAME DRISHTY TO DILMEET
0040879403-1

I, KUNWAR PAL SINGH S/o Late Sh. Kishan Chand, R/o H. No. 12642, Sant Nagar Colony, Old Faridabad, Haryana-121002, do hereby declare, That I hereby declare that the above mentioned names KUNWAR PAL SINGH and KUNWAR PAL belong to one and are the names of one and the same person. My correct name, KUNWAR PALSINGH, may be considered for all official purposes
0040879282-1

I, Jayprakash S/o Shahbram Sharma R/o Gali No.2, Shivaji Nagar, Sikandrabad, Bulandshahr, U.P.-203205 have changed my name from Jayprakash to Jaiprakash Pathak. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jaiprakash Pathak for all future purposes.
0071061421-1

I, Baker Husain S/o Abdul Majid R/o 3349 F/F, Bagichi Aachi Ji, Bara Hindu Rao, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to BAQAR HUSSAIN, for all purpose.
0040879356-9

I, Upender Veer S/o Sukhdev Singh R/o B-1005, APEX the Florus, Sector-18, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Upinder Veer.
0040879390-4

I, FAIZAN S/O TASLEEM R/O H NO-7309, STREET NO-02, ARAM NAGAR, PAHAR GANJ, Delhi-110055 have changed my name Faizan to MD Faizan
0040879303-2

I, Suneet Kumar Malpani, S/O. Vijay Kumar Malpani, R/O-D-1401, M2K Victoria Garden, Azadpur Delhi-110033 have changed my name to Suneet Malpani.
0040879356-2

I, RISHABH GARG, S/o-Vishnu Garg, R/O. House No-2034, Plot No-7, Nai Basti Narela, Old Anand Mandi, Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed my name to *RISABH GARG.
0040879365-7

I, MANJU DHANDA, W/O SHRI MANOJ KUMAR, D/O SURJEET SINGH, R/O B-14, NANDAROAD, SARAI PIPAL THALA EXTN, ADARSH NAGAR, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, changed my name from MANJU DHANDA to MANJU KUMARI for all purposes.
0071061427-1

I, SUSHMA DEVI, W/o-ROHIT KUMAR PANDIT, R/O-FF-2, Plot No.30, Sec-2C, Vaishali, Ghaziabad (U.P.), have changed my name from, SUSHMA KUMARI to, SUSHMA DEVI. Henceforth I would be known, by the name of SUSHMA DEVI.
0040879395-4

I, Brij Mohan S/o Ami Lal Gupta R/o 169, Pocket-C-11, Near Jaipur Golden Hospital, Sector-3, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Brij Mohan Gupta permanently.
0040879269-1

I, EHSAN BANO W/O ZAKIR HUSSAIN R/O 1095 KISHAN GANJ TELIWARAAZAD MARKET DELHI-110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AHSAN BANO FOR FUTURE.
0040879356-11

I, Rabaani Hora W/o Haskanant Singh R/o-26/56, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi-26 have changed my name to Rabaani Kaur Anand for all purposes.
0071061412-1

I, SHAFIA / SHAFIA BANO, W/o-MOHAMMED AZAM, R/o-H.NO.-5836, FIRST FLOOR, BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH, SADAR THANA ROAD, DELHI-110006 have change my name to SHAFIA QURESHI
0040879390-6

I, Anushka Singh D/o Rajnish Kumar Singh R/o 43 DA Village & Post Gharhi District Ghazipur, UP hereby declares that Anushka and Anushka Singh are both same and one identical person vide Affidavit no. IN-DL00829433604868 at, 17.09.2026 and shall be known as Anushka Singh for all the future purposes.
0050298038-1

I, Ilma D/o Tasleem Nabi R/o H-13, Gali No.5, Brahmampuri, Seelampur, North East Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Ilma Naaz for all purposes
0040879395-6

I Parminder Rani alias Sparsla W/o Sh. Mahinder Kumar, D/o Sh. Dashu R/o A-3, Second Floor, Vivek Vihar Phase -1, Vivek Vihar, Delhi have changed my name to Sparsala for all purposes.
0040879231-1

I, SAMIM BEGUM, W/O-SAGIR AHMAD, R/O H-7/C, 4TH FLOOR LEFT SIDE, AZAD ROAD ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE-1, JAMIA NAGAR, OKHA, SOUTH DELHI-110025, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, SAMIM BEGUM, TO SAMIM BANO PERMANENTLY.
0040879356-4

I, THANKAMMA KURIAN mother of Joji P K Presently residing at Puthuparambil House, Palachode Post, Kuruvambalam Village, Malappuram Distt. Kerala-679338, have changed my name from, THANKAMMA KURIAN to THANKAMMA, Vide affidavit, date-18.09.2026.
0040879365-9

I, Sucharu Lata D/o S.K Samal, K-I-187, Gali No-4, Sangam Vihar, Delhi-110062, have changed my name to Sucharu Lata Samal.
0071061433-1

I, TMAFRI KUMARI W/O SANTOSH KUMAR CHOUDHARY R/O C-69 2ND FLOOR VIVEK VIHAR PHASE -1 VIVEK VIHAR JHLMIL EAST DELHI DELHI 110095 have changed my name MAFRI TIKMARAM for all future purpose
0071061477-1

I, Junaid, S/o Mohd Iqbal, R/o-F-2, DDA Flats Sheesh Mahal Ganj, Mir Khan Delhi, has changed my name to Junaid Khan, for all purpose.
0040879365-2

I Vishal Singh S/o Sh. Jaipal Singh R/o House.No.224, new manglupuri New Delhi-110030. Have changed my name from Vishal to Vishal Singh for all purposes. Both name belongs to one and same person.
0071061420-1

I, MOHD AZAM / MOH AZAM ALI / MOHAMMAD AZAM, S/o-MOHD ALI, R/o-H. NO.-5836, FIRST FLOOR, BASTI HARPHOOL SINGH, SADAR THANA ROAD, DELHI - 110006, have change my name to, MOHAMMED AZAM
0040879390-8

I, Manish Kumar, s/o-Gopal Chander verma, R/O B-1419, High End Paradise, Raj Nagar Extension, Gaziabad, UP, 201017 I have changed my name to, Manish Kumar Verma for all future purpose
0040879399-1

I, Syed Zamin Ali Naqvi, S/o-Late Syed Zakir Husain Naqvi, R/o-HNO-C-38/A Second Floor, Johri Farm Noor Nagar Extn, Jamia Nagar, South Delhi-110025, have changed my name, from Zamin Ali Naqvi to Syed Zamin Ali Naqvi for all purposes.
0040879356-6

I, RAVINDRA KUMAR CHAUDHARY, S/O-DAMODAR SINGH CHAUDHARY, R/O R-Z-D-1/89, Third floor, Gali No-01, D D A Park, Vijay Enclave, Palam Village, South West Delhi-110045, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO, Ravinder Kumar
0040879390-1

I, Sahina W/o Mobin R/o 56, Block O, Chanakya Place -2, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi-110059, have changed my minor son's name from Mohsen Ahmad Aged 12 Years to Mohsin Ahmad forever
0071061441-1

I, Reen Devi W/o Sanjay R/O 349, Shyam Nagar, Near Subhash-Nagar Crossing, Tilak-Nagar, N.D. 18, have changed my name to Renu Devi for-all purposes.
0040879365-4

I, FAIZAN S/O TASLEEM R/O H NO-7309, STREET NO-02, ARAM NAGAR, PAHAR GANJ, Delhi-110055 have changed my name Faizan to MD Faizan
0040879303-2

I, Suneet Kumar Malpani, S/O. Vijay Kumar Malpani, R/O-D-1401, M2K Victoria Garden, Azadpur Delhi-110033 have changed my name to Suneet Malpani.
0040879356-2

I, RISHABH GARG, S/o-Vishnu Garg, R/O. House No-2034, Plot No-7, Nai Basti Narela, Old Anand Mandi, Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed my name to *RISABH GARG.
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I, MANJU DHANDA, W/O SHRI MANOJ KUMAR, D/O SURJEET SINGH, R/O B-14, NANDAROAD, SARAI PIPAL THALA EXTN, ADARSH NAGAR, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, changed my name from MANJU DHANDA to MANJU KUMARI for all purposes.
0071061427-1

I, SUSHMA DEVI, W/o-ROHIT KUMAR PANDIT, R/O-FF-2, Plot No.30, Sec-2C, Vaishali, Ghaziabad (U.P.), have changed my name from, SUSHMA KUMARI to, SUSHMA DEVI. Henceforth I would be known, by the name of SUSHMA DEVI.
0040879395-4

I, Brij Mohan S/o Ami Lal Gupta R/o 169, Pocket-C-11, Near Jaipur Golden Hospital, Sector-3, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Brij Mohan Gupta permanently.
0040879269-1

I, Sunita W/O Krishan Pal Kataria R/O I-5/4, Third Floor, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have Changed my name to Sunita Kataria.
0040879390-3

I, Anil Tamang S/O Ratan Tamang R/o 58/B, Uttar Palash, Debidanga, Champasari, Matigara, Champasari, PO-Champasari, Distt-Darjeeling, West Bengal - 734003, have changed my name to Arun Tamang.
0071061461-1

I, MOHD TASLEEM R/O H NO-7309, STREET NO-02, ARAM NAGAR, PAHAR GANJ, Delhi-110055 have changed my name Mohd Tasleem to Tasleem
0040879303-1

I, Parul Sinha @ Parul Saxena, W/o-Alok Saxena, R/o-House No-609, Sector-15 Vasundhara Ghaziabad U.P-201012 have changed my name to Parul Sinha Saxena.
0040879356-1

I, DIKSHA NEGI, W/O-VIKRANT SINGH KANDARI, R/O-HOUSE NO.44 GALI DOMAN NEAR FATEHPURI, CHURCH, BAGH DIWAR CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI-110006, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DIKSHA KANDARI.
0040879365-6

I hitherto known as Nishant S/o Praveen Kumar residing at 29A, DDA Flats, Pocket A-12, Kalka Extension, Kalkaji, Delhi-110019, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nishant Bhandula.
0071061425-1

I, AMAR KUMAR SRIVASTAVA, S/o-Bhavnes Kumar Srivastava, R/o-Flat No.97, Shivam Apartment, Sector-15, Rohini Delhi-110089, have changed my name to AMAR KUMAR.
0040879395-3

I, ASHISH PAL SINGH S/O BHUPINDER SINGH VAID R/O-F-10/31, KRISHNA NAGAR, DELHI-110051, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ASHISH PAL SINGH VAID PERMANENTLY.
0040878952-5

I, Mohd Ashqin S/o Mohd Usman R/o 1117, Teliwara, Azad Market, Kishan Ganj, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to MOHD ASHQEEN, for all purpose.
0040879356-10

We RADHEY SHYAM & RENUKA SHARMA, R/O 106, 3rd Floor, Bannu Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changed the name of my minor child, aged 13 years from AARAV KUMAR to AARAV SHARMA
0071061411-1

I, Bharat S/o-Virender Munjal, R/o-124/24, Main Bazar, Old Subzi Mandi, Majid Mohalla, Bahadurgarh, Distt Jhajjar (Haryana), have changed my name to Bharat Bhushan Munjal for all Purposes.
0040879390-5

I, Narendra Singh, R/o 182, Village - Salempur Gurjar, Salempur Gurjar, G/B Nagar, U.P. have changed my minor daughter name from Alish Bhat to Aradhyia Chaudhary, The name Aradhyia Chaudhary shall be used in all her educational, government and other official records.
0071061468-1

Bride wanted
BRAHMIN

Mumbai working boy, 32/5'11" BE(Mech), MS(Ship Designing-Sweden), Teetotaler, Vegetarian, Family Saryuparin, MP Based, Father Retired GM Electrical from CPSU, Hyderabad Settled seeks professionally qualified (Hindi Brahmin) working girl. Contact: A Shukla. 9550423808/ 9490491735
0130069439-1

CASTE NO BAR

WANTED BRIDE for professional manglik Groom, 35/5'10", MBA, drawing 12LPA. Seeking educated and working girl, 30-34. Castenobar. Contact 8076735005
0130069422-1

CHRISTIAN

Retired, USA settled Malayalee Christian Widower, healthy 66 yrs seeking female companion. Looking for caring, religious life partner aged 45-65 and willing to settle in USA. Contact with details: simivalleyd@yahoo.com
0050297786-1

HINDU

MD/MS MATCH FOR 28, 5'2", HINDU, ARORA, CONVENT EDUCATED MD SR BIOCHEMISTRY PERSUING FELLOWSHIP AT AIIMS 9855952964
0050297788-1

Groom wanted

PUBLIC NOTICE
BE IT KNOWN TO ALL THAT MY CLIENTS SR. KASHID HUSSEN SO-AD HUSSEN AND SMT. SHAMSHAD BEGUM W/O KASHID HUSSEN, BOTH RO A-67, GALI NO.5, MADHU VILAGE, PATPARGANJ, NEAR BANJAMAN MANDIR, LP EXTENSION, EAST DELHI-11002 HAVE SEVERED RELATION WITH THEIR SON NAMELY MOHAMMAD SALMAN AND THEIR DAUGHTER IN LAW, NAMELY GULSHAN ZEENA DO SH. ZAIED HUSSEN, WHO MOHAMMAD SALMAN AND DISOWNED BOTH OF THEM DUE TO MISCONDUCT AND BEHAVIOR AND UNPLEASANT ACT TOWARDS MY CLIENT BOTH OF MY CLIENTS HAVE DISOWNED TOWARDS MY CLIENT BOTH OF MY CLIENTS HAVE DISOWNED AND DEBARRED BOTH THEIR SON AND DAUGHTER IN LAW FROM ALL IMMOVABLE AND MOVABLE PROPERTIES OWNED BY MY CLIENTS WITH IMMEDIATE EFFECT MY CLIENT WILL NOT BE RESPONSIBLE IN ANY MANNER OF ANY ACT COMMITTED OR OMITTED BY MOHAMMAD SALMAN AND HIS WIFE NAMELY GULSHAN ZEENA
Sd/-
NEERAJ KARDWAL
Advocate
CHANDIA, CIVIL WING,
TIS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE
The public at large is hereby informed on behalf of my client Sh. Raj Kumar S/o Late Sh. Rishal Singh, Sh. Ajay Kumar Singhal S/o Sh. Raj Kumar, Smt. Manju Gupta W/o Sh. Raj Kumar Singhal, Ms. Ruchi Singhal D/o Sh. Ajay Kumar Singhal and Sh. Manoj Kumar Singhal S/o Sh. Ajay Kumar Singhal all residents of I/6981 (Upper Ground Floor), Shivaji Park, Shabbdra Lohi-110032, that they have disowned, severed and completely terminated all relations with Sh. Anurag Singhal S/o Sh. Ajay Kumar Singhal and his wife Smt. Sakshi Aggarwal.
The said disassociation has been necessitated due to their continuous misconduct, cruelty, disobedient behavior, and acts causing mental harassment and toucher to my clients without any justifiable reason.
Henceforth, my clients shall have no responsibility, liability or concern whatsoever for any acts, deeds, or transactions, dealings, liabilities or obligations undertaken by or on behalf of Sh. Anurag Singhal and Smt. Sakshi Aggarwal.
Any person dealing with them shall do so at their own risk and consequences.
Sd/-
PARVEEN KUMAR GARG
Advocate
Ch.No.700, Western Wing,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

I, ARVIND GOYAL, R/o 42-A/78, West Punjabi Bagh, New Delhi-110026, declare that the name of my daughter, born on 23/10/2025, has been changed from AVEERA GOYAL to SAMIKSHA GOYAL. Both names refer to one and the same person for all purposes.
ARVIND GOYAL
(Father & Natural Guardian)

EDUCATIONAL

ADMISSION

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Applications (Online/Offline) are invited for admission in B.Ed.-2026-27 under Special Round of Counseling from Registered / unregistered, CET/CUET - 2026 qualified eligible candidates.
Download Application Form at GRCDE.IN w.e.f. 21 - 23 Sept. 2026 or visit Reception Desk (Monday to Friday 9.30am - 3.30pm) GURU RAM DASS COLLEGE OF EDUCATION (Affiliated to GGSIU) West Jyoti Nagar (Kardam Marg), Shahdara, Delhi-110094 (Mob./Whatsapp 704292808) Reservation as applicable

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Tel: 9135-2763506, 2763808, Fax: 9135-2763507, web@ujvn.com, www.ujvn.com

Tender No.836
TENDER NOTICE
Office of Executive Engineer (Maint.), Khodri Power House, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below,
Tender No:-11, 12, 13 & 14 /EE(Maint.)/Khodri/2026-27.
Name of work: (1)safety audit of Power Station equipment offKhodri Power Station.
(2) Annual maintenance works related to turbine & associated parts of Unit.No. 01 of Khodri Power Station.
(3) Repair & maintenance works of mechanical auxiliaries of Unit 1, 2 & 3 of Khodri Power station.
(4) Repairing & Overhauling of 15 HP Emergency pump & 02 Nos. 20 HP Clean water pump of Khodri Power Station.
Estimated cost (In Lakh): Rs. 01.49 (GST extra), Rs. 09.15 (GST extra), Rs. 24.47 (GST extra) & Rs. 19.10 (GST extra) respectively.
Date of availability of bid Document on website-21.09.2026, 10:00 Hrs. Last date for submission of tender :12.10.2026, 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender document can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com".
Executive Engineer (Maint.) khodri power station
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

HINDU

MD/MS MATCH FOR 28, 5'2", HINDU, ARORA, CONVENT EDUCATED MD SR BIOCHEMISTRY PERSUING FELLOWSHIP AT AIIMS 9855952964
0050297788-1

उ० प्र० पावर ट्रांसमिशन कारपोरेशन लि० विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा ई निविदा सूचना दिनांक 19.09.2026 निविदा संख्या एवं कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण: 1 ई-निविदा संख्या टी- 43/ वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27 : विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड-प्रथम आगरा के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत (जमा मद के तहत) 132 के.वी. उपकेन्द्र फतेहाबाद आगरा पर 02 नम 33 के.वी. निबोहरा एवं महाराजपुर "बे" का

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rahul @ Gandhi S/o Rajesh R/o Vagabond, Town Hall, Chandni Chowk, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 772/2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul @ Gandhi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul @ Gandhi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul @ Gandhi** of case **FIR No. 772/2020 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08
Central District, Room No. 272
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12853/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akash Sharma, S/o Harkesh Sharma R/o 154, Gali No.07, Chander Vihar, Mandawali and Also at, H.No. A-22, Near Hanuman Mandir, IP Extension, Joshi Colony, Delhi-92** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 452/2020 U/s 379/356/34 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akash Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akash Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Akash Sharma** of **FIR No. 452/2020 u/s 379/356/34 IPC, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
East District, Room No. 16
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12035/ED/2026

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)

Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan,
Kanwali Road, Dehradun -248001
Telephone-(0135)2763672-76, Fax-(0135)2760289

CORRIGENDUM TO E-TENDER NOTICE

This office e-tender specification no. CCP-11/4/2026-2027, invited previously, for supply of 114 Nos. 33kV Outdoor Pole mounted CT-PT combined unit with meter box is hereby extended due to unavoidable reasons. The e-tender can be purchased and submitted upto 17:00hrs. of 05.10.2026. Part-I of the e-tender shall be opened on 06.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs.

For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in.

Superintending Engineer
Corporate (C&P-II)

No.: 738/EE(cm)/UPCL/A-2 Date: 19/09/2026

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION" Use L.E.D. Bulb to Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) "Pay Electricity Bill Online 24 x 7 from www.upcl.org (For information on Electricity theft, informer may refer to Toll Free No. 1800 1804185 0405/Fax No. 0135-2760911)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gurinder Singh S/o Ajinder Pal Singh R/o: B-27, 1st Floor, Hardev Nagar, Buri, Delhi-84, Also at: C-18, Mahendru Enclave Near Chhatarsal Stadium, Delhi-33**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 6424/2019, U/S138 NI Act, PS Model Town, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gurinder Singh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gurinder Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Gurinder Singh** the said accused of **CT Case No. 6424/2019, U/S138 NI Act, PS Model Town, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Akash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North Distt., Court No.-213, 2nd Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13238/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: JHS/DYCM/2026/23 Date: 17.09.2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, The Dy Chief Material Manager, General Store Depot, Jhansi are invite the following E-procurement tender

Tender No.: 51266106 Tender Opening Date: 14.10.2026

Description: ELECTRO-PNEUMATIC PRESSURISED FLUSHING SYSTEM FOR LHB COACHES., as per Drawing: MMDTS 19027 REV. 03/AND FOLLOW DRG. NO. MID07851 ALT NIL FOR MOUNTING DIMENSIONS OF CONTROL PANEL OF EPFFS FOR LHB COACHES., Packing Instruction: EP FLUSHING SYSTEM ITEMS SHOULD BE INDIVIDUALLY WRAPPED WITH CORRUGATED PAPER AND COLLECTIVELY PACKED IN WOODEN BOX HAVING SUFFICIENT STRENGTH. IT SHOULD BE ENSURED THAT ITEM SHOULD NOT RUB DURING TRANSPORTATION. TRANSIT DAMAGE IF ANY SHALL BE AT THE COST OF SUPPLIER. A LIST SHOULD BE PASTED ON EACH BOX SHOWING PURCHASE ORDER NO, PL NO., DESCRIPTION, DRG/SP/ECNO, QTY, FIRM NAME & ADDRESS, DATE OF DISPATCH ETC. NOTE QR CODE IS TO BE AFFIXED [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery] [Inspection Agency: TPI, Stage Insp.: No, Stages: 0]

Qty.: 200 Set EMD: ₹ 134800/-

Note: (1) The Complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E bids shall not be accepted against above tenders for this purpose vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS Website along with class III digital signature certificate issued by CCA under IT act 2000. (3) Rules entered into financial rate page and duly singed digitally signature shall only be considered rates and any other financial entry in any other form/letter had if attached by vendor shall be original straight way ignore and shall not be considered. 2132/26 (A)

f North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajinder Kumar S/o Rajmal R/o Village-Sainthal, P.O.-Sainthal, Tehsil-Joginder Nagar Parain 50 Mandi, Himachal Pradesh-175032, Also at: WA-74A, 3rd Floor, Shakarpur, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-92**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI Act : 1436/2022, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Bhajanpura, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajinder Kumar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajinder Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajinder Kumar** the said accused of **CC NI Act : 1436/2022, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Bhajanpura, North-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sanjana Kasana
Judicial Magistrate First Class,
Room No.-409, North-East Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13254/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, U. P. LIVESTOCK DEVELOPMENT BOARD

Badshah Bagh, Gokaran Nath Road, Lucknow-226007
Ph. No. 0522-2977709, Email Id: upldb@rediffmail.com, Website: <https://upldb.up.gov.in>

L. No. 1138(2)/UPLDB/Static Vessel/GeM/2026-27, Date: September, 18, 2026

NOTICE FOR CUSTOM GEM-BID INVITATION

Uttar Pradesh Livestock Development Board (U.P.L.D.B.) is a society registered under the Society Registration Act, 1860 established as per Govt. of India directives has invited online Custom GeM Bid# **GE/2026/B/8040265**, Dated: 17.09.2026 for implementation of Animal Breeding programme in the State of Uttar Pradesh. For this 1000 Lts.(± 50 Lts.) Vertical Tanks (Cryo-Vessel for holding Liquid Nitrogen-used for preservation of Semen straws) are to be procured and installed at 76 Tehsil-Block level Animal Husbandry centres for making available Liquid Nitrogen to Artificial Insemination Technicians (AIt)s working at district level, as per the details given below:

GeM Bid Details

Custom GeM Bid No. & Date	Tendered Items/Instruments (As per details given in the GeM Bid documents)	Earnest Money (Rs.) (Refundable)	Last Date & time for submission	Opening of GeM Bids (Technical bids)
Custom GeM Bid# GE/2026/B/8040265, Dated: 17.09.2026	1000 Lts. (± 50 Lts.) Vertical LIN holding Vessel for Animal Breeding Programme	6,00,000.00	28.09.2026 upto 01:00 P.M.	29.09.2026 01:00 P.M. onwards

The complete GeM Bid details have been uploaded on GeM portal as per information given in the above table. Any corrigendum/amendment in the GeM Bid document shall be uploaded on GeM portal only. UPLDB reserves the right to cancel any or all the GeM-Bids without assigning any reason and decision of UPLDB shall be final and binding.

Dr. Pramod Kumar Singh
Chief Executive Officer

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।

:- अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना :-

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-EE/NREP/CHAIBASA/03 /2026-27 (DMFT मद)

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-

क्र.सं०	प्रश्नखंड	कार्यकनाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विघटन का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	आनन्दपुर	विन्डू पंचायत के ग्राम रूमी नया टोला वेन्गामिन लुगुन के घर से उड़सै साीमान तक 2600 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् सड़क निर्माण।	45452530.00	910000.00	10000.00	9 माह
2	आनन्दपुर	आनन्दपुर पंचायत के ग्राम रूमीन में अरुन्दीन्दीन् रोड खसिहान से नवाडीह टोला हुग कलिन केरा घर तक 1400 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् सड़क निर्माण।	14972540.00	300000.00	10000.00	6 माह
3	आनन्दपुर	रूमीकोना पंचायत के ग्राम सोदा में मंदान से चच तक 1500 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् सड़क निर्माण।	25878245.00	518000.00	10000.00	9 माह
4	आनन्दपुर	झारबेडा पंचायत के ग्राम धरमसाईं पंचायत नवन से लकमिन मय शिवालय धारपडा स्थल होते हुए माहलीतिया मनहर नवगार के घर तक 3000 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	40137322.00	803000.00	10000.00	9 माह
5	मनोहरपुर	कोलनोटका पंचायत के ग्राम बीजा टोली REO सड़क से सनिका टोली के घर तक 1100 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ एवं अरुन्दीन्दीन् पुलिया एवं गार्डवाल निर्माण।	17245100.00	345000.00	10000.00	9 माह
6	मनोहरपुर	गमदा पंचायत के ग्राम सोदा के सुगुन्दी टोली से मुख्य सड़क को जोडने हेतु कोयना नदी री 3 पंचे पुलिया निर्माण।	34361800.00	688000.00	10000.00	12 माह
7	मनोहरपुर	दीघा पंचायत के ग्राम बिटकिन्सीसय के बाला टोला में गडवानडेख नाला में 2 सेन पुलिया निर्माण।	40985900.00	820000.00	10000.00	12 माह
8	चक्रधरपुर	कुलीगोडा पंचायत के ग्राम धरमसाईं में दुल्लु मुन्डा के घर से रोसोवा मुन्डा के घर में 1000 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् सड़क निर्माण।	9224880.00	185000.00	10000.00	6 माह
9	चक्रधरपुर	कोलचोकडा पंचायत के ग्राम यामसाईंहीह ननुमान मंदि से आसनलतिया तक 2250 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	22565660.00	452000.00	10000.00	6 माह
10	चक्रधरपुर	जामिद पंचायत के ग्राम मरेखा के बुईगा टोला में धतुपुंज नायक के सालाह से सारकारी नाला तक 800 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	10806330.00	217000.00	10000.00	6 माह
11	चक्रधरपुर	बाइरी पंचायत के ग्राम-कोनाय में झाईनी रकुल कोमाईं लोन थोक से बाबुसिंह जोको घर तक 1410 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	12545910.00	251000.00	10000.00	6 माह
12	चक्रधरपुर	नैनपुर पंचायत के ग्राम इन्डिका के उरुडीह में मोती बौदरा के घर से कश्तिरान तक 1180 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	10948690.00	219000.00	10000.00	6 माह
13	चक्रधरपुर	सिभिदिरी पंचायत के ग्राम सिभिदिरी के मुस्लिम टोला में रजा अहमद के घर से कश्तिरान नाला में 325 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् सड़क एवं अरुन्दीन्दीन् पुलिया का निर्माण।	6400050.00	129000.00	10000.00	6 माह
14	चक्रधरपुर	नलित पंचायत के ग्राम नलित में वि. वनाथ कुन्हार के घर से सामाड घर तक 270 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	2406400.00	49000.00	5000.00	3 माह
15	चक्रधरपुर	सिलकोडी पंचायत के ग्राम बुडीगोडा में कोल्हान साईं मुख्य मार्ग से बागुन बौदरा के घर तक 915 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	8543320.00	171000.00	10000.00	6 माह
16	कुमारझुंजी	बेडामुन्दी पंचायत के ग्राम धोरी चौक से जेरपी माया जामुनी तक 2650 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	25409900.00	509000.00	10000.00	9 माह
17	मदगांव	असनगठ पंचायत के ग्राम खैरावा में बलान कुडा से पूर्ति साईं होते हुए पुखरिया साईं नदी तक 1620 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	17600800.00	353000.00	10000.00	6 माह
18	सदर चाईबासा	बरकोला पंचायत के ग्राम बरकोला भागिहार हाट से बीटीपी लतारसिका होते हुए मय शिवालय, ककटा मुख्य सड़क तक 4400 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	37684700.00	754000.00	10000.00	9 माह
19	सदर चाईबासा	कुस्ती पंचायत के ग्राम पुरनिया मुख्य पथ से जाहरा से पुरनिया होते हुए भवाम लता घर मुख्य पथ तक 1900 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	12858000.00	258000.00	10000.00	6 माह
20	सदर चाईबासा	हरिना पंचायत के ग्राम हरिना टोला दुल्लाल से ग्राम तेरंगो जाने वाली सड़क के नाला में 3 सेन पुलिया निर्माण।	38858200.00	778000.00	10000.00	12 माह
21	सदर चाईबासा	मतकमहातु पंचायत के ग्राम मतकमहातु मुख्य सड़क टेकहातु होते हुए शिंगपोखरिया स्टे ल तक 4000 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	23770115.00	476000.00	10000.00	6 माह
22	झीकपाणी	कलेन्डे पंचायत के ग्राम-सोनीपोली में मेन रोड से तोरोगासा होते हुए किताबासा तक 1200 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	11211300.00	225000.00	10000.00	6 माह
23	टोन्टी	टोन्टी पंचायत के ग्राम बदलकन से भासुरीरु तक 3000 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	37703100.00	755000.00	10000.00	9 माह
24	नोवामुडी	कावाजामदा पंचायत के ग्राम कावाजामदा सांगुगुड मुख्य सड़क से बातु लोर तक 1550 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	22684710.00	454000.00	10000.00	6 माह
25	नोवामुडी	दिरादुल पंचायत के ग्राम बडबालाजोडी मुख्य सड़क से मानकी टोला UPG MS विद्यालय बडबालाजोडी होते हुए बादासाईं तक 1300 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	16613910.00	333000.00	10000.00	6 माह
26	नोवामुडी	कोटगोड पंचायत के जमननाथपुर-नोवामुडी PWD मुख्य सड़क से कटियासाईं होते हुए हवाईपट्टी तक 2400 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	26708700.00	535000.00	10000.00	9 माह
27	जमाननाथपुर	लोडगहातु पंचायत के ग्राम कुडीरौल टोला जोडा पांखर के मुरा पुरी के घर से कमर गाडा बारा सुखील बालमुपु घर से लतारसाईं होते हुए कान्करम केराईं घर तक 750 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	7391200.00	148000.00	10000.00	6 माह
28	खुटपाणी	कंदा पंचायत के ग्राम बकुगुन्टिया के मतकमहातु सीमा से साशागाडा बीत तक 1050 मीटर पीन्सीन्सीन् पथ निर्माण।	7662730.00	154000.00	10000.00	6 माह

2. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि- 29.09.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय-दिनांक 12.10.2026 तक समय अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान-कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम,पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय -14.10.2026 अपराह्न 05 बजे।

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदवीधारी का नाम एवं पता :-कार्यपालक अभियंता, राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठका दूरभाष सं०-7091319073(संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंताका दूरभाषनम्बर)

8. परिमाण विघटन की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. सरकार के संयुक्त सचिव ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग द्वाराखण्ड सरकार तंत्री के पत्रांक 02(नि०नि०-17)-251/23 ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग 3130(अनु०) तंत्री, दिनांक 06.10.2023 द्वारा दिये गये निर्दे। 1 के अनुसारन में रूमी कामजात के साथ, निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी।अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाब देही आपकी होगी।

11. ग्रामीण विकास विभाग (ग्रामीण कार्य मामले) झारखण्ड, पथ निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड के अनुरात पंजीकृत समुचित श्रेणी के सवेदक भाग ले सकते हैं।

12. जिला दण्डाधिकारी-साह-उपमण्डल, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा के पत्रांक 1679 दिनांक 23.12.2022 के अलोक में निविदा डालने के समय चाईबासा जिला अंतर्गत किसी भी प्रपञ्चल/विभाग द्वारा आवंटित कार्य एकराशित अवधि बीत जाने के बाद लखित नहीं होने संबंधित माईबास पत्र देना होगा।। कार्य लखित पाये जाने पर उनका निविदा स्वतः रद्द माना जाएगा।

13. बिना कारण बताए किसी भी समय निविदा को रद्द करने का अधिकार अचोहरतासारी को सुरक्षित रहेगा।।

14. निविदा खोलने की तिथि से 05(पांच) दिनों के अंतर निविदाखता द्वारा अपनी आपत्ति/ दावादर्ज कराये अन्यथा अवधि बीतने के परश्चात कोई भी आपत्ति/ दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

15. जिस सवेदक का कार्य छ: माह से अधिक लखित है उनको कार्य आवंटन नहीं किया जायेगा।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लियेवेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचनापत्र पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।

PR.NO.390112 West Singhbhum(26-27):D

Office of The Chief Engineer (Bhopal Zone) P.W.D Bhopal (M.P.)

Email:- cpwdcapital@mp.nic.in Telephone/Fax No. 0755-2551403

Tender Notice

NIT No. 15/G/1/Mis/Bpl.Z./2019 (Year 2026) Bhopal, Date 16-09-2026

Online Tender for mentioned below are being invited. The Tender have been uploaded on the e-Procurement system of Public Works Department on the Portal <https://mptenders.gov.in>. Tender details are as below:-

S. No.	Tender No.	District	Nature of Work	Name of Work	Call No.	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. In lack)	Remarks
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	2026 PWDDB_536412	Bhopal (Mn. Dn. No.02 Bhopal)	Road	White Topping of Road from DIG Bunglow to Best Price (Ayodhya Bypass Road) via Kalipared Road Length 3.50 Km. (Balance Work)	1st Call	765.64	EMD/All Document are to be submitted online only.
				Total		765.64	

The document can only be purchased online from the above website after making online payment. The last date & time for purchase of Document on line is Dated 03-10-2026 up to (17:30). Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on the above mentioned portal. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in newspaper.

Sd/
Chief Engineer (Bhopal Zone)
P.W.D. Bhopal Madhya pradesh

G18728/26

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ड्रेनेज मण्डल, अलीगढ (E-Mail: sedrainage@gmail.com)

ई प्रोक्वोमेन्ट अति अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या: 12/ एस०ई० / डी.सी.ए./2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ऑन लाइन निविदाएँ (<http://etender.up.nic.in>) सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, उत्तर प्रदेश में वगीकृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत टेकदारों से दिनांक 30.09.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा की प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन / टेक्नीकल बिड अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ड्रेनेज मण्डल, अलीगढ के कार्यालय में मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) मेरठ द्वारा गठित समितिके सदस्यों द्वारा दिनांक 30.09.2026 को अपराह्न 03.30 बजे खोली जायेगी। इसके अगले कार्य दिवस में, यदि इस सम्बन्ध में कोई आपत्ति हो तो, इस कार्यालय में आपत्ति प्राप्त की जायेगी। प्री क्वालीफिकेशन / टेक्नीकल बिड में क्वालीफाईड पाये गये टेकदारों की ही फाईनेन्शियल बिड खोली जायेगी। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा अवकाश होने की दशा में यह निविदा अगले कार्य दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेगी। अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा दिनांक 23.09.2026 को अपराह्न 02.00 बजे से दिनांक 30.09.2026 को अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक डाउनलोड/अपलोड की जा सकती हैं। कार्य का विवरण निम्नवत है :-

लट सं०	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (बिना जी०एस० टी०) लाख रू० में	धरोर धराणी लाख रू० में	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	सम्बन्धित खण्डीय कार्या का नाम	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य -जी.एस.टी. + वेबगार्ड हेडलिंज चार्ज (रखे में)	पंजीकरण श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Re-Construction of Damaged Bridges at Km. 177.473, Km. 182.126, Km.186.754 and Km. 187.448 of Anoop shahar Branch Canal Under Aligarh Division Ganga Canal, Aligarh	369.25	7.39	180 दिवस	अधिशासी अभियन्ता, अलीगढ खण्ड गंगा नहर, अलीगढ	300 + 500 + 144 + 3693 रू० 4637.00	'ए'

विस्तृत अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना का विवरण एवं नियम व शर्त उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की वेबसाईट (<http://upgovt.up.nic/infotech>) तथा सिंचाई विभाग की वेबसाईट (<http://www.idup.gov.in>) पर उपलब्ध है। उपरोक्त वर्गीत सूचना तथा वेबसाईट पर प्रदर्शित सूचना में यदि कोई भिन्नता होती है तो वेबसाईट पर प्रदर्शित सूचना ही मान्य होगी। यह अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना बिना किसी पूर्व सूचना के निरस्त की जा सकती है। इसके लिये किसी प्रकार का कोई दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

UPID- 256519 DATE-18/09/2026 www.upidadv.gov.in

(प्रभात कुमार सिंह) अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. DYCE/GSU/GWL/Tender/1226 Dated : 17.09.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Deputy Chief Engineer/GSU, N.C. Railway, Gwalior for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open online E-Tenders (Single packet System) for the following work:

E-tender No. : DYCEGSUGWL1226 Approx. Cost : Rs. 54.70 Lakh

Description of work : Land Acquisition and other allied works in connection of various ROBs/RUB works under jurisdiction of Dy. CE/GSU/GWL of Jhansi Division of North Central Railway.

Date of closing Tender : 12.10.2026

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months

* Tender can be submitted online up to 11:00 hrs. on 12.10.2026 * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 2136/26 (C)

f North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in X @CPRONC

Chola

Enter a better life

CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED

Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

DEMAND NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT 2002

You, the under mentioned Borrower / Co-Borrowers is hereby informed that the company has initiated proceedings against you under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and that the Notice under 13 (2) of the Act sent to you by Registered Post Ack. Due for Borrower/s has been returned undelivered. Hence, you are hereby called upon to take notice and pay the outstanding loan amount mentioned against the said account with interest accruing there from within 60 days from the date of this publication, failing which the company will proceed against you by exercising its right under Sub-Sec (4) of Section 13 of the Act by enforcing the below mentioned security to realize its dues with interests and costs. It is needless to mention that this notice is addressed to you without prejudice to any other remedy available to the company.

Loan Account No. TL01DRN0000067991, Name and Address of the Borrower/Co-Borrowers: 1. Mr. Neeraj S/o Sh. Ram Chander, (Borrower) Address: Garhi Sampla (35), District Rohtak, Haryana 124501, 2. Mrs. Kavita C/o Mr. Ranvir Singh, (Co Borrower) Address: Garhi Sampla (35), District Rohtak, Haryana -124 5013. Mrs. Nirmala W/o Mr. Ram Chander, (Co Borrower) Address: Garhi Sampla (35), District Rohtak, Haryana - 124 501 Loan Amount: Rs. 41,86,058/- Date of Demand Notice: 11.09.2026, Amount Outstanding: Rs. 42,92,542/- as on 10.09.2026 with further interest thereon & NPA Date: 05.09.2026.

SCHEDULE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY:

All Piece and Parcel of Property i.e. Part Bearing Khewat No 295, Khataoni No 326, Khasra No 30/4/2(6K-0M), Rakba 6K-0M Admeasuring 0K-6M(181 Sq.Yds) As per Jamabandi for the Year 2017-2018, Situated at Village Garhi Sampla Tehsil Sampla and District Rohtak, Hadbast No 293 Bearing Sale Deed No 1486 Dated 28-September-2022 in the name of Smt. Nirmala W/o Sh. Ram Chander. Bounded as: East: NA, North : Road, West: House of Nirmala, South : Factory.

Date : 20.09.2026 Place : Haryana

Authorized Officer For Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. CC-6/E-Auction/SLR/2026 Date : 17.09.2026

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior Divisional Commercial, North Central Railway, Prayagraj in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04, Date 13.06.2022 (FM No. 11 of 2022) invites bids through E-Auction module of IREPS for leasing contract 02 years for leasing of parcel space (SLRs & VPs) in the following trains originating from various station of Prayagraj Division.

Parcel					
S. N.	Compt. Train No.	CC (Intones)	From-To	Frequency (In a week)	E-Auction catalogue No. E-Auction Start Date & Time
1	FSLR 12275	3.9	PRYJ-NDLS	03 DAYS	PRYJ-PRCL-



AMITY UNIVERSITY - CONFERENCE

Amity Institute of Public Health and Hospital Administration (AIPH&HA) and CAHO hosted the 5th National Student Annual Knowledge Sharing Conference (SAKCON-2026) on September 11–12, 2026. Themed “Human-Centered Quality Care with Digital Health and AI for Viksit Bharat,” the event brought together 320+ delegates from 30+ institutions and 700+ participants across eight pre-conference programmes. The conference featured workshops at leading Delhi-NCR hospitals, combining expert sessions with guided visits. Keynote speaker Prof. (Dr.) Vikram Datta highlighted integrating AI with compassionate care, while CAHO President Emeritus Dr. Vijay Agarwal stressed quality improvement and patient safety. Sessions spanned technology-driven safety, responsible AI, and healthcare policy, encouraging students to shape India’s patient-centric healthcare system.



GLBITM - ACHIEVEMENT

GL Bajaj Institute of Technology & Management celebrated the achievement of fourth-year B.Tech CSE student Mridul Singh Soam, who secured Second Runner-Up at the Women Who Master Hackathon 2026, a Guinness World Record-breaking women-only Generative AI hackathon. Organised by Aspire For Her and Logitech, the event received over 129,000 applications, with 1,712 participants contributing to the record across multiple venues. Among 115 finalists at the Grand Finale at Logitech headquarters, Mridul demonstrated creativity, technical expertise and problem-solving skills. GL Bajaj Vice Chairman Pankaj Agarwal and CEO Kartikay Agarwal congratulated Mridul, highlighting the importance of innovation, practical learning and future-ready skills. The achievement reflects GLBITM’s commitment to technology-driven competitions, industry exposure and nurturing student innovation.



HRIT UNIVERSITY - SEMINAR

It organised a guidance seminar in collaboration with Six Sigma IAS Academy to help students prepare for UPSC Civil Services and other competitive examinations alongside graduation. The programme was held under the guidance of Chancellor Dr. Anil Agarwal, VC Prof. (Dr.) D. K. Sharma, Dean Academics Prof. (Dr.) Anubhav Kumar and Shikha Darbari, IRS, former Chief Commissioner of Income Tax and Founder, Six Sigma IAS Academy. Darbari shared insights on public administration and competitive examinations, encouraging students to begin preparation early through NCERTs, newspapers, current affairs, conceptual learning and regular revision.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



JAMIA HAMDARD - CELEBRATIONS

Jamia Hamdard commemorated the 118th birth anniversary of its founder, Late Hakeem Abdul Hameed Saheb, at Hamdard Convention Centre, New Delhi. Held under the patronage of Chancellor Janab Hammad Ahmed Saheb, the event featured Dr. Sanjay Kumar, Chairman, Agricultural Scientists Recruitment Board, as Chief Guest. The highlight was the Hakeem Abdul Hameed Memorial Lecture 2026 on “Bioresources for a Thriving Bioeconomy: Linking Nature, Science and Livelihoods.” Dr. Kumar highlighted India’s growing bioeconomy and Hakeem Saheb’s vision for humanity, education and scientific advancement. Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) M. Z. Abdin reaffirmed Jamia Hamdard’s commitment to excellence, innovation and social responsibility.



ITS COLLEGE OF HEALTH AND WELLNESS SCIENCES - EVENT

ITS College of Health and Wellness Sciences (ITSCHWS) celebrated World Physiotherapy Day on 8th September with high energy and enthusiasm under the theme “Motion, Mind & Masterpieces.” Bachelor of Physiotherapy (BPT) students showcased their talent across a diverse array of competitive events, blending healthcare awareness with artistic expression. The day featured spirited intellectual debates during an Extempore competition, alongside creative contests including Face Painting, Jute Bag Painting, Digital Poster Making, and a “Best Out of Waste” initiative. Students also demonstrated their versatility in a Short Reel Screening and a fireless culinary showcase, “Cooking Without Fire.” The vibrant event highlighted not only the academic dedication of future physiotherapists but also their creative ingenuity and community spirit.



SARLA CHOPRA D.A.V. PUBLIC SCHOOL, NOIDA - ORIENTATION

The school organised a Parent Orientation Session under Project MATE (Mind Activation Through Education) to sensitise parents about its objectives, significance and implementation. The session featured Dr. Nand Kumar, Professor, Department of Psychiatry, AIIMS, New Delhi, alongside Dr. Deepika Dahima and Ms. Priyanka Tandon. The resource persons highlighted mental health, emotional well-being and holistic child development, emphasising supportive family and school environments. Parents actively participated, sharing concerns and queries. The session strengthened collaboration among parents, the school and mental-health professionals.



LBSIM - LEADERSHIP DELEGATION

Lal Bahadur Shastri Institute of Management (LBSIM), Delhi, an AACSB International-accredited business school, hosted a leadership delegation from AACSB International, led by Ms. Lily Bi, President and CEO. The delegation included Dr. Geoff Perry, Prof. Eileen McAuliffe, Mr. Prathap Das and Ms. Uma Maruthan. They were welcomed by Shri Anil Shastri, Chairman, Board of Governors, and Prof. Praveen Gupta, Director, LBSIM. Shri Anil Shastri acknowledged AACSB’s continued mentorship, while Prof. Gupta described the accreditation as a “monumental validation” of LBSIM’s mission, placing it among India’s 30 AACSB-accredited business schools. Ms. Bi congratulated LBSIM and urged students to develop knowledge, ability, resilience and the right mindset. The visit concluded with a tree plantation.



AJAY KUMAR GARG ENGINEERING COLLEGE - CONFERENCE

The 1st International Conference on Innovations in Electronics, Communication and Computing Techniques (IEC2T-2026) commenced at AKGEC, Ghaziabad. Co-sponsored by the IEEE U.P. Section, the two-day physical event selected the top 10% of over 1,200 submitted research papers across seven technical tracks. The inauguration featured Chief Guest Prof. S. N. Singh (Director, ABV-ITM Gwalior), Guests of Honour Dr. P. C. Panchariya (CSIR-CERI) and Mr. Jitender Garg (BSNL), alongside AKGEC Director Dr. Hemant Ahuja and General Chair Dr. Neelesh Kumar Gupta. Day one featured keynotes by Mr. Preet Yadav (NXP Semiconductors) and Mr. Pawan Chhabra (Intel, USA), alongside parallel technical sessions and an IEEE student poster competition. The event is led by Dr. Gupta, Conference Chair Dr. Himani Garg, and Organizing Chair Dr. Naresh Kumar.

LOTUS VALLEY INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL- SCHOOL CONNECT

Education must go beyond academic achievement. It must nurture values, character, life skills and emotional well-being. As children enter middle school and navigate the transition into adolescence, they seek greater independence while facing new emotional, social and digital influences. This often brings concerns around discipline, declining life skills, excessive screen exposure, distractions and communication. A thought-provoking question for every parent is: “Who do you want your child to become?” The answer lies in a strong home–school partnership built on:

- Clear and consistent boundaries
- Punctuality, discipline and responsibility
- Respect for school identity and values
- Age-appropriate guidance on relationships and digital behaviour
- A nurturing environment where children feel heard and valued
- Parents who model the values they expect from their children
- Consistent reinforcement of positive behaviour at home and school

When school and home speak the same language of values, accountability and empathy, children are better equipped to grow into confident, responsible and compassionate individuals. Academic success matters—but the person a child becomes matters even more. So let’s join our hands as together we can and together we will make a difference.

–Written by Neerja Rishi

TRANSPORT DEPARTMENT, HARYANA

Office of The Transport Commissioner, Haryana

30 Bays Building, 2nd Floor, Sector-17 B, Chandigarh-160017

e-mail: stcharyana@hry.nic.in

Ph.: 0172-2784359

PUBLIC NOTICE

SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF ANPR CAMERAS

Transport Department, Haryana has invited e-tenders through GEM Portal for Supply, Installation & Commissioning of 600 Integrated Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) Cameras as per CAQM direction no. 101 at the fuel stations in four NCR districts, namely Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonapat and Jhajjar.

All concerned are requested to offer their competitive bids through GEM portal (<https://gem.gov.in>) (Bid No: GEM/2026/B/8051179) positively. Last date to apply is 05.10.2026 upto 09:00 A.M.

-sd-
Transport Commissioner,
Haryana, Chandigarh

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

VISAKHAPATNAM

Short Tender Notice No.51/2026-27/SE (W-East)/EE-East / DB/GVMC/ Dt.17-09-2026

01. No. of Works : 1 No

02. Value of works (ECV) : Rs.53.91 Lakhs

03. Downloading Starting Date : 17-09-2026 @ 11.00 PM

04. Downloading End Date : 25-09-2026 @ 02.00 PM

05. Last date for Submission of bid : 25-09-2026 @ 03.00 PM

Further details at <http://www.appeprocurement.gov.in>

O/o The Executive Engineer (PW-III) Division Sd/- Commissioner, GVMC

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, सैची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना

नाम—सफीउल्लाह अंसारी,
उम्र—26 वर्ष,
उँचाई—5 फीट 2 ईंच,
रंग—सॉबला,
पहनावा—सफेद रंग का
कुल शर्ट एवं नीला रंग
का जींस पहने हुए है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता व्यक्ति कहीं मिलता / दिखता है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolice.gov.in)
पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, मु०, द्वितीय, सैची। —9431706142
थाना प्रभारी, नगड़ी, सैची। —9431706176
आवेदक महबुल अंसारी। —6201360516

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
सैची

Government of Jharkhand

Department of Mines & Geology

Directorate of Geology

Engineer's Hostel No-2, 2nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi

NIT No- 02/2026-27

S. No.	Particulars	Information
1.	Name of work	Supply of a Press Palette Machine. Director, Geology; Directorate of Geology, Department of Mines & Geology, Government of Jharkhand; Engineers' Hostel No-2, 2 nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004; E-mail ID: dir-geology@jharkhandmail.gov.in
2.	Contact Person and Address for Communication	
3.	Cost of NIT	NIL
4.	Validity of the Rate/Price Offered by the Bidders	180 days
5.	Tender publication date	18.09.2026
6.	Last date of submission of Bids/NIT	05.10.2026 till 01:00 PM
7.	Bid/NIT opening date	05.10.2026 up to 03:30 PM.
8.	Period of issue of NIT	18.09.2026 to 05.10.2026
9.	Mode of Bid submission	The bid must be submitted through the Speed post/Registered post in a sealed envelope clearly mentioning the NIT reference number and the subject matter on the sealed envelope.
10.	Address of Bid submission	Directorate of Geology, Engineers' Hostel No-2, 2 nd Floor, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand, PIN-834004 Sd/- Director, Geology Directorate of Geology, Department of Mines & Geology, Government of Jharkhand

PR.NO.390083 Mines and Geology(26-27):D

Purvanchal Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd.,

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MM-II)

Vidyt Nagar, BLW, Varanasi

E-Tender Notice

Tender Number and Brief Distribution of Work

1. EAV-64/2026-27, Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Maintenance of Smoke Detector and Fire Alarm at various store centres under PuVVNL Varanasi.

Tender Fee: Rs. 3540.00, Earnest Money: Rs. 20,900.00

Last date & Time for submission of tender document: 12, October 2026, 15:00 Hrs

Further details and all other information can be seen at website www.etender.up.nic.in

Sd/-
(Avinash Gupta)
Superintending Engineer (MM-II)
पत्रक 1487/पुर्वोचलविद्युत निगम (बो) /सां०प्र०-द्वितीय / विद्युतन दिनांक: 19/09/2026

इण्डियन ओवरसीज बैंक Indian Overseas Bank

Regional Office : Building No. 80, First Floor, Near BSNL Office, Tejgarhi Crossing, Meerut -250005

CORRIGENDUM

SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

The sale notice, for sale of immovable properties of Sl. No. 2. Branch: Amroha, Borrower: Aslam & Mohd Ashmad, Sl. No. 6. Branch: Chakrata Road, Borrower: Mohammad Javed S/o Mohd Sharafat, Sl. No. 8. Branch: Najibabad, Borrower: M/s Pure Spice Foods, Sl. No. 12. Branch: Police Line, Borrower: Mr. Sanjay Tyagi, Sl. No. 13. Branch: Saharanpur Main, Borrower: Pritam Singh & Susheela Devi, Sl. No. 15. Branch: Saharanpur Main, Borrower: Mr. Ashraf S/o Shri Abdul Shakoor & Sl. No. 18. Branch: SME Saharanpur, Borrower: Ajay Disawar was published on 06.09.2026 in Indian Express (Delhi edition) under Sarfaesi act. The e-auction Dated 24.09.2026 for the aforesaid Property stands cancelled. The other terms and conditions will remain the same.

Date: 19.09.2026 Place: Meerut

Authorized Officer,
Indian Overseas Bank

कार्यपालक अभियंत का कार्यालय

राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, सैची

Very Short, e-Procurement Notice

ई-निविदा सं०- राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, सैची / सैची 35 / 2026-27, दिनांक :

क्रम सं०	योजना का नाम	प्राकलित राशि / प्रशासनिक रीकृति की राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	यंत्र सयंत्र का स्वामित्व
1	बुण्डू प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत सुमानडीह पंचायत के ग्राम-बुढाडीह में आदिवासी संस्कृति एवं कला केन्द्र / धुमकुडिया भवन निर्माण।	2,49,65,700/-	5,00,000/-	10,000/-	12 Months	कार्य के अनुरूप
2	बुण्डू प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत तैजु पंचायत के ग्राम- आमजोड़ा में आदिवासी संस्कृति एवं कला केन्द्र / धुमकुडिया भवन निर्माण।	2,49,65,700/-	5,00,000/-	10,000/-	12 Months	कार्य के अनुरूप

5. Mode of Submission of tender

6. Date of Publication of Tender on Website

5. Bids online Submission

6. Technical Bid Opening Date

Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Start Date 21.09.2026 to 11.00 AM

End Date 29/09/2026 up to : 2.00 PM

Start Date 21.09.2026 Time : 11.00 AM

End Date 29/09/2026 Time : 11.00 AM

Date 30/09/2026 Time : 11.00 AM

कार्यपालक अभियंता

राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, सैची

Address : कार्यपालक अभियंता

राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, सैची

कार्यपालक अभियंता

राष्ट्रीय ग्रामीण नियोजन कार्यक्रम, सैची

PR 390151 NREP(26-27)#D

ଓଡିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ ଶକ୍ତି

ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ ନିଗମ लि०

(ଓଡିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)

Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Jangpah, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007

ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)

E-TCN NO.-CPC-67/2026-27: OPTCL invites bids from the interested bidders for Conversion of existing 03 nos Conventional Grid Sub-station at Cuttack, Bhanjanagar & Thiruvali into SAS-enabled Sub-station through installation of Kiosk-Based Automation System and provision of switchyard equipment for one no. incomplete tie bay at Thiruvali GSS. The estimate cost of the project is **Rs. 92.74,28,746/-**. For details, visit OPTCL's official website <http://www.optcl.co.in> and www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL.

FW-CA-109/IAD/2026-27/1055: OPTCL invites Profiles from the Chartered Accountants/ Cost Accountants Firms for conducting Internal Audit/ Physical Verification of Fixed Assets and Materilas at Site at various offices of OPTCL all over Odisha for the financial year 2026-27 onwards. The last date for submission of application/profile is **25.09.2026**. For details, visit our website <http://www.optcl.co.in>.

HIPIR-58/2026-27

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical/General), North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites Online (E-Tendering) "Open Tenders" for the following work, S.N. 1. Tender Reference No: E-Tender-L-31-26-27; Name of work: Electrical work connection to modification of inspection Bay and creation of maintenance pits, construction of lab building, wheel parking shed and other facilities at Electric Loco Shed (ELS)/Saipdur Bhilri.; Approx. Cost (in ₹): ₹42,17,553.28; Earnest money (in ₹): ₹84,400/-; Completion Period: 04 Months; Date & time of Closing Tender: 13.10.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; Date & time of Opening Tender: 13.10.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; S.N. 2. Tender Reference No: E-Tender-L-32-26-27; Name of work: Electrical work connection to 1. Additional work of DEOS station under ABSS. 2. Additional work of BTT station under ABSS. 3. Provision of Foot over Bridge (6.0m wide) at CPJ. 4. Provision of store room at LJ and JGP, KKT & SSU, New waiting hall at TRJ and miscellaneous work at KKT. 5. Provision of Interlocking LC gates irrespective of TVU on account of Restricted visibility of BSB Division with RTU & Power Supply arrangement (Total 08 No. LC). 6. Provision of Interlocking of LC gates having more than 50000 TVU in BSB Division with RTU & Power Supply arrangement (SQW-RTU-35 Spl & POU-KKT-64 Spl) (Total 02 Nos. LC). Approx. Cost (in ₹): ₹1,22,09,011.60; Earnest money (in ₹): ₹2,44,200/-; Completion Period: 06 Months; Date & time of Closing Tender: 13.10.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; Date & time of Opening Tender: 13.10.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; For full details of above E-Tender work and to participate in tenders please visit Indian Railway website www.irops.gov.in

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ CPRO/EL-190 General, Varanasi

DO NOT SMOKE BID/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

BRIDGE

DEALER: East		VULNERABLE: None	
NORTH		SOUTH	
♠ K 5 4		♠ A Q J 3	
♥ 8 7		♥ A K J 10 9 4	
♦ K 10 8 6		♦ —	
♣ K 7 6 5		♣ 4 3 2	
SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
—	—	—	pass
1 ♥	pass	1 NT	pass
3 ♥	pass	3 ♥	pass
pass	pass	—	—

West leads the queen of clubs, which holds, then the jack of clubs, which also holds, and the ten of clubs: king, ace, small. East switches to the queen of diamonds. Plan the play.

With five trumps to the queen missing and only two trumps in the dummy, taking two finesses against the queen is a better percentage play than first cashing one high trump and playing only one finesse. If the missing hearts divide four-one, there is a much better chance of finding South with a singleton six, five, three or two, than with specifically a singleton queen.

WEST HAND ♠ 9 8 7 2 ♥ 2 ♦ A 9 5 3 2 ♣ Q J 10
EAST HAND ♠ 10 6 ♥ Q 6 5 3 ♦ Q J 7 4 ♠ A 9 8

The third possibility, cashing the ace and king in the hope that the queen is singleton or doubleton, is also an inferior play, "eight ever, nine never." To prepare for the possibility of repeating the trump finesse, South must trump the queen of diamonds lead with the jack, ten or nine of hearts. With only one entry to dummy, he must be able to retain the lead in dummy after the first heart finesse (by playing his four under the seven or eight), so he will retain the lead in dummy, to take the finesse again. Try this small slam in spades.

DEALER: East VULNERABLE: North/South

NORTH		SOUTH	
♠ J 5 3		♠ A K 10 9 8 7 6	
♥ 9 7 3		♥ A K 8	
♦ A 10 2		♦ K 9 5	
♣ K Q 7 3		♣ —	
SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
—	—	5 NT	pass
5 ♣	—	—	—
6 ♣	pass	pass	pass

West leads the heart queen. Plan the play (trumps break 3-0).

SUNDAY CROSSWORD

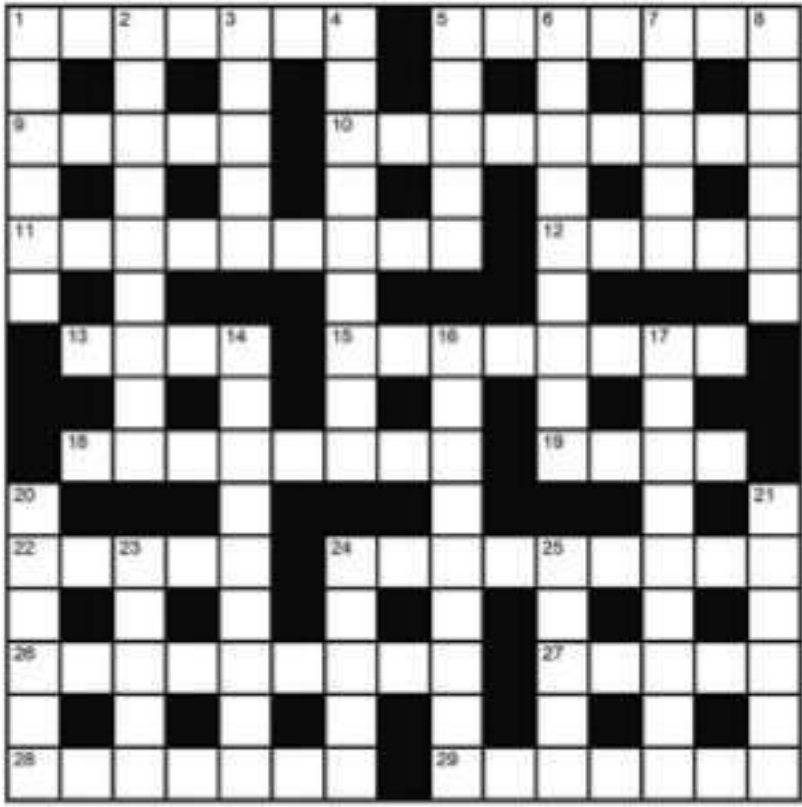
QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

- 1. A small weapon (7)
- 5. Wasted time (7)
- 9. Form of speech (5)
- 10. Articles written to refute previous written material (9)
- 11. Excessively dramatic behaviour (9)
- 12. Garden flowers (5)
- 13. Headwear (4)
- 15. Strive (US) (8)
- 18. Rock fragments (8)
- 19. English batsman ____ Morgan (4)
- 22. 'Wednesday's child is full ____' (2,3)
- 24. Capital of Sweden (9)
- 26. Being hypocritical (9)
- 27. Disguises (5)
- 28. Advise (7)
- 29. Wandered away (7)

DOWN

- 1. Swoons (6)
- 2. Repeat (9)
- 3. Acknowledge (5)
- 4. Hilarious mirth (9)
- 5. Sums owing (5)
- 6. The scandal which rocked Richard Nixon's government (9)
- 7. Seeps or oozes out (5)
- 8. Refrain, abstain or halt (6)
- 14. NCOs bearing three stripes? (9)
- 16. Detects (9)
- 17. Grimly (9)
- 20. Group of astrological signs (6)



- 21. Entertained (6)
- 23. Chinese martial arts (5)
- 24. Bulge (5)
- 25. Inhabitant of Cambodia (5)

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS

- 1. He puts on beads and then cuts them off? (7)
- 5. Kids' swabs getting dear (7)
- 9. Rather cold to have the cover in the end (5)
- 10. Ruling houses on the day lose heart at many unpleasant things (9)
- 11. Concerning split in outwardly free American public votes (9)
- 12. Keep back a missing

- ingredient for gunpowder (5)
- 13. Document inscribed with number missing (4)
- 15. Not, we understand, where generals die! (2,6)
- 18. Showed indifference as second husband gets rough (8)
- 19. All the time you're given (4)
- 22. Scope for a qualified man in the island (5)
- 24. Make situation worse for a Girl Guide initially, Virginia, in class (9)
- 26. Sugar and meat may be mixed into cattle-feed (9)
- 27. Musical instruments confusing old Bose (5)

SOLUTIONS TO 2599 QUICK CLUES ACROSS: 1 Catacomb, 5 Step up, 9 Infinity, 10 Agadir, 12 Blessings, 13 Tuned, 14 Wage, 16 Yanking, 19 Queried, 21 Alda, 24 Again, 25 Rationale, 27 Drones, 28 Reindeer, 29 Rebate, 30 Asperses DOWN: 1 Climbs, 2 Toffee, 3 Cents, 4 Matinee, 6 Tightened, 7 Pedantic, 8 Paradigm, 11 spy, 15 Alignment, 17 Squander, 18 Hecatomb, 20 Dara, 21 Aptness, 22 Havens, 23 Learns, 26 Ounce CRYPTIC CLUES ACROSS: 1 Grenades, 5 Ad libs, 9 At a pinch, 10 Take to, 12 Posthaste, 13 Halts, 14 Bird, 16 Bylines, 19 Evictor, 21 Envy, 24 Algae, 25 A dog's life, 27 Lentil, 28 Hara-kiri, 29 Cracks, 30 Sponging DOWN: 1 Grasps, 2 Elapse, 3 Amish, 4 Encased, 6 Diaghilev, 7 Ice plant, 8 Scorsese, 11 Beeb, 15 In the pink, 17 Metallic, 18 Virginia, 20 Road, 21 Exocarp, 22 Bikini, 23 Peking, 26 Swain

2600

IF IT'S YOUR BIRTHDAY

SUNDAY SEPTEMBER 20:

Socialise and enjoy life this year. Nurture the happiness and beauty within. Let your guard down. Old friends might reappear.

MONDAY SEPTEMBER 21:

This is a year about creating solid foundations in your life. Simplicity is key. Take charge of your health. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

TUESDAY SEPTEMBER 22:

This year is about exciting changes and increased personal freedom. Let go of whatever is impeding your growth. Seek out new opportunities and be ready to act fast.

WEDNESDAY SEPTEMBER 23:

This is a year of service for you, perhaps service to family. Take care of yourself so that you can be a resource to those who turn to you for comfort and courage.

THURSDAY SEPTEMBER 24:

This is a year of learning and teaching. Make time to renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that give you better self-awareness and get you closer to the meaning of your life.

FRIDAY SEPTEMBER 25:

This year you reap the benefits of all your hard work. Expect power and leadership. It's a time for major decisions. Promotions, kudos and awards might come your way.

SATURDAY SEPTEMBER 26:

This year take inventory of your life and let go of the people, places and things that hold you back. Do some internal and external housecleaning.

YOUR WEEK AHEAD



ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Be aware that people notice you, and some even know personal details about your private life. Think about this in case you have to do some damage control. This is a relaxed day, and a chatty one. This Week: Listen to partners and close friends.



TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Do something different today. Don't be too ambitious. Talk to people you encounter casually. Try to learn something new. This will please you. This Week: Getting better organised will make you feel good.



GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is the perfect day to relax at home. Enjoy mental games, puzzles and mysteries to occupy your time. If you're working, co-workers will be supportive. This Week: Make time to play and have fun.



CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today you have to go more than halfway when dealing with others because the Moon is opposite your sign. In two weeks, people will have to go more than halfway when dealing with you. This Week: Family discussions and home repairs need your attention.



LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today you'll find it to be personally rewarding if you can help someone. You're big-hearted and generous by nature, which means helping others makes you feel good. This Week: Enjoy short trips. Learn something new.



VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a fortunate day for you. Take it easy. Enjoy chatting with others, as well as checking out sports, the arts, movies and the theater. This Week: Figure out what you owe and what you own.



LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Welcome a chance to relax at home among familiar surroundings today. With Mercury in your sign, an interesting conversation with someone will entertain you. This Week: Enjoy shopping for pretty things.



SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today you have a strong desire to express yourself or share your ideas with someone, which is why you need to find someone who is willing to listen to you. You want to discuss something that's meaningful. This Week: Relax. People find you charming and diplomatic.



SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You might be thinking of making a purchase. On a more subtle level, you're thinking about your values and what it is that makes you happy. What do you want to do with the rest of your life? This Week: You're popular. Enjoy being with younger people.



CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today the Moon is in your sign, which gives you a slight advantage over all the other signs. It means you can ask the universe for a favour. If there is something you want, make an effort to get it or to ask someone for help. This Week: You impress people.



AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Take it easy today. Someone might ask for your advice. If you can help, you will. If not, don't worry about it. This Week: Travel or explore your own backyard.



PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is the classic day for a heart-to-heart discussion with a friend. You might share your hopes and dreams for the future. This could be an opportunity to get feedback from someone else about what you want to do. This Week: Organise your finances.

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT e-Procurement Notice NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

1. The Executive Engineer, Shimla Rural Division, HPPWD, Dhani on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the percentage rates bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of Contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table as under:

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost Excluding GST (in Rs.)	EMD (in Rs.)	Cost of Tender	Time
1	R/R damages on Tutikandi Shilgaon road km. 0/00 to 3/870 & Badhai to Ghanti road km. 0/00 to 0/430 (SH:- Repair of pot holes 2/00 to 3/870 & 0/00 to 0/430).	22,36,675/-	44,700/-	500/-	Fifteen Days
2	R/R damages on Shoghi Dhari road km. 0/00 to 6/150 (Sh:- providing & Laying Bitumen penetration macadam in between km. 0/00 to 2/00).	14,63,134/-	29,300/-	500/-	Fifteen Days
3	R/R damages on Sandhoth Kakrate road km. 0/00 to 2/200(SH:- P/L bitumen penetration macadam in between km. 0/00 to 1/00)	9,16,493/-	18,300/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
4	R/R damages on Link road to Village Ranghav km. 0/00 to 0/430(Sh:- P/L bitumen penetration in between km. 0/00 to 0/430).	7,77,630/-	13,600/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
5	R/R damages on Shoghi Salana road km. 0/00 to 8/00(SH:- P/L bitumen penetration macadam in between km. 3/00 to 5/00).	7,41,898/-	14,800/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
6	R/R damages on Tara Devi Gumber road km. 0/00 to 11/550(SH:- P/L bitumen penetration macadam in between km. 7/00 to 8/00).	6,81,400/-	13,600/-	500/-	Fifteen Days
7	R/R damages on Shakoh to Hanuman Mandir road km. 0/00 to 1/250(SH:- P/L bitumen penetration macadam in between km. 0/00 to 1/250).	5,11,050/-	10,200/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
8	R/R damages on Tara Devi Gumber road km. 0/00 to 11/550(SH:- Providing with WBM G-III in km. 10/500 to 11/500).	1,47,591/-	3000/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
9	Annual Surfacing on various roads under Sub Division Sunni (SH:- (i) Providing and Laying 30 mm thick Bituminous Concrete in Shimla Mandi Road km. 23/00 to 24/00, 32/00 to 33/00 & 39/200 to 41/00 (ii) Providing and Laying 25 mm thick BC in link road to Ghani km. 2/00 to 3/00 and link road to village Annu in km. 2/00 to 4/00) under AMP 2026-27 Addl. Kms.	1,57,39,202/-	314800/-	5000/-	Fifteen Days
10	R/R damages on various Roads under Sunni Sub Division (SH:- Repair of patch work by P/L WBM G-III & Bituminous Penetration Macadam in link road to Ghaini km. 2/00 to 3/00 and link road village Annu in km. 2/00 to 4/00).	7,70,508/-	15,500/-	350/-	Fifteen Days
11	Annual Surfacing on link road to Garkhan km. 0/00 to 3/00(SH:- P/L 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete in km. 1/00 to 3/00) Under AMP 2026-27 Addl. Km	33,94,510/-	68,000/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
12	R/R damages on Slapper Tattapani Sunni Luhri road km. 86/00 to 104/00(SH:- P/L G-III, Prime Coat, Tack Coat and 25 mm thick Bituminous concrete for patch work in km. 86/00 to 104/00).	59,63,846	1,19,500/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
13	Annual surfacing on (1) Salaper Tattapani Sunni Luhri road Km 0/00 to 120/800 (Portion Km 86/00 to 104/00) and (ii) Kadharghat Domehar Road Km 0/0 to 5/000 (SII:- Providing and laying Bituminous Concrete along with providing & laying of Hot Applied Thermoplastic compound 2.50 mm thick for edge line on (1) Salaper Tattapani Sunni Luhri road Km 0/00 to 120/800 (Portion Km 86/00 to 104/00) in between Km 86/00 to 88/000, 91/00 to 92/00, 93/000 to 94/000, 97/00 to 98/00 and 99/00 to 100/00)and (ii) Kadharghat Domehar Road Km 0/000 to 5/000 in between Km 1/000 to 2/000) under AMP 2026-27 Addl. Kms.	1,35,53,650/-	2,70,500/-	5000/-	Fifteen Days
14	Annual Surfacing on Dhani Bainsh Road Km. 0/000 to 6/000 (Sh: Providing and laying bitumen penetration macadam, 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete along with P/L of Hot applied thermo plastic compound 2.50 mm thick for edge line in between Km. 4/000 to 6/000) under AMP 2026-27 Additional km	32,99,313	66,000/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
15	Annual Surfacing on various roads under Sub Division Dhani on Thachi Seri Shaili Road Km. 0/000 to 3/825 (Sh. Providing and laying bitumen penetration macadam, 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete along with P/L of Hot applied thermo plastic compound 2.50 mm thick for edge line in between Km. 1/000 to 3/285) and on (1) Rattanpur Bathmana Road Km. 0/000 to 1/600 (Sh: Providing and laying bitumen penetration macadam, 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete along with P/L of Hot applied thermo plastic compound 2.50 mm thick for edge line in between Km. 0/000 to 1/000) under AMP 2026-27 Additional Kms.	64,08,851/-	1,28,500/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
16	Annual Surfacing on Garog Nalta Road Km. 0/000 to 7/000 (SH: Providing and laying bitumen penetration macadam, 25 mm thick Bituminous Concrete along with P/L of Hot applied thermo plastic compound 2.50 mm thick for edge line in between Km. 2/000 to 3/000 & 5/000 to 6/000) under AMP 2026-27 Additional Kms.	32,99,313/-	66000/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
17	Restoration of rain damages on Garog Nalta Road Km. 0/000 to 7/000 (Sh:- Repair of Pot Holes / Patch work at various RDs. in km. 3/000 to 5/000 & 6/00 to 7/000)	14,17,295/-	66000/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days
18	Restoration of rain damages on various Roads under Dhani Sub Division (Sh:- Repair of Pot Holes / Patch work on Galog Halog Road at various RDs. in between Kms. 2/000 to 4/000, 5/000 to 7/000 and 8/000 to 11/135).	32,91,228/-	66000/-	2000/-	Fifteen Days

- 2. The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the departmental website www.hptenders.gov.in.
- 3. Date of online publication 21.09.2026 and last date of online submission through e- tendering on 28.09.2026 and the bid shall be opened on 29.09.2026.
- 4. All the required material like Cement/Steel/Bitumen/Explosive etc. shall be arranged by contractor at his own level.
- 5. The competent authority reserves the right to cancel/extend any or all the tender without assigning any reason thereof.

Executive Engineer, Shimla Rural Division H.P.P.W.D. Dhani on behalf of Governor of H.P.

UJVNL LTD.
H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR200619GCO25966, Website : www.ujvnl.com

Letter No 825 e-Tender Notice Dated 18.09.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), UJVNL, Pashulok Barrage Rishikesh invites online bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below: -

Tender No. 15/2026-27/EE (Civil)/UJVNL/Pashulok Barrage.

Name of work : Rehabilitation of Protection Works of Bin Super Passage at Power Channel of Chilla HEP.

Estimated cost : Rs. 1,11,59,849.19 Only (GST Extra).

Date of availability of bid document on website: From 13:00 hrs of 18.09.2026.

Last date for submission of bids on website : Upto 13:00 hrs of 09.10.2026.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal ["https://uktenders.gov.in"](https://uktenders.gov.in) Executive Engineer (Civil) Pashulok Barrage, Rishikesh.

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTHERN RAILWAY

e -AUCTION NOTICE NO. 'November-2026'

E-Auction will be conducted for disposal of Ferrous Scrap, Non Ferrous Scrap, Other Misc Scrap, Condemned Loco, Coaches and Wagons, Scrap Rail and other Scrap P.Way material etc.. Used Lead Acid Batteries/Used Oil/Refused Oil etc. will be sold only to recyclers registered with State Pollution Control Board. Auction programme is as under.

e -AUCTION date for November-2026'

S N	Depot/Division Auction Conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1st round date	2nd round date	3rd round date	4th round date	5th round date	6th round date	7th round date
1.	Dy.CMM/AMV 0522-2451257	10:30 AM	5	10	13	18	23	26	30
2.	Dy.CMM/SSB 011-27015387	10:30 AM	6	12	17	20	26	--	--
3.	Dy.CMM/JUDW 01732-252388	10:30 AM	5	12	17	20	26	--	--
4.	Sr.DMM/DLI 011-23365311	10:30 AM	6	13	18	23	26	--	--
5.	Sr.DMM/UMB 0171-2611203	10:30 AM	6	12	19	23	27	--	--
6.	Sr.DMM/FZR 01632-244154	10:30 AM	6	13	18	23	26	--	--
7.	Sr.DMM/LKO 0522-2234756	10:30 AM	5	12	18	23	27	--	--
8.	Sr.DMM/MB 0591-2413141	10:30 AM	5	12	18	23	27	--	--
9.	Sr.DMM/UAT	10:30 AM	10	16	19	23	27	--	--

Note: 1. The details of item to be sold in auction will be available in catalogue at www.ireps.gov.in. 2. The intending purchasers may inspect the scrap material before the auction during working hours at nominated locations. 3. To participate in e-auction, purchasers need to get themselves registered with ireps. The details on last sold rates in auctions are available at www.railnet.gov.in. 4. For further details regarding registration and other conditions of e-auction, please visit Railway website 'www.ireps.gov.in'. No. 117-S/Sale/Auction Programme/2026-27 Dated: 15.09.2026

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कार्यालय जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू
Email:- zilaparishad.palamu@gmail.com

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना।
ई- संख्या:- DOPR/DE/ZP/Palamu 10/2026-27

विज्ञापन दाता का नाम :- जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू।
Website पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :-दिनांक 25.09.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे)
ई-निविदा प्राप्त करने की तिथि :- दिनांक 25.09.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे) से दिनांक 14.10.2026 (अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक)
निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक 16.10.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे)
निविदा खोलने का स्थान :-कार्यालय जिला परिषद, पलामू।

क्र०	प्रस्तावक	योजना का नाम	प्रामाणिकता राशि	अग्रयन राशि	निविदा शुल्क	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	एन्कआइटीडी रेकॉर्ड सं०	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	पादन किशुनपुर	ग्रामाधिक स्वाम्य कन्द किशुनपुर का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-10/ 2026-27/ Gr-01	
2	घनचूरु तैलाडी	ग्रामाधिक स्वाम्य कन्द तैलाडी का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-10/2026-27/ Gr-02	

नोट- 1. केवल ई-निविदा ही स्वीकार होगे।
2. निविदा डबल बीड पद्धति से होगी।
3. जिला परिषद, पलामू में समुचित श्रेणी में निबंधित संवेदक ही निविदा में भाग ले सकेंगे।
4. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट बड़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
5. निविदा शुल्क (Non Refundable) एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Demand Draft (किसी भी मान्यता प्राप्त बैंक द्वारा निर्मित) जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू (District Engineer, Zila Parishad, Palamu) के पदनाम से डाकदस्तावेज में सुरक्षित होगा, के रूप में स्वीकार्य होगी।

निविदा की तकनीकी एवं सामान्य शर्तें www.palamu.nic.in एवं कार्यालय जिला परिषद, पलामू के सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए Website- www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

PR.NO.390133 District(26-27):D **ह०/** -जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू।

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Kavita, W/o / D/o: Yogesh Singh, R/o: Naina Jat** Gwalior Road Agar (Agra) UP has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 04/2023, Dt. 14.01.2023, U/s: 420/34 IPC, PS: Cyber West, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Kavita**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Kavita**, has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Kavita**, of **FIR No. 04/2023, Dt. 14.01.2023, U/s: 420/34 IPC, PS: Cyber West, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.10.2026**.

By Order
Vasundhra Azad,
Chief Judicial Magistrate
Room No.146
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/13233/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Azad R/o H.No. K**

• BRIEFLY

No ceremonial kit: Toor replaced as flag-bearer

INDIA WAS forced to make a last-minute change in their male flagbearer at the Asian Games opening ceremony, replacing shot putter Tajinderpal Singh Toor with kabaddi player Pawan Sehrawat. The Indian Olympic Association (IOA) confirmed this with a short statement. "Due to technical issues, Tajinderpal Singh Toor will not be able to be India's flagbearer. Pawan Sehrawat will be India's male flagbearer today," Toor was to lead out the Indian contingent at the athletes' parade with shooting star Manu Bhaker later on Saturday. Toor had to be replaced because the shot-putter had not yet received his official ceremonial kit. "I am told that my kit will reach at 3 pm at the (Nagoya) airport. Reaching the opening ceremony venue on time after collecting my kit at the airport will be very difficult. So, I have told IOA that I am not coming for the opening ceremony," Toor told PTI. "My kit is lying in India. Nobody in the athletics team has got their kits so far," the two-time Asian Games gold medalist said. ENS

• TODAY'S PICKS

DAY 2
Teqball: Women's Singles (6:30 AM), Mixed Doubles (7 AM)

● Quimcy Dsouza will have two shots at a medal, with a bronze medal match in singles, followed by mixed doubles with Anas Baig.

Shooting: 10m Rifle Qualification (6:15 AM), Final (11 AM)

● Experienced shooter Elavenni Valarivan will lead India's charge, along with young guns Sonam Maskar and Vidarsa Vinod with individual and team medals on the line.

Women's Cricket Semis: India v Bangladesh (10:30 AM)

● Defending champions India's gold medal quest will see them facing Bangladesh.

Hockey: India vs Uzbekistan (women's, 07:30 AM), India vs Indonesia (men's, 11 AM)

● Both the Indian men's and women's hockey teams will begin their campaigns.

READY, BREATHE, FIRE

India's shooters sharpen their slow breathing, stillness skills

Biofeedback and simulated pressure lie behind a squad hoping to repeat its 22-medal haul from Hangzhou



Mihir Vasavada
Nagoya, September 19

HOLD YOUR breath. India's shooters are doing just that, learning how to slow their breathing, settle their heart-beat and find the few seconds of stillness that could help them produce another big medal haul at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya.

When Sonam Maskar began the final preparations for her Asian Games debut at a camp in Bhopal, the 23-year-old rifle shooter had a belt strapped around her chest and sensors attached to her finger. The chest strap measured her heart rate in real time; the sensors tracked her body temperature, giving the coaches an indication of stress.

"If the heart rate is 100 or more, then the task is to bring it lower and shoot only after that," Maskar, who competes in the 10m event on Sunday, tells *The Indian Express*. Like Maskar, many in the Indian shooting squad are entering new territory in Nagoya. Ten of the 18 rifle and pistol shooters are making their Asian Games debuts. Their preparation, therefore, has gone well beyond putting bullets and pellets through targets.

At the Bhopal camp over the last few weeks, some of the training looked more like a laboratory experiment. Gadgets were attached to their bodies, an app was open on their phones and, while aiming at the target, the shooters could see their breathing, heartbeat and skin temperature changing in real time.

"We are trying to gather more information about the shooters," India's rifle coach Thomas Farnik says. "Some shooters react a little bit too much. All these biofeedback systems that we have, we are trying to make them learn to use their body to react in situations when it is necessary."

“Breathing affects movement. So does the heartbeat. So when you are trying to hit a target from a distance, even movements that are invisible to the naked eye can matter”

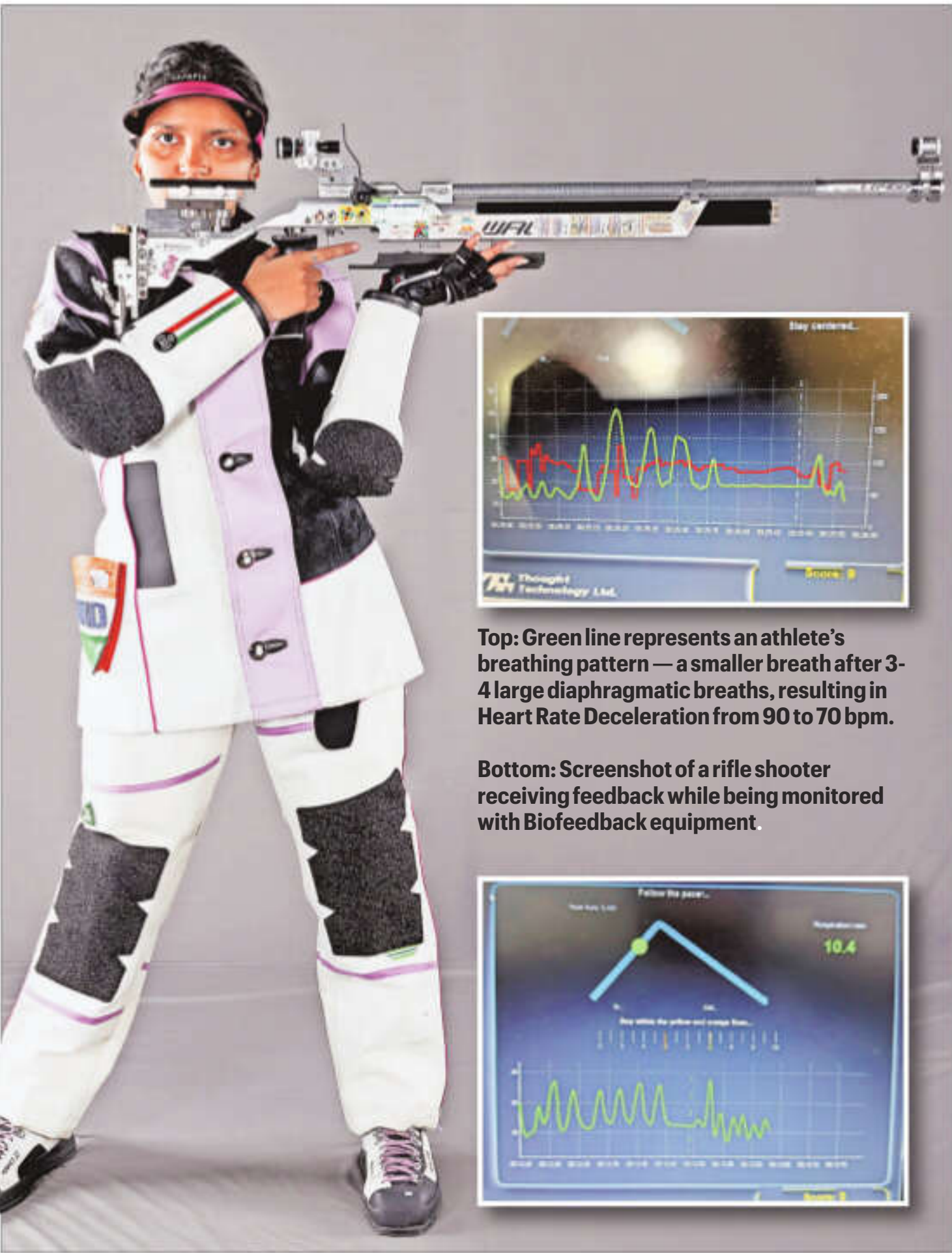
RONAK PANDIT
PISTOL SHOOTING COACH.

Pierre Beauchamp, Indian shooting's high performance director, and the sport psychologists have been working with the rifle and pistol coaches on self-regulation, teaching shooters to deliberately bring their bodies and minds into the state required to execute a shot. Rather than plainly being told to relax, they were being shown what relaxation looked and felt like, so they could learn to find that zone without the gadgets when the competition began.

At one assessment, one shooter was breathing around 10 times a minute during the preparation phase of the shot. The coaches felt that was on the higher side and worked with the shooter to gradually bring it down towards four to six breaths a minute through different breathing techniques.

The reason, pistol shooting high performance coach Ronak Pandit says, is not simply to make the shooter calmer. "Breathing affects movement. So does the heartbeat. So when you are trying to hit a target from a distance, even movements that are invisible to the naked eye can matter," Pandit says.

As breathing becomes more controlled, the heart rate can slow too. In one case, a shooter's heart rate fell from around 80 beats per minute to 60, what Beauchamp calls heart-rate deceleration. Some of India's top shooters can produce a 30-to-40 beat drop during their individual shot cycles. The aim, however, is not to chase the biggest number. "It is important



Shooter Sonam Maskar will be competing in 10m Air Rifle team and individual events on Sunday. NRAI

that it is synchronised with the aiming and triggering process, and that they can do it repeatedly," Pandit says.

Shutting the noise out

That last word, repeatedly, is crucial. A training range in Bhopal is one thing. An Asian Games final is another. So the Bhopal camp tried to recreate some of that pressure too. Trainees from the Madhya Pradesh shooting academy were brought in and asked to make noise around the shooters as they went through simulated final situations. The idea was to force the athletes to shoot through distractions, the sort of noise and commotion that can turn a familiar routine into an uncomfortable

one on competition day. The shooters had to learn to return to the same sequence: control the breathing, settle the heartbeat, find the sight picture and pull the trigger.

Nagoya will bring another layer of pressure. The shooters have already experienced some of the uncertainty of a multi-discipline event, with landing and check-in troubles affecting the Indian contingent. Those troubles continued into Friday, when pistol shooter Rahi Sarnobat reportedly faced the same delays as several of her teammates. At the range, though, the target will look the same. The rifle will feel the same. The mechanics of the shot will not suddenly change. However, the expectations will.

Shooting produced 22 medals for India at the previous Asian Games, including seven gold, and, along with athletics, was one of the two biggest contributors to the country's record 106-medal haul in Hangzhou. If India is to cross 100 medals again in Nagoya, shooting is expected to carry a substantial part of the load. Which is why so much of the preparation has been about mastering what the eye cannot see. There will be no belt around Maskar's chest when she steps onto the range on Sunday. No sensors on her finger. No phone screen showing her heartbeat. No graph telling her whether she has found the right zone. Just a shooter, a target and a final breath. Then the trigger.

Redemption on Bangladesh's agenda, rehearsal on India's

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 19

"SHAFALI VERMA gave us a catch in the second over itself. We did not take that chance, and then she scored all the runs. If we took that catch, maybe the scenario would have been different," said Nigar Sultana Joty, captain of Bangladesh women's cricket team, nine days ago in Dubai. Moments earlier, she had joined the long roll of cricketers who learn, at cruel cost, that cricket deals not in maybes, but in absolutes.

The result might indeed have been different on September 10, had Fahima Khatun clung on to a chance easier than a regulation catch. Reprised on 6, Shafali made Bangladesh pay dearly, blazing a match-winning 64 off 40 balls. Neither did she stop scoring after the reprieve, nor did Bangladesh stop dropping dollops — four more chances would go begging.

The Asian Games may not sit among the high altars of cricketing prestige, but Sunday's semi-final in Nisshin carries layers of subtext. The first is the simplest: Bangladesh seek redemption, while India seek to widen the chasm between themselves and the rest of the subcontinental chasing pack.

For Harmanpreet Kaur's team, it will be the seventh fixture in 22 days. Physical exhaustion, hence, could easily have been a cause of concern, but they have hardly broken a sweat in any of the last six. They arrive on the heels of an eight-wicket rout of hosts Japan, a contest that lasted a mere 149 deliveries.

Considering the dominance

The Asian Games may not sit among the high altars of cricketing prestige, but Sunday's semi-final in Nisshin carries layers of subtext.

they have exerted over their neighbours in the last three weeks, India have little to fear from this fixture, or indeed from the competition as a whole.

And herein lies the second layer of context. In five months, India will host the inaugural Women's Champions Trophy, a 20-over tournament whose field will include Australia and South Africa, both of whom beat them at this year's T20 World Cup. Before that contest, India will have just eight outings in which to settle on their optimal XI: two at the Asian Games and three apiece against Zimbabwe and South Africa.

The frailties, however minute and inconsequential they might seem like at the moment, must hence be reflected upon. On India's wishlist will be — among other things — runs from Bharti Fulmali's bat, and 18-year-old opener Gunalan Kamalini offering a glimpse into her potential.

A third layer, should one be sought, is that the tournament offers both captains a chance to silence their doubters. The clamour for a new leader of the women's team, after all, has echoed on both sides of the border. India stand a couple of steps adrift of retaining their gold medal.

Live on Sony Sports Network from 10:30 AM: India vs Bangladesh women's cricket semi-final



Shafali Verma scored 64 in her last T20I against Bangladesh. CREIMAS

TEQING STRIDES

Teqball: Born out of a footballer's urge to practice, developed with scientist's help

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, September 19

FAR FROM the shooting arenas, wrestling mats, and track and field, it is the sport with a curved table and a football that might deliver India's first medal at the Asian Games.

The sport is Teqball, making its debut at the continental showpiece.

With Quimcy Dsouza in the women's singles bronze medal match, and the pair of Quimcy and Md Anas in the mixed doubles bronze medal match, it is highly likely that India will open its medal count in Aichi-Nagoya with a Teqball medal.

Started in 2012 in Budapest, Hungary, Teqball combines the skills of football with the typical exchange of racquet sports like table tennis. It is played on a curved table with a standard-size football, a rigid net across the middle, and a service line in play. As a sport it is barely a decade old, but it has made big splashes in recent years, entering the 2023 European Games as a medal event before arriving here in Nagoya.

Origins of sport

The sport traces its origin to Budapest, where former professional footballer Gábor Borsányi used to practise passing a football across ordinary concrete table-tennis tables when he couldn't access a football pitch.

"Honestly, if you look at it, Borsanyi converted a backyard



Teqball was the idea of former Hungarian professional footballer Gábor Borsányi. AP

activity into a full-fledged sport which is growing rapidly now," Nihar Shah, technical director of Teqball India, told *The Indian Express* from Japan.

As Borsányi developed the idea, he wanted to make the table curved to keep the bounce and return of the ball consistent. He was joined by computer scientist Viktor Huszár and investor György Gattyán, who helped develop the concept further. The first public video of Teqball was released on the opening day of the 2014 FIFA World Cup, and as stars like Ronaldinho started playing it, the sport began to draw attention.

Simple rules

Much of its growth traces

back to how simple the rules are. "You have to think of it as table tennis with a football," Nihar said.

"The rules are very simple. There is a service line from where the athlete has to serve, and every athlete has two chances to serve, like tennis."

Matches are played best of three sets, with 12 points needed to win a set. "The athletes have to use their head, legs and body, all the body parts used in football," Nihar said.

"Every athlete gets three touches to return the ball, and the third touch has to send it back, in both singles and doubles." In doubles, the ball must be passed to a partner at least once, and players can't use

the same body part twice in a row to control or return it.

The sport's spread hasn't relied only on competition. Social media videos have helped, as has the fact that clubs like Chelsea, Real Madrid, Barcelona and Arsenal now use it for recreation and sometimes training. Teqball India, the body responsible for growing the sport domestically, has been at it for seven years.

"As Teqball India, we started back in 2019, but Covid-19 hit and we were sort of restricted in terms of growth," Nihar said. "However, after 2022, the sport has grown steadily. The athletes have participated at the world level and are winning at events like world championships."

From avidly watching Ronaldinho's reels, Quimcy stands on the cusp of Asiad medal

Mihir Vasavada
Nagoya, September 19

QUIMCY D'SOUZA stood distraught after the final point. She had just lost a close Asian Games semifinal to Indonesia's Sumaya, despite coming within five points of a place in the final, leading 7-4 in the decider. Just then, Sumaya took a time out, the momentum swung in those seconds, and the 24-year-old Indian conceded eight straight points before losing 12-7, 9-12, 7-12 at the Nagoya City Higashi Sports Centre.

The disappointment of missing out on a final lingered. But she hasn't run out of chances. D'Souza has two opportunities to win a bronze medal on Sunday, in singles and mixed doubles. And there is something remarkable about the fact that she is here at all.

Four years ago, D'Souza was not a teqball player. Almost nobody in India was. Today, she is one of around 180 registered Indian players, representing the country at the Asian Games in one of the sport's first appearances on the continent's biggest sporting stage. "I always wanted to play for India," she says. "That has always been my dream, no matter which sport."

It could have been athletics. D'Souza ran the 1500m and 3000m at state level before turning to football, representing Maharashtra. Then, while recovering from a ligament injury, she found something unexpected on Instagram. "I was



Quimcy D'Souza started playing teqball four years ago. AINAGOC

scrolling and watched Ronaldinho play teqball," she says. She tried it. "From day one, I fell in love with the sport. I thought it was for me."

There was another sign. The teqball logo has a Q in it. "Teqball's logo, the Q, is what I feel is Quimcy," she says. "So I think the sport is for me and I want to keep going."

A couple of friends in Mumbai had found a club. D'Souza got in touch and a small group began playing. There was no established Indian pathway, no professional ecosystem and no guarantee that the sport would take them anywhere.

Covid disrupted its early growth. It was only around 2022 that the Indian group began to build in earnest.

Since then, they have largely built it themselves. "For the last four years, we've not been funded," D'Souza says. "We're paying for tournaments, we work full time, and then we save that money up for tournaments."

Unconventional route

The three Indians in Nagoya — D'Souza, Mohamed Anas Imran Beg and Declan Goncalves — are not products of a conventional professional sporting system. They are part-time athletes with full-time lives. D'Souza works as a test engineer at Decathlon in Bengaluru; her teammates have their own careers. They train, compete and help build the sport around their jobs.

Sepak takraw connect

Indonesia has a natural advantage India does not: sepak takraw. The sports are different, but the crossover is obvious. Teqball is a game of touch and control, with players using their feet, thighs, chest and head to manipulate a ball on a curved table. Sepak takraw players spend years developing precisely those instincts. "Sepak Takraw already gives you the touch," D'Souza says. "They have better touches and better outlooks. But I think, like I said before, the game doesn't matter. We are here by our own."

Chess Oly: Gukesh helps sustain Open winning streak; women beat Mongolia



D Gukesh continued to play on board 4 at Chess Olympiad. FIDE

Mayank Chaudhary
New Delhi, September 19

WHEN D Gukesh last faced Alexei Shirov in classical chess in 2022, he was closing in on the 2700 rating mark. Four years on, Gukesh is still hovering around that same number, but his world has changed beyond recognition. Since then, he has won two individual Olympiad gold medals, led India to a bronze and a maiden gold in the same team event, become the youngest-ever Candidates winner and the youngest-ever world champion, and touched a peak rating of 2794 before sliding back down.

What has not changed is his result against the Spanish veteran. Gukesh had outsmarted a creative genius in Shirov at the 2022 Chess Olympiad in Mahablipuram. He has repeated the feat in Samarkand at the ongoing 46th edition — only this time, his win was far more convincing. For his third win in four rounds, Gukesh continued to vindicate his status as India's biggest weapon in team events, as their winning streak persisted, with a dominant 3.0-1.0 victory over Spain on Saturday. Arjun Erigaisi also returned to winning ways.

Both Gukesh and Shirov had led their respective teams on Board 1 the last time they faced off. In Samarkand, with age catching up with the Spaniard and Gukesh fighting a lean patch, both players found themselves on lower boards.

With the white pieces, Gukesh secured a free-flowing position in the Sicilian Defence, even though it meant spending more time on the clock initially. Despite the inferior clock, Gukesh always had a fighting position favouring his light pieces.

With his king nestled safely after a kingside castle and his queen running down an open black king, the pressure kept mounting on Shirov, even though the Spaniard enjoyed a time edge. As the clock ran down, Gukesh produced immaculate moves to tie up Shirov's pieces. The 20-year-old played several "only-playable" moves to keep the heat on.

Soon, Gukesh went up an exchange and once the queens were traded, he was left with an extra pawn and a stronger rook-knight duo against the Spaniard's bishop pair. Shirov resigned on the 42nd move.

The round also gave Arjun his first win of the event after his shock loss to Thailand's Prin Laohawirapap in the opening

With the white pieces, Gukesh secured a free-flowing position in the Sicilian Defence, even though it meant spending more time on the clock initially.

round. It was a quintessential Arjun victory, built on a deep line of preparation with the white pieces against 2629-rated Maksim Chigaev on Board 2.

Arjun, only the second Indian to have ever crossed the 2800 rating mark, kept the position sharp in the Queen's Indian game that transitioned from the English Opening. In a matter of five moves in the middlegame, Chigaev lost all control, allowing Arjun to tie him down with an impending checkmate attack.

Earlier, following a hat-trick of victories in the event, Nihal Sarin's winning streak came to an end after he drew against Jaime Santos with black pieces. Meanwhile, Praggnanandhaa's search for his first win also continued after he was held to a draw on the top board by David Antón.

In the women's section, India prevailed over Mongolia with a similar 3.0-1.0 scoreline. It was the lower boards, Divya Deshmukh and Savitha Shri B, who pushed the side over the finishing line with wins on Board 3 and Board 4 respectively. Koneru Humpy avoided a big mishap, sustaining pressure from Woman International Master (WIM) Bat-Erdene Mungunzul on the top board before managing half a point from the clash.

World Championship challenger R Vaishali will rue her missed chances against Woman Grandmaster (WGM) Turmunkh Munkhzul, as she too ended her game with a draw. Unlike the men's team, which started slow, the women's team has been firing on all cylinders. The 3-1 win over Mongolia was the first occasion the women's side allowed any team to take a full point against it in four rounds.

Divya exudes the confidence the team is showing. Asked if India can repeat the feat of Budapest, she said: "I think for sure. We're the top seeds, so we will be looking forward to defending our title. It'll be the first for India," said Divya.



Artists perform around a Japanese castle on a heart-shaped platform during the 2026 Asian Games opening ceremony. AP

JAPAN'S EMPEROR Nakuhiito, Empress Masako, Olympic Council of Asia president Sheikh Joaan bin Hamad Al Thani and International Olympic Committee president Kirsty Coventry were all present at the Opening Ceremony. Emperor Nakuhiito flagged the Asiad open.

JAPANESE FILMMAKER Yukihiro Tsutsumi curated an event by the theme of 'Harmonic Heart Beat'. Part of the event was a heart-shaped stage and a similar cauldron which was lit at the end towards the ceremony's end.

THE 30,000-seater strong Paloma Mizuho Stadium in Nagoya hosted the opening ceremony for the 2026 Asian Games. This is the third time Japan is hosting the Asian Games after the 1958 Tokyo Asiad and the 1994 Hiroshima Asiad.



FATHER-SON DUO Shigenobu Murofushi and his son Koji Murofushi lit the cauldron at the opening ceremony. Shigenobu was a five-time Asian Games hammer-throw gold medal winner and national record holder before Koji broke it and became an Olympic champion winning the Hammer throw gold medal at the 2004 Athens Olympics. REUTERS

NOSTALGIA

Against the odds, '82Asiad sparked India's colour TV revolution

Government sought Russian help after a NASA-launched satellite ran into trouble

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, September 19

THE 1982 Asian Games will go down in history for many reasons. It was the first real sighting of PT Usha's prodigious talent. It was the reason venues like the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, the Siri Fort auditorium, and the Karni Singh shooting range exist today. It was the second — and the most recent time — that India hosted the continental mega event. It was an occasion that provided a measure of the country's capacity to host big-ticket events. It was also the first time China ended up on top of the medal tally, a spot it has refused to relinquish ever since.

However, several months before the Asian Games were to begin in November 1982, the country's space scientists at Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) were running a different race: one against time, and space itself. Then prime minister Indira Gandhi had set an ambitious target: she wanted the Asiad to be broadcast in colour.

That would require work on multiple fronts: ISRO would have to send a communications satellite in space to beam the images; Doordarshan would have to set up on-ground infrastructure like signal-receiving stations to capture and relay the visuals; and people would have to own colour TVs to watch them in the comfort of their homes.

The first part was the hardest to execute. ISRO contracted an American company, Ford Aerospace, to build the

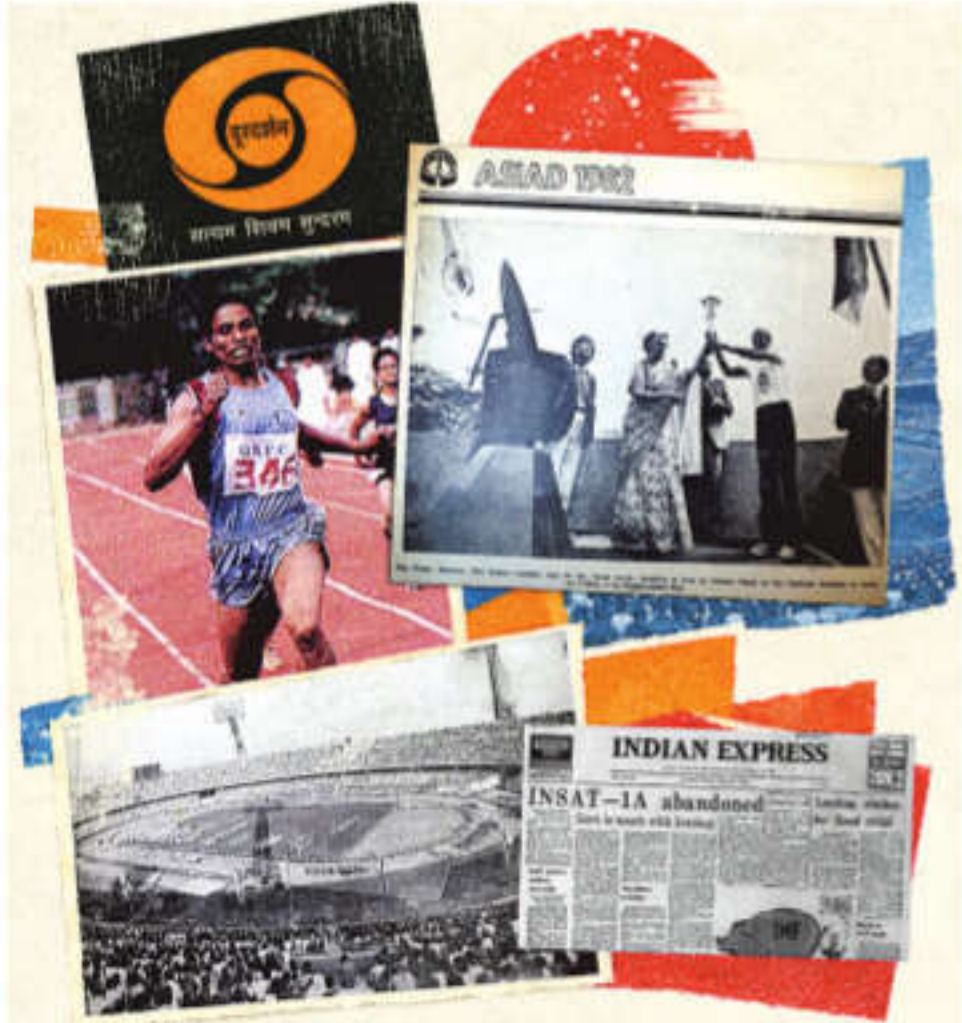
satellite — called INSAT 1A, the country's first multipurpose operational satellite — based on a concept they had been working on since the 1970s. NASA launched the satellite from Florida's Cape Kennedy Space Centre on April 10, 1982, seven months before the Asian Games were to begin.

But after the satellite detached from the vehicle carrying it, it ran into turbulence. On September 6, about two months before the Asiad, it had to be deactivated. "During the launch, immediately within a few hours, we noticed that there was a problem. It was sorted out before the satellite reached its final orbit. But in the final orbit, we had another problem: the solar sail did not deploy. The satellite was heating up," Pramod Kale, a Padma Shri awardee who was the Project Director of INSAT 1 at the time, tells *The Indian Express*. "We were not certain how many hours we could actually support the broadcasting operations."

Kale and his team had spent many months of long, sleepless nights and travelled several times from Karnataka's Hassan - where ISRO had built a master control facility - to Palo Alto in the US for the project. But now, there was no satellite.

A desperate government reached out to the Soviet Union, who agreed to provide their satellite to broadcast the Games. "It was a very good decision taken by the Information and Broadcasting Ministry to have an alternate plan for the Asian Games," says Kale.

On the ground, Doordarshan was doubling its efforts. In



those days, the public broadcaster was capable of reaching only the big cities in the country. So before the Asiad, a team from Doordarshan was sent to Germany, four OB vans and mobile cameras were added to its arsenal, recalls Mission ISRO, a podcast about India's space ambitions. By 1982, Doordarshan had built 20 TV stations in different cities.

"The Asian Games definitely gave a big fillip to television broadcasting throughout the country because by that time, a large number of television transmitters also had come up in cities," says Kale. "In colour television transmission, there was a slightly raised cost in terms of the making of TV studios, making them colour compatible, the lights used, the cameras used. So, there was a question of investment from the government. Then the colour television sets would have to be purchased by the consumers."

The third front in this Asian Games-infused colour TV revolution was the easiest one to be tackled. "By one estimate, India had about 84,000 TV sets in the early 1970s," Ronojoy Sen, the author of *India at Play*, was quoted as saying on the Mission ISRO podcast. "Of these, about 90 percent were in Delhi and Bombay. Outside these two cities, the presence of TV was very minimal."

But the government eased rules around owning colour TVs, as long as they were gifted by someone from abroad. A report from 1982 in *India Today* stated that people were so eager to own a colour television set that they were happily forking out an eye-watering amount of Rs 7,000 to the government as tax. The demand grew so much that airlines organised special charter flights just to bring TV sets to India. Shops in some of Asia's biggest commercial centres of Hong Kong, Singa-

“Immediately within a few hours, we noticed that there was a problem. It was sorted out before the satellite reached its final orbit. But in the final orbit, we had another problem: the solar sail did not deploy... We were not certain how many hours we could actually support the broadcasting operations”

PRAMOD KALE,
PROJECT DIRECTOR, INSAT 1

“After I narrowly missed out on a medal at the Olympics, Kerala CM K. Karunakaran said, 'For us, it is like you have won a medal', and he gave me a colour television. It was a Keltron TV made in Kerala. Once you start watching colour television, you will never go back to black-and-white television.”

PT USHA,
IOA CHIEF, SPRINT QUEEN

pore and Dubai were running out of TV sets. The report added that the government earned customs revenue of around Rs 70 crore from imported sets, which almost covered the cost of hosting the Asian Games.

Eventually, when the Asian Games came along, thousands of Indians got to see their athletes competing in colour.

Kale, who is now 85 years old, was one of them, watching the Games on a colour TV made by the Bush company in Bangalore. The impact of India getting to watch the Asiad on colour TVs was such that by the time the Los Angeles Olympics came along two years later, they had almost become a must-have accessory in many living rooms around the country.

Usha, who had become a star at the 1982 Asiad by winning two silver medals, went to the 1984 Olympics and finished fourth in the 400m hurdles

race. The Kerala government honoured her by gifting her... what else, a colour television.

"During the 1982 Asian Games, we had a black-and-white TV at home. But that changed soon. When I went to the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics, we still had a black-and-white TV. So my father went to a relative's house to watch me on a colour TV," Usha recounts to *The Indian Express*.

"After I narrowly missed out on a medal at the Olympics, Kerala Chief Minister K. Karunakaran said, 'For us, it is like you have won a medal', and he gave me a colour television. It was a Keltron TV made in Kerala. Once you start watching colour television, you will never go back to black-and-white television."

That's exactly what the rest of the country felt after experiencing the colour TV revolution fuelled by the Asian Games.

INDIA V SOUTH KOREA: DAVIS CUP ROUND 2

Nagal's body gives out, and with it India's Davis Cup Finals dream

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 19

THE LAST time India met South Korea in the Davis Cup, they set up a trial by heat in Chandigarh. Two Korean players, Yong Kyu Lim and Seong Chan Hong, wilted and had to retire mid-match; a ball boy collapsed too. India won 4-1. Ten years later, it was South Korea's turn to host, and they chose Seoul's historic Olympic Park Tennis Center as the setting. The weather was sultry but not nearly as oppressive as Chandigarh 2016. Sumit Nagal wilted anyway.

India's top-ranked singles player appeared jaded and faded without a trace in his reverse singles rubber against Soonwoo Kwon on Saturday. His 1-6, 2-6 capitulation ended the national team's notable

campaign at the Qualifiers stage. South Korea won 3-1 and advanced to the prestigious Final 8 for the first time.

Nagal's performance on Day 2 was a far departure from his spirited fight against Hyeon Chung earlier. Though he lost that match too, the 29-year-old went hell for leather in pursuit of deep and wide balls. He got within two games of victory and battled on for three hours and six minutes before going down. Versus Kwon, Nagal looked defeated long before the scoreline said so. He folded in all of 68 minutes. Kwon's sublime show had a lot to do with that too, of course.

India began the day on the brink, down 0-2 in the tie, and desperately needed their doubles duo to deliver against Jisung Nam and Uisung Park. Deliver it did. Dhakshineswar

Suresh strode out alongside Sri-ram Balaji instead of the slated Niki Poonacha; captain Rohit Rajpal belatedly decided to stick with Dhakshineswar, bearing his doubles win in Bengaluru in mind. The gamble paid off.

Balaji complemented Dhakshineswar's big serve with consummate volleying, and Dhakshineswar returned the favour whenever Balaji served. The pair put collective pressure on Nam's serve in the fourth game of Set 1 and finally broke through after six opportunities with precise net play. A smart lob by Balaji wrapped up the set in India's favour.

After a lengthy stretch of solid serving, the Indians erred in the sixth game of Set 2. The first break points arrived for Korea, and a double fault by Balaji handed Nam-Park the break. Park gleefully served out



Sumit Nagal. AP

the set to level things.

The decider opened with three nervous service games from either pair before Dhakshineswar produced a line-kissing winner to earn the decisive break in the eighth game. After one hour and 44 minutes, the Tamil Nadu duo had won 6-3, 3-6, 6-3. India stayed alive.

All hopes now rested on Nagal. Kwon crushed them at the outset. The Korea No. 1 started menacingly, overpowering Nagal with powerful groundstrokes and inch-perfect placement, breaking the Indian's serve thrice to rout him in the first set. Nagal settled down a little in Set 2, landing deeper returns and coming close to breaking Kwon's serve in the third game, but that was the extent of his resistance as the world No. 157 used his forehand to devastating effect on both sides.

Nagal was reduced to a spectator. He saved four match points on his serve, but the writing was on the wall. A Nagal return went wide, and Kwon slumped to the ground. With his demolition job, the 28-year-old had propelled South Korea to a momentous quarterfinal

berth. For India, it was a golden opportunity lost.

Yuki Bhambri, who missed the tie with a thigh injury, said Nagal could have fought harder. "It is tough to recover from a gruelling three-hour match the previous day. But you are representing the country and have a team of physios there with you. Regardless of the result, you must give it your all," Bhambri told the broadcaster.

Nagal felt his struggle on the day was physical rather than mental. "He (Kwon) played at a very high level. I was one level down, he was one level up. That made a big difference between me and him. He just outplayed me, that's it," Nagal said. He cited Kwon's expertise on the slow, low court too. "It's very tough to hurt him here. It's very suitable for him. The balls are heavy, everything goes to his knee, he

can barely hit anything above his shoulder, while my game style is very opposite to him."

Rajpal, while refusing to single out Nagal's losses, admitted that the failure to close out close matches hurt the team. "We just lacked finish and luck favoured them. A lot of things went their way. This Davis Cup is all about home advantage but we needed to close the match," he said. "Yesterday's match was clearly Sumit's match. Third set he was back to 4-4 from 1-4," Rajpal added.

The jury is out on the cause, but the effect is evident. Having reached touching distance of the ultra-elite top eight, India stumbled. They will start their next Davis Cup campaign from the Qualifiers stage. Unless Nagal, or someone else, steps up next to DK, the dream will remain a dream.

Powar set to be chairman of junior selectors

Mumbai: FORMER INDIA off-spinner Ramesh Powar is tipped to become chairman of the BCCI's junior national selection committee, it is learnt. The Indian board is set to have a new junior selection panel and had sought applications from candidates.

Powar coached Gujarat's senior team last season, and recently decided to move on. He has twice worked as coach of the Indian women's team, with his second stint ending abruptly when he was shifted to the National Cricket Academy to work as spin-bowling coach with the men's setup headed by VVS Laxman.

The Mumbai off-spinner played two tests and 31 ODIs for India, and has since taken up coaching roles.

DEVENDRA PANDEY

‘Easier to write fiction now’

With *The Actor*, veteran journalist and *The Indian Express* columnist Tavleen Singh turns to fiction to chart the journey of a nation

Ethiopia’s walk into the future



The Chutney Chronicles

How a little chutney on the plate holds stories of region, season, thrift and memory

Heena Khandelwal

WHAT COMES to mind when you hear the word ‘chutney’? The green coriander-mint relish served in restaurants or the sweet date-tamarind one that’s a must with chaats? Think again, and this time think about what chutney looked like at home, in your childhood, when it would uplift a dal-rice or roti-sabzi meal by many notches.

It’s a dash of flavour that defies definition, changing from one community to another, from one region to another. It’s a shapeshifter that can be dry, coarse, runny or thick. “Our culinary landscape is vast and incredibly nuanced and the concept of chutney is also limitless,” says award-winning author and culinary chronicler Rushina Munshaw-Ghildiyal, who spent nearly a decade documenting chutneys across the country.

In 2017, she started Indian Food Observation Days with one of the 10 days dedicated to chutneys. It is celebrated year on year ever since. She put out an open call for people across the country to celebrate it in any way they liked. It picked up, with people using #ChutneyDay to share stories and recipes. Brands joined in, and September 24 is now celebrated as Chutney Day.

Last year, it all came together in the form of a deliciously illustrated, over-500-page book, *Chutney: A Compendium of Stories and Recipes*. It features around 230 recipes and inputs from over 120 regional food experts, capturing what chutneys look like across India, from Kashmir, Haryana, Jharkhand, Manipur, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh to communities such as the Bohri, Sindhi, Saraswat, Anglo-Indian and Syrian Christian. For Munshaw-Ghildiyal, the reasons for embarking on this journey were two-fold: Chutney connects people on a fundamental level and it has also suffered from homogenisation.

“Similar to how people talk about ‘curry’ not really existing as a single dish, chutney too underwent a broad-stroke flattening as it travelled around the world,” she says. “Even the word ‘chutney’ was popularised by the colonialists. Different parts of India historically had different names for it. In the south, it was recorded as *thuvaiyal*. Ayurvedic texts refer to it as *katni* or *catni*, and *lehya* — inspired by the act of licking. Traditionally, it was just a small dot on the plate.”

Using whatever is on hand

For Kashmiri Nath, 56, an Assamese food chronicler, chutney was “something fun — created out of nothing.” A little leftover fresh green pea curry, for instance, could become one. The same resourcefulness shaped Anuradha Joshi Medhora’s childhood in Indore. There was a chutney with every meal and it was, as she puts it, “the flavour bomb”. What went into it depended on what came from the family garden: *amrud*, *amla*, *dhania*, *pudina*, *kairi*, *narangi*, *shehtut*, figs, *mahua*. Then there were the scraps — *lauki*, pumpkin, ridge gourd and ivy gourd peels, toasted with sesame, mustard, lime and whatever else was at hand. Then, of course, the *beej* (seed) ki chutneys of *kathal*, *kaddu*, *tarbooz*, *lauki*. Whatever seeds you had, you found a way to turn them into something delicious.

There was no refrigeration then, she says, and the logic was simple: Use what you have before it goes to waste.

It is a logic that appears again and again across regions. In Andhra Pradesh, Hyderabad-based chef Vignesh Ramachandran, chef-partner at Theta Theta Telugu and Coffee Sangam, describes Telugu food as a treasure trove of chutneys. “Virtually any vegetable can be turned into one,” he says. In Telugu, chutney is called *pachadi* and there is *pachadi* made from aubergine,



ridge gourd, bottle gourd, ivy gourd, raw mango, cabbage and tomato.

His grated raw mango chutney, made with fresh coconut, chilli powder, salt and finished with a tempering of mustard seeds, curry leaves and dried red chillies, is very different from the chopped or pickled mango preparations many are familiar with.

In Assam, the tools, too, were part of the process. Nath recalls the *dheki*, a foot-operated pounding device, used when families lived jointly and larger batches were required. Hard fruits such as hog plum were pounded whole. Softer star fruit was chopped and roughly pounded on a *silbatta*, then served with chilli, mustard oil, salt and coriander. Lentils also found their way into chutney.

Sour, sweet and seasonal

Before chutney, Bengal had *tok* and *ombol*. Today, they sit in harmony with one another. “Tok and ombol are largely used interchangeably depending on where you hail from, but the word ‘tok’ literally translates to ‘sour’. It’s a sour palate cleanser and has a definite place in a Bengali meal,” says Kolkata-based Sujoy Chatterjee, co-founder of Amar Khamar, which brings Bengal’s indigenous produce from farms to tables.

An old tamarind tok, he says, works well between the protein course and dessert. Sometimes, tok is eaten with a little rice so that the rice absorbs the sourness better. It is usually runny and fish can also be used. Early autumn, for instance, is the time for tok/ombol made with the head of hilsa.

Chutney, in contrast, is fruitier, sweeter and thicker. “Papaya chutney with lime juice is a classic,” he says. Chutney takes Chatterjee back to another time: weddings,

There was a time when cooks arrived with large utensils and made big batches of tomato chutney with dates, cashews and raisins. Seasonality still decides what appears on many plates — Jolphai chutney in Assam in winter, kuler chutney during Saraswati Puja in Bengal, raw mango tok in summer.

The chutney pantry

Up north in Kashmir, chutney is not an occasional accompaniment either. “Chutneys are an integral part of Kashmiri food culture, be it the Kashmiri Muslim Wazwan or Pandit cuisine,” says chef Prateek Sadhu, a Kashmiri who grew up in Delhi. Three are considered essential: “Doon Chetin, made

Chutneys are integral to Kashmiri food, be it the Muslim wazwan or Pandit cuisine. There is one made with walnut, one with radish, another with mint

PRATEEK SADHU
Chef founder, Naar

with walnuts; Muji Chetin, made with radish and particularly integral to weddings and Pudin Chetin, made with Kashmiri mint, which is notably peppery,” says the chef-founder of the award-winning restaurant, Naar.

The method matters as much as the ingredients. A Kashmiri stone mortar and pestle is used to crush radish with salt, green chillies and *kala jeera* before yoghurt is added. For the walnut version, walnuts, radish, onions and soaked dried Kashmiri red chillies are mashed together, with yoghurt acting as a binder. These are not seasonal, they are constants.

Chef Thomas Zacharias, founder of The Locavore, remembers a similar insistence on method from his Kerala home, where what is broadly called chutney in English is usually chammanthi or chammandhi.

His grandmother, Amamma’s ulli chammandi, made with green chillies, coconut oil and shallots and eaten with boiled tapioca, was always made with a mortar and pestle. That chutney later inspired the version of Eggs Kejriwal when The Bombay Canteen opened in February 2015. Zacharias says his work with The Locavore has only reinforced how astonishing the range is: chutneys can be made from cultivated or foraged leaves, flowers, fruit, seeds, vegetable scraps, wild herbs, dried fish, fermented ingredients and even ants.

When chutney is the meal

For Shahu Patole, who hails from the Mang community in Marathwada, chutney wasn’t an accompaniment. It was the meal. “Some of us still have to run to the fields to work and don’t have the luxury of buying and making vegetables, so what would we do? Take a bhakri, put on a

little kharda or thecha and the meal is done,” says the 64-year-old, who chronicled the food habits of Dalit communities in his 2016 Marathi book *Anna He Apoorva Brahma*, translated into English as *Dalit Kitchens of Marathwada* in 2024.

Dry chutneys were common at his home because they lasted longer. They typically combined red chilli powder, salt and another ingredient — peanuts (Shengadanayachi chatni), flax seeds (Jawasachi chatni), roselle (Ambadaichi chatni), dry prawn (zinge) or dry Bombay duck (Bombilachi chatani). The main ingredient was roasted on a tawa, then pounded by hand with chilli, salt and, when available, garlic and coriander. There was also tikhat, simply red chilli powder and salt.

Wet chutneys included thecha, made by pounding green chillies with salt; roasted chillies turned it into kharda. Then there was ola yesur: onions placed directly on the hot chulha after the bhakris were cooked, allowed to soften and then pounded with roasted green chilli and salt.

“We wouldn’t have oil. So we would cook meat in salt and turmeric, if available garlic-ginger paste and coriander and once done, add this ola yesur to give it more flavour,” Patole says.

More than a condiment

A chutney with fish or meat has been a staple in some parts of the country. In Assam, fish was dried and smoked above the wood-fire kitchen stove on a bamboo rack called a *chunga*. When little else was available, it was pounded with chilli, chopped onion, mustard oil and salt. In Madhya Pradesh, leftovers from fish and mutton could become chutney too — maas ki chutney from leftover mutton, fish from lunch becoming chutney for dinner.

“There’s a saying in Marathi, *tondala la-waicha*, which means just enough to touch your mouth, and that’s exactly how much chutney one needed. But what it did was add a little punch to every meal,” says Medhora, founder of Charoli Foods, which began in 2015 as a pop-up serving the royal kitchens of Malwa and has since grown into a catering company specialising in royal cuisine.

It was also, she believes, a quiet culinary strategy in a patriarchal household. “Men then would get upset if the food wasn’t up to the mark. But you can’t cook elaborate meals all the time! So what would the women do? Add a little chutney and it would spice up the most boring meal and nobody would complain.”

Perhaps, this is why chutney is so emotional. It is not merely what sits beside the food; it is a record of what was available, what was affordable, what grew in a particular season, what a grandmother knew to do with a peel and what a mother could put together without measuring anything.

For Zacharias, chutney is also a way of understanding a place. “Its ingredients and techniques can reveal a great deal about the local ecology, seasons, preservation practices and the knowledge held within home kitchens,” he says.

At The Locavore, they featured Futkal Chutney from Jharkhand, made from tender wild fig buds gathered in a short season, boiled, sun-dried and later ground with roasted tomato, ginger, garlic and chilli. From Ladakh came Tangthur, made with buttermilk, seasonal greens and skotse, a wild Himalayan herb foraged in summer, pounded into cakes, dried and stored for winter. There was also Sukhti Chutney from Alibag, made with roasted and pounded dried jawla, garlic and chilli — particularly useful during the monsoon, when fresh seawater fish is less readily available. “Each of these is delicious, of course, but they also tell us how people respond to their surroundings and circumstances.”

There is nutrition in that little spoonful too. Munshaw-Ghildiyal says that chutney helped complete the *shadrasa* — the six tastes — even as the rest of the plate changed with the seasons.

Much of this knowledge, she says, lived in the heads of women. Tanisha Phanbu, a home chef and proponent of Meghalaya cuisine, told Munshaw-Ghildiyal that after chutney was ground on the *mawjingshoh*, a ball of rice was rolled over the stone to collect every last bit of juice, flavour and spice. “People actually wait for those balls to come out,” says Munshaw-Ghildiyal.

Each dash of a chutney brings back a memory. Munshaw-Ghildiyal’s husband’s grandmother, Mohini Raturi, made a til-tamatar wali chutney that was closer in texture to an aloo sabzi. She wrote the recipe during one of her visits to Dehradun, not knowing that it would be the last time she would see her.

Years later, she found the old notes, made the chutney and brought it home. Her husband Shekhar, who has co-published the book, finished it with six rotis that had originally been meant for dinner.

Recently, when Raturi’s great-granddaughter got married in Delhi, Munshaw-Ghildiyal made the chutney again. Her daughters and grandchildren were there.

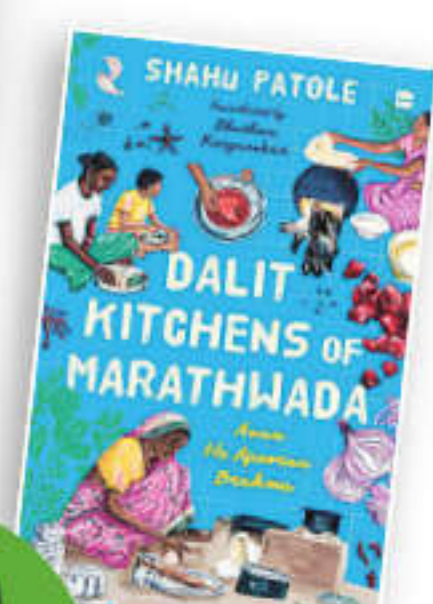
“They were thrilled,” she says. The recipe in the book is credited to Raturi. And perhaps that is what chutney has always done best: carry something forward — a season, a place, a way of eating, a little thrift, a grandmother’s instinct, or simply the memory of a meal, one small spoonful at a time.



Thomas Zacharias



Sujoy Chatterjee



Shahu Patole

THE WORD
THIS WEEK

From the Crossword Longlist

THE CROSSWORD Book Awards are back for their landmark 20th edition, with an extensive longlist of 50 titles across fiction, non-fiction, translations, children's books and business and management. Jeet Thayil, Viswanathan Anand, Rahul Bhattacharya, Anuradha Roy, Shanta Gokhale and TM Krishna are among the authors nominated for the awards. The shortlists will be announced in October, and the awards ceremony will be held in Mumbai in December. The winning authors will get a cash prize of Rs 50,000 each. This week, we recommend one book from each category.

QUICK VERDICT

HIT
The Other Side

MICHELLE D'COSTA's debut novel, *You Envy the Coutinhos*, offers a window into what migrating to another country actually entails and what life is like before and after. Having lived her formative years in Bahrain, D'costa's novel largely takes place there. The protagonist, Joachim, is from a not-well-to-do family from Mangalore. He has dreams of becoming a Bollywood actor but his mother's voice taunts him about his broken Hindi each time he thinks of it. He settles for a safe job in the Gulf that will improve his situation. Being in the Gulf is harder still, with insecurity at each step, but he has to put on a brave face for those back home who think of him as 'successful'. That brave face, the pretence of Joachim having a loving marriage with Emilda, a science-studying daughter and a good job, makes his nephew, Darrel Serrao, envious. Through its tragicomic style, the novel peels back the layers of class, religion, gender, masculinity, family and success. Reminiscent of Jhumpa Lahiri's early writing, it tackles cultural stereotypes and breaks open the disillusionments of migration. D'costa's debut is gripping from the first paragraph. **REVA THAKKAR**

HIT
Borrowed coats

SET DURING World War I, writer and producer Devki Pande's debut novel, *The Imitation Englishman* is a historical fiction that examines the psychological toll of colonialism. The story follows Madhusudan Chandra Joshi, a clerk working in the district courts in India, who travels to Heidelberg to study law. On the way, he meets Amir Farooqui who is with the Hindu-German conspiracy, a revolutionary group formed by Indians living in exile. As the war gathers momentum, Amir and Madhusudan flee to San Francisco and London respectively, the former in search of his fellow revolutionaries who are part of the Hindustan Ghadar Party and the latter determined to continue his studies. But it is London that exposes Madhusudan to the harsh realities of colonialism. The novel it refuses to offer its protagonist easy heroism. Madhusudan is forced to come to terms with the price of his own assimilation. The story smoothly ties in real historical figures like Lala Har Dayal, Bhagwan Singh and Ram Chandra, all members of the Hindustan Ghadar Party. The book is a thought-provoking debut about friendships, identity and the cost of choosing a cause. **ANUSREE K C**

HIT
Living Up

CARO CLAIRE Burke's debut novel has been the talk of book clubs all summer, thanks to its perfectly of-the-moment subject: the tradwife influencer, that beguiling creature who makes bank while selling women the romanticised fantasy of a glorified broodmare. The book follows Natalie Heller Mills, an influencer who peddles sourdough and soft-focus femininity to the liberal feminists she baits, the incels who claim her as proof, and the conservative politicos who see her as a weapon. In practice, she is no tradwife. Off camera, she has all modern conveniences at her disposal, the business model is hers and she is unequivocally the family's breadwinner. When a documentary maker exposes the sham, she embraces the pioneer fantasy in earnest, and wakes one day to find herself in 1855. Burke successfully dismantles the machinery that sells subservience as choice, and shows how the fantasy claims victims among men and children too. The writing, especially the climax, is, however, rushed, and the 1855 sections are unconvincing. *Yesteryear* had the bones to be one of the greats but it just fell shy. **AISHWARYA KHOSLA**

Absolute Jafar
by Sarnath Banerjee

SARNATH BANERJEE's semi-autobiographical graphic novel, *Absolute Jafar*, merits a place on any bookshelf. The protagonist, Brighu, a Delhi-based compulsive walker, marries Mahrukh, an artist from Karachi. The marriage dissolves, but their son, Jafar, born in Berlin, inherits these fractured histories. His only link to his parents' countries is the bedtime stories of jinn and street food his father tells him.

Scamlands
by Snigdha Poonam

ANYONE WHO has fielded a call demanding an OTP, or been warned of a 'digital arrest', will find Snigdha Poonam's *Scamlands* both engaging and enlightening. Nominated in the Non-fiction category, the book is immersive without being sensational. It neither villainises nor victimises the fraudsters. It documents how caste, money and politics shape who ends up behind the phone, and why the empire keeps growing.

Tiger Lessons
by Sannapureddy Venkatarami Reddy

IN TIGER Lessons, nominated in the Translations category, Sannapureddy Venkatarami Reddy introduces us to a world removed from the urban hustle — where ancestral ecological wisdom is still needed to survive. At its centre is Tiger Ravi from a golla family — a Telugu shepherd community. This is a rare novel that teaches geography, anthropology, biology and botany without ever feeling like a lesson.

Ancient Indians
Tony Joseph

BEFORE HUMANS, India belonged to giant monsters. Then, *homo sapiens* arrived, and the struggle for food began. Sixty-five thousand years later, more than a billion people live here. This children's edition of Tony Joseph's *Early Indians: The Story of Our Ancestors and Where We Came From*, nominated in the Children's Books category, takes young readers through that story, from fossils and bones to words and ruins.

The Great Sanctions Hack
by Urjit Patel

IN THIS book, Urjit Patel, former Governor of the RBI, argues that economic sanctions, which are America's go-to geopolitical weapon, rarely achieve their goals and often punish the wrong parties. Nominated in the Business & Management category, Patel contends that secondary sanctions inflict damage on countries such as India and shows how alternatives like the New Development Bank can help nations cope. **AISHWARYA KHOSLA**

‘Easier to write fiction at the moment’

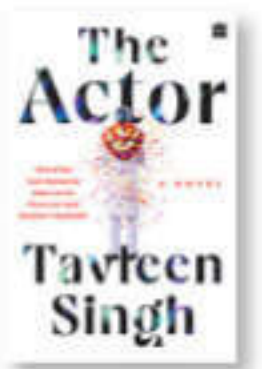
With The Actor, veteran journalist and The Indian Express columnist Tavleen Singh turns to fiction to chart the journey of a nation that feels prescient



ANIL SHARMA

NOTIONS OF NATION
Tavleen Singh at her Delhi residence

brief, aborted turn in politics, to the stints played by Amitabh Bachchan, Rajesh Khanna and Vinod Khanna, which is evidence, she says, that “politicians are performers,” and that a leader who cannot command a stage is at a real disadvantage. Movie stars, Singh says, wield more power than most politicians. “Even the Ambanis,” she points out, “need stars at their events to draw a crowd. Don’t forget that America at the moment is being led by a reality TV star who keeps talking about how he is going to get someone out of central casting,” she says. “He goes for people’s looks and loyalty.” Singh says she was startled by how closely her novel foreshadows reality. One finds real-world echoes of plot points that were written before they transpired, such as the birth of the Cockroach Janata Party, or the rise of the actor-turned-politician Vijay. Naresh’s rural tours through UP and Bihar, meanwhile, were consciously modelled on political strategist Prashant Kishor’s two years spent travelling the



THE ACTOR
BY TAVLEEN SINGH
HarperCollins
328 pages
₹699

country to study its problems, Singh says. One of her most compelling characters is the political reporter Maya, who becomes a mentor of sorts to Amit, a political ignoramus sheltered in the vacuous conversations of Bollywood. Eventually, she also becomes his love interest. Their affair is drawn more explicitly than the novel’s politics, as is a running subplot involving a promiscuous *maharani*-turned-politician, who flirts openly with Amit at a string of Delhi dinner parties. In one scene, he stumbles upon bundles of cash hidden behind a false ceiling in her private bathroom. Asked whether Maya is Singh’s voice, the author says, “Not necessarily but, of course, she has some of my views.” The plucky journalist is assembled from scribes and socialites she has known over decades in Lutyens’ Delhi, the same world in which Amit and Naresh grew up. On whether the state’s machinery would eventually catch up with a real-life reformer like Naresh, Singh is optimistic.

“Voters have changed. They can see when they are being bribed for votes; they can see that nothing happens,” she says. What would the fictional Guruji do if he read the book — ban it, ignore it, or invite her to tea and a selfie? “The reaction would not be a tax raid that’s coming your way but a bullet,” she says. Singh is intimately familiar with the consequences of displeasing the ruling dispensation. Her son, the writer Aatish Taseer, had his Overseas Citizen of India status revoked in 2019, after he wrote a *Time* magazine cover story critical of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Taseer has since unsuccessfully applied for an ordinary visa to visit her and her ailing husband. Singh has not thought about a sequel, she says but has left the door open. “Whether Naresh lives or dies, we don’t know,” she says. “He is in the hospital but he is still alive at the end of the book... I have seen India change because of religion being brought too much into politics. So I felt the need to write this.”

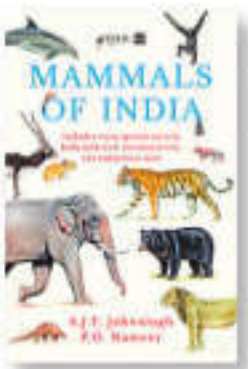
Wild, Wild Nest

In Mammals of India, wildlife biologists AJT Johnsingh and PO Nameer follow the forest trails of India to put the spotlight on over 450 such species in the country

Nikhil Ghanekar

AT FIRST sight, *Mammals of India* may seem unwieldy and daunting for a wildlife guide. Running over 800-pages long, it informs us that it covers information on 454 mammalian species found in India. However, the fluid design, distribution maps and illustrations ensure that it will not only appeal to the field researcher with miles of forest trail under their belt but also curious school children. Capturing the mammalian diversity of India, with every minute detail of their food, habitat and anatomy is no mean task. But the late renowned wildlife biologist Asir Jawahar Thomas or AJT Johnsingh, who passed away in June 2024, and his co-author PO Nameer, professor of Wildlife Science and dean of the College of Climate Change and Environmental Science at Kerala Agricultural University, have delivered a labour of love. Johnsingh was an Indian vertebrate

ecologist from Tamil Nadu. Considered India’s foremost mammalian expert, his work ranges from research on the dholes in Bandipur and Asian elephants to the conservation of the blue-finned mahseer. He was also a faculty at the Wildlife Institute of India, and served on the National Board for Wildlife. At its heart, *Mammals of India* is an exhaustive guide to mammals currently found in India’s varied biogeographic zones. The distribution maps in the book have been prepared by Raghunath Rangaswamy and the illustrations are by Chirag Thumbar. The guide has referred to and cited literature dating back to 1888, and includes updates from scientific journals, information from natural history museums in England and the United States of America. *Mammals of India* also builds on the work of notable works published in the same genre. The book covers both terrestrial and aquatic mammal species. One of the ap-



MAMMALS OF INDIA
BY A.J.T. JOHNSINGH, P.O. NAMEER
HarperCollins
872 pages
₹3999



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

ON THE FOREST TRAIL
A dhole in Bandipur

proaches that distinguishes this guide from others are the conservation prescriptions made by the authors. In addition to presenting taxonomic, ecological and biological information, the book spells out the conservation challenges to keystone species such as elephants, bears, tigers, leopards and bats. Bats, the most reviled, stigmatised species and also the most abundant in India — with 135 species found — are given their due space. These “extraordinary creatures” are also the “most misunderstood groups of mammals”, the book notes. It flags removal of fruiting trees along highways during road expansion, disturbance and destruction of roosting sites, climate change, environmental pollution as threats to bats, emphasising the need for the government to actively promote bat research. This is particularly important, it says, in light of Nipah outbreaks and the COVID-19 pandemic. The book acquaints the reader with the evolution of mammals through different ages, narrating lucidly the impacts of tectonic shifts, the formation of modern-day biodiversity hotspots, such as the Himalayas and Western Ghats, and their combined impacts on the evolution and distribution of species. For instance, the Pleistocene epoch, around 2-3 million years ago, presumably forced many mammals to retreat southwards. Among them were possibly the Nilgiri Tahr and their subsequent evolution, which are today famously found in the Nilgiri Hills and its verdant sub-alpine grassland. No less than 11 kinds of elephants or mastodons and six kinds of rhinoceroses, as well as giraffe and hippo-like animals were once found in ancient times. PO Nameer told *The Indian Express* that the book’s genesis dates back to 2018, when the former director of the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS), Deepak Apte, broached the idea of producing an updated version of the classic, *The Book of Indian Animals* by Anglo-Indian naturalist SH Prater. The idea took a turn and converted into an entirely new and independent volume on Indian mammals. “Johnsingh had put five decades of his career in this work and I have three decades of experience, so it is a work based on our lifelong experience,” Nameer said.

‘AI can never replace HI—Human Instinct, Human Intelligence’

Filmmaker MEGHNA GULZAR and actors KAREENA KAPOOR KHAN and PRITHVIRAJ SUKUMARAN on their film *Daayra*, portraying crime onscreen and navigating AI. They were in conversation with Priyanka Sinha Jha, COO, The SCREEN Academy



(From left) Anant Goenka, Executive Director, The Indian Express Group; Meghna Gulzar; Kareena Kapoor Khan; Prithviraj Sukumaran; Priyanka Sinha Jha

Priyanka Sinha Jha: Meghna, in *Daayra*, you don't take sides. You show two sides of two protagonists. Between Team Ajooni and Team Raman, which do you align with?

MEGHNA GULZAR: Team *Daayra*.
KAREENA KAPOOR KHAN: It's not about taking sides. It's about believing in the film that Meghna wanted to make and doing justice to it. That is what we hope the discussion is going to be after the lights come on because it's going to make you think.

PRITHVIRAJ SUKUMARAN: Why *Daayra* appealed to me, at least as a script, is the fact that I do not agree or disagree with the entirety of Raman or Ajooni. And that is a space within which the film exists in its whole form. The film takes you through a journey where equal weightage is given to both sides. In the end, the question is posed to you. If we have been successful in making the film we wanted, then you won't be able to pick a side easily. That is what crime, punishment and the deliverance of justice is about today.

Do films owe a social responsibility to make the audience aware?

MEGHNA: If there is a responsibility on cinema to propagate certain things, it is also the responsibility of the audience to follow what the cinema is propagating. It's not like we depict only the malaise of society. We also make films on family values. Can we ensure everybody imbibes that? We are blamed for inspiring the negative. However, when we depict the negative, it's actually to fix it.

PRITHVIRAJ: Cinema is a powerful medium. But we also need to be aware that cinema is more often than not a reflection of society. The need to make it is born out of the reality that we live in today. I hope we reach a time where a film like *Daayra* is redundant.

KAREENA: *Daayra* is going to be one film that is going to stand the test of time. People will watch it again and have different emotions at different times. The film does mirror society. But it is the need of the hour.

Meghna, how did you find your Ajooni

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SPIRIT OF EXCELLENCE

and Raman?
MEGHNA: By the time we finished the script, one thing was clear that they were complete opposites and yet complemented

each other in an ironic way...one cannot exist without the other. Ajooni disarms with a smile. Raman is scowling all the time.

I knew I wanted Ajooni to be represented different from the way we have female police officers in our films. I had the liberty because she was not going to be in her uniform since she is a special investigator. That's when Kareena came into my mind.

It was important for me that *Daayra* is made up of region neutral characters. Raman is a name you can have in the North, South, East or West of India. So I wanted a Raman not from Hindi cinema. The minute I knew that, his name popped into my head.

Prithvi, you were busy with a film at the time and changed your mind after you heard the script. Did she give you an offer that you couldn't refuse?

PRITHVIRAJ: She did, actually. When I got the call to meet Meghna Gulzar, I had just said yes to SS Rajamouli sir's *Varanasi*. I knew I was going to be tied up the next couple of years. I also had other commitments in Malayalam cinema. So I didn't think this was going to work out for me. But I wanted to meet her anyway and was prepared to say a polite 'no'. But Meghna didn't even ask me if I had the time. She just started giving me a well-structured narration.

As artists, it's not often you are presented with an opportunity to be part of something you feel is also your responsibility. With a film like *Daayra*, it's my responsibility to use my craft to facilitate that. Luckily for me, the timelines shifted a bit and things aligned.

Kareena, you turned producer with *The Buckingham Murders*, although you had said you wouldn't produce.

KAREENA: That was a one-off thing. Acting is probably the only thing I'm good at.

You have been a glamour icon. When you get a gritty film like *Daayra*, how do you approach that?

KAREENA: An actor shouldn't be put in any sort of a box. It has never been about



SCAN THE QR CODE TO WATCH THE VIDEO

AN ACTOR SHOULDN'T BE PUT IN ANY SORT OF A BOX. IT HAS NEVER BEEN ABOUT STICKING TO AN IMAGE. THE IMAGE IS BUILT BECAUSE OF WHAT PEOPLE THINK YOU ARE. BUT AS AN ARTISTE, IT'S MY DUTY TO EXPLORE DIFFERENT PARTS

sticking to this glamorous image. The image is always built because of what people think you are. But as an artiste, it's my duty to explore different parts, which I have always done. Now, I'm choosing quality over quantity. And I don't have plans of retiring anytime soon and have a lot to explore.

When you have women in front of and behind the camera, and in various other capacities, does that change the atmosphere on the set?

PRITHVIRAJ: As an actor, it doesn't make a difference to me. There are good directors and bad directors. Regarding perspectives, it's an age-old cliché now... the man envisioned by a woman. I'm assuming there is something to it because I have done another film in Malayalam called *Kooda*, directed by Anjali Menon, and my wife tells me there is so much of Joshua she has seen in me in real life. I'm assuming that has got a lot to do with how Anjali conceived the character and what she saw in me as an actor.

MEGHNA: Women are more organised. So when there are more women on set, it runs like a well-oiled machine.

KAREENA: Women also multitask. We can be homemakers, actors, run a business, do our finances, send our children to school. There's nothing a woman can't do.

In *Daayra*, there was no exaggeration in the reenactment of the crime. How did you decide what to keep and what not to keep in that particular scene?

MEGHNA: I was clear I wanted to make men uncomfortable when they saw that. I know that happens because I have editors who are men and I could keep working on that sequence for hours and they would want to leave the room. So that was intentional.

Every director brings a certain culture to their set. What was Meghna Gulzar's set like?

PRITHVIRAJ: I studied in an Army school and it was like going back to school. But she is easily one of the most, if not the most, ac-

ademic, judicious filmmaker I have worked with. I don't know if I can pick a filmmaker who is more prepared than Meghna.

But the magic is not about being prepared. Meghna goes to a location with her team of assistants and shoots the entire scene on a phone or a digital camera first. Then she edits the scene and the screen grabs make her storyboard. So when we go there for a shoot, she already has a reference. This seems like a rigid process but the magic is that she has this at her disposal.

KAREENA: That's also an art.

Kareena, you have spoken about how you had to rein in the energy.

KAREENA: Because of the character that it was. I have always believed that the director is the captain of the ship. There's nobody who knows the ship more than the director.

Because you feel creatively safe when you have somebody to steer you?

KAREENA: The way she respects her work and the kind of energy and effort she is putting in, you know you just have to deliver.

In the age of AI, do you see yourself at some point licensing to generate your likeness?

MEGHNA: I'm actually old school and a purist and maybe boring because I have always believed that cinema will never get replaced even when television or streaming came. Similarly, I believe that AI will never replace 'HI'—human instinct, human intelligence. It is merely a tool. At the end of it, it is emotionless. So after a point, it's going to start doing the wrong things when you have run out of prompts.

PRITHVIRAJ: I don't think you can fight artificial intelligence. We'll have to adapt to it. But in the broader picture, it's going to ultimately give more value to original ideas and humane elements in stories.

KAREENA KAPOOR: I don't know exactly the way I feel. Right now, as a woman, the only thing I can see is the way it's being used online negatively. That is very disturbing.

RAPID FIRE WITH ANANT GOENKA

KAREENA KAPOOR KHAN

● **The one Meghna Gulzar film that motivated you to take up this one.**
Talvar.

● **Is being a star today more or less competitive than it was when you started your career?**
There was something more electric about being a star in the 2000s.

● **The one brand you endorse that you actually use.**
Fizzy Goblet.

● **One difference and similarity**

between you and Saif as parents.

I am the stricter one, he's more chill. We are similar in terms of values.

● **... as actors.**
I'm instinctive. Saif likes to prepare.

● **One career advice you credit Karisma for?**
Hard work and perseverance because that's what the '90s were about.

● **Of your two kids, who will be the cricketer and who the actor?**
That's not for me to say, but Tim the cricketer and definitely Jeh the actor.

● **The last time you felt being a celebrity came in the way of you being a parent?**
It's a constant battle because sometimes at the airport they see ads with me putting or frowning and Tim says, 'Why are you doing that?' I don't know when my ads show up and I don't know if I want them to see too much.

● **The one Malayalam film you wish you were approached for?**
I would love to get an opportunity to work with Anjali Menon.

● **One director you haven't worked with and want to?**
Sanjay Leela Bhansali, Zoya Akhtar.

MEGHNA GULZAR

● **One thing you have admired about Prithviraj.**
His technical finesse shows up in the actor that he is. It's immaculate.

● **Your next topic for a film.**
Now, I need to do something happy.

● **One easy and one difficult thing about working with these actors: IRRFAN**
Easy: He did everything and made me look damn good. Difficult: I still don't know which side of *Talvar*'s perspective he believed in.

VICKY
Easy: The connection is just superb. Difficult: After *Sam Bahadur*, it's difficult to find a role larger than that.

DEEPIKA
Easy: She will go beneath the surface. Difficult: She has a bigger OCD than me.

ALIA
Easy: Spontaneous and instinctive to the point where she can hurt herself. That's also the difficult part.

TABU
Easy: The performances are a given. Difficult: Too accomplished for me to be telling her what to do.

SUSHMITA
Easy: What you see is what you get. Very affable. Nothing difficult.
KAREENA AND PRITHVIRAJ
Easy: their proficiency as actors. Difficult: The immense trust they put in me is scary.

● **One insight you have gained about the audience from these films:**

TALVAR
They are more intelligent than we give them credit for.

RAAZI
I didn't see layers the way they did.
CHHAPAAK
It can be difficult to convince them to see a film they think is a difficult watch.

SAM BAHADUR
Everybody wants a hero.

PRITHVIRAJ SUKUMARAN

● **Justice to you is?**
Justice has perspectives. That is what the film is about.

● **The one secret ingredient of Malayalam cinema that Bollywood should learn from?**

How informal we are as an industry. Contrary to popular belief, Malayalam cinema does not get made in 15 days in Rs 5 crore. We do shoot Rs 100-120 crore films over 150 days. But even then, there is an informality to it. That lends a tangible, humane element to the cinema. A director can simply call an actor to narrate a sub-

ject. Here I have learned that you first contact the agency, which will speak to your manager who then convinces the actor to meet the director.

● **You have the magical ability to force every Indian to watch one Malayalam film in all languages. Which film would you pick and why?**
My Dear Kuttichathan. It's the first 3D film ever made in India. I think the first 70mm film and the first technicolour film in India were also made in Malayalam. It foreshadowed so much about how this craft is going to evolve. And I am a sucker for things like that.

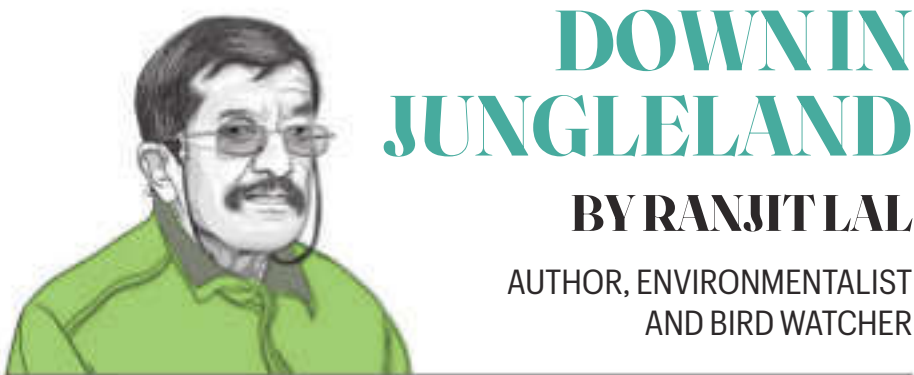
● **One way Meghna and Rajamouli are similar and poles apart.**

There is a lot of similarity in the way they make actors feel invested in the film and the characters. One way they are not is the number of days Meghna takes to shoot a film is more or less the number of days Rajamouli sir will shoot a scene in.

● **The first time you felt tempted to step outside of Malayalam cinema.**

I have never been tempted to step away from any cinema or into any. For me, it has just been about the next story that interests me.

PHOTOS: AKASH PATIL



DOWN IN JUNGLELAND

BY RANJIT LAL

AUTHOR, ENVIRONMENTALIST
AND BIRD WATCHER



Bar-headed geese are among the highest-flying birds in the world. **RANJIT LAL**

The Flight Sport

From soaring eagles to wheeling kites, birds have extraordinary ways to master the skies

ALWAYS, THEY are mesmerising: be they black kites wheeling 2,000 feet high, lazily circling on thermals, their flight feathers splayed out, minute twists of the tail steering them or ducks and parakeets streaking across like squadrons of jet fighters or shrieking missiles. Even doves, taking off from a standing start with their startling 'clap wing' as their wings smack together on the upstroke, or a humming (or sun) bird, vibrating like an electric motor in front of the flowers it desires, beating its tiny wings 80 times a second.

We have long envied and emulated bird flight. The wings of birds come in various forms, depending on their function and the type of flight preferred by the bird. They are nothing but modified arms and hands, cloaked with lightweight but tough feathers that provide both lift and thrust. Thus, small forest hawks and owls and most passerine (perching) birds have 'elliptical' wings — short, almost stubby and curved, enabling them to execute deft, high-speed manoeuvres in tight spaces. Slim sickle-like 'fastback' wings like those of swifts and falcons enable speeds of up to 389 kmph. The falcon, in fact, has relatively large wings, which it tucks into its body while executing its killer dive. Seabirds like albatrosses have long slim wings, (which we have emulated in our gliders), enabling them to skim over the ocean waves, taking advantage of the wind currents, and they can weave just over the waves for hours on end with nary a wing-beat. The big boys — the eagles and vultures — have large, broad wings with splayed-out pinions at the end to provide lift and the slots at the ends of their pinions, smoothen the vortices spinning off the wing, again enabling them to soar smoothly for hours on end with minimal expenditure of energy.

There are basically two types of wing feathers: the stiff primaries at the end of the wings, which provide thrust, by working like propellers (twisting around their axis) and the softer secondaries that prove lift by curving on the down stroke and pushing the bird up. An ingenious pulley mechanism ensures that the bird is able to fold its wings on the upstroke, reducing drag, and then pull taut during the down stroke to provide lift and thrust. Only the hummingbird is exempt from this — it can swivel its wings around 180 degrees, so that it can get lift and thrust on both strokes, enabling it to hover blurrily in front of flowers and fly sideways, up and down and backwards.

The mighty flight muscles are attached to a keel along the breastbone of the bird. According to Salim Ali, we would need a breastbone four-feet long if we were to fly like birds.

Feathers have to be kept in tip-top shape if they are to enable the bird to fly as required and birds take great care in ensuring this. I once watched a darter meticulously preen its wings for over 45 minutes, before I got tired and walked away. Every pinion has to be in perfect condition. Penguins too use their wings as flippers underwater.

Birds like ostriches have lost the ability to fly but more than make up for it by their ability to gallop over the ground and kick out like stallions, if attacked.

One experiment I like demonstrating is how a single flight pinion can provide lift: Hold a feather (say, one dropped by a black kite) lightly between thumb and forefinger and draw it forward at speed. Immediately you will feel the feather wanting to 'take-off' as it were. But feathers don't last forever. They get tattered and battered and must be replaced, something that happens at least once a year. Ingeniously, these feathers fall off symmetrically from each wing ensuring that the bird is not unbalanced in flight.

There is nothing more evocative than watching skeins of geese or cranes flying in their traditional 'V' formation, so that the wash from the wingtips of the bird ahead buoys the bird behind it. Leadership is changed frequently, so the lead bird does not get exhausted.

Ethiopia, a country that wrote the story of human evolution, finds itself in the midst of an urban transformation

Kishore Singh

ALONG-CHERISHED desire to visit Ethiopia — the land of origins — finally came true. My curiosity about the country had been brewing for years, fuelled by two of Ethiopia's most celebrated contributions to humanity: Lucy, the 3.2-million-year-old hominin fossil that helped rewrite the story of human evolution, and coffee, the magical energy bean that, according to legend, was discovered by a goat herder named Kaldi after he noticed his goats behaving as if they had consumed several espressos too many.

In fact, there was a third attraction as well: injera, Ethiopia's beloved spongy flatbread. I was struck by its uncanny resemblance to dosa. The promise of tracing humanity's origins, understanding the birthplace of coffee, and comparing injera with dosa added both flavour and energy to my curiosity long before I boarded the flight to Addis Ababa.

I arrived in Ethiopia carrying three stereotypes and an empty stomach. The stereotypes were Lucy, coffee, and injera. The empty stomach was quickly taken care of with enough of coffee to keep a small nation awake and had a taste of injera spongy and sour enough to make me forget dosa. But Lucy remained elusive.

Long before Ethiopia, I knew Lucy as a fossil in a textbook — the 1974 skeleton that rewrote human evolution. She proved our ancestors walked upright millions of years before they were smart enough to invent traffic jams, luxury apartments or PowerPoint presentations on urban transformation.

Her discovery placed Ethiopia at the centre of the search for human origins. Scholars stopped looking at the country and started looking to it — a cradle of humanity, its Rift Valley sediments holding proof that every human story, whatever the race, nationality, or religion, traces back to this same dry earth.

If Lucy helped explain where humanity came from, coffee helped humanity stay awake long enough to think about it.

Few countries have given the world a gift as transformative as coffee. Originating in the highlands of Ethiopia, coffee has travelled farther than any Ethiopian ambassador could have imagined. From the cafés of Paris to the boardrooms of New York, from university libraries to roadside tea stalls that now serve coffee as well, billions of cups are consumed every day. It fuels conversations, commerce, creativity, and occasionally the illusion that deadlines are manageable.

Yet for Ethiopia, coffee is much more than a beverage. The rituals surrounding buna (coffee) in traditional Ethiopian homes makes it more than a beverage. The slow roasting of green beans, the wafting aroma, the careful brewing, and the unhurried conversations that accompany each cup transform coffee into a social institution. In Ethiopia, coffee is identity, culture, hospitality, and economy rolled into a single bean. It connects farmers to global markets, neighbours to one another, and the present



PHOTOS COURTESY: KISHORE SINGH



GETTY IMAGES

THE ROAD AHEAD
(Clockwise from left) Modern Ethiopia; its coffee culture; a traditional conical structure

Walking with Lucy into the Future

generation to centuries of tradition. But the irony is that while the world runs on Ethiopian coffee, many coffee-growing communities continue to struggle with poverty, volatile global prices, and limited economic opportunities. The bean that energises the world does not always generate equivalent prosperity for those who grow it.

But beneath this glittering narrative lies another story.

No visitor to Ethiopia today can miss the Corridor Development Project. Roads widen, flyovers soar, glass towers pierce the skyline, and construction cranes appear so often they might as well be the national bird. There is dust, cement, drilling, demolishing, widening, beautifying, modernising, and, above all, inaugurating. The city carries itself with the confidence of a place that knows it's being watched: skylines rising almost overnight, development is celebrated through concrete, steel, and spectacle. New skylines are emerging almost overnight.

Walking through Ethiopia today, one encounters a striking paradox. One wonders what Lucy would make of the place today. She would probably be impressed by the roads. After all, walking was her thing.

FEW COUNTRIES HAVE GIVEN THE WORLD A GIFT AS TRANSFORMATIVE AS COFFEE. ORIGINATING IN THE HIGHLANDS OF ETHIOPIA. IT HAS TRAVELLED FARTHER THAN ANY ETHIOPIAN AMBASSADOR COULD HAVE IMAGINED

At first, like many visitors, I was impressed. But as I spent more time observing the city and taking to people, another reality began to emerge. I could not ignore the quieter stories unfolding behind freshly laid boulevards and landscaped public spaces. Taxi drivers pointed to neighbourhoods that had disappeared. Urban workers spoke of long commutes from the city's edge. Small businesses that once animated familiar streets had vanished.

The corridor project captures the central dilemma of contemporary Ethiopia. It asks a question that many rapidly developing societies confront: Who is the city being built for? The answer is not simple. The new infrastructure is real. The benefits are real. But so too are the anxieties of those who feel that, in the rush toward the future, their place within it has become uncertain.

The people who physically build the city — carrying stones, mixing cement, erecting towers — often find themselves excluded from the spaces they create. As land values rise, traditional neighbourhoods disappear and informal workers and residents are displaced. The closer the city moves toward its dream of modernity, the further ordinary

people are pushed from it. A city cannot be judged by its infrastructure alone, but by whether the people who build and populate it can belong to it.

The irony is hard to ignore. Lucy's discovery reminded the world that human history is ultimately a story about people, communities, adaptation, and survival — that Ethiopia's contribution to humanity rested not on monuments but on memory embedded in the landscape. In this sense, Lucy has become more than a fossil; she has become a metaphor.

One wonders whether a society risks losing something essential when development becomes detached from the people it is supposed to serve.

Three million years ago, Lucy walked these lands searching for survival.

Today, millions of Ethiopians are walking through cities searching for something just as important: a place within the future they are helping to build.

The author, who retired from the ILO's Regional Office for Arab States in Beirut, writes on travel, social development and the human side of global change

Sailing to the Poles

From a vessel that made history by sailing both to the Arctic and Antarctic seas to one that carried seafaring Vikings, the splendour of human endeavour shines in Scandinavia's museums

Rohan Banerjee

TO VISIT one of Oslo's best museums, you have to leave the quaint city centre and venture deep into suburbia. A ferry or a bus will get you there, though the bus may take an unexpected turn and deposit you on a leafy lane lined with prim cottages. You will have to find your way using Google Maps because there's nobody around to give you directions. Your fear that you have stumbled into an idyllic ghost town is put to bed when you see two topless tennis players — who must be male models on a day off — firing forehands at each other on a clay court.

The sun is scorching but your long walk is made worthwhile when you arrive at your destination, enter a building with a teepee-shaped facade and step onboard the ship that travelled to both poles of our planet.

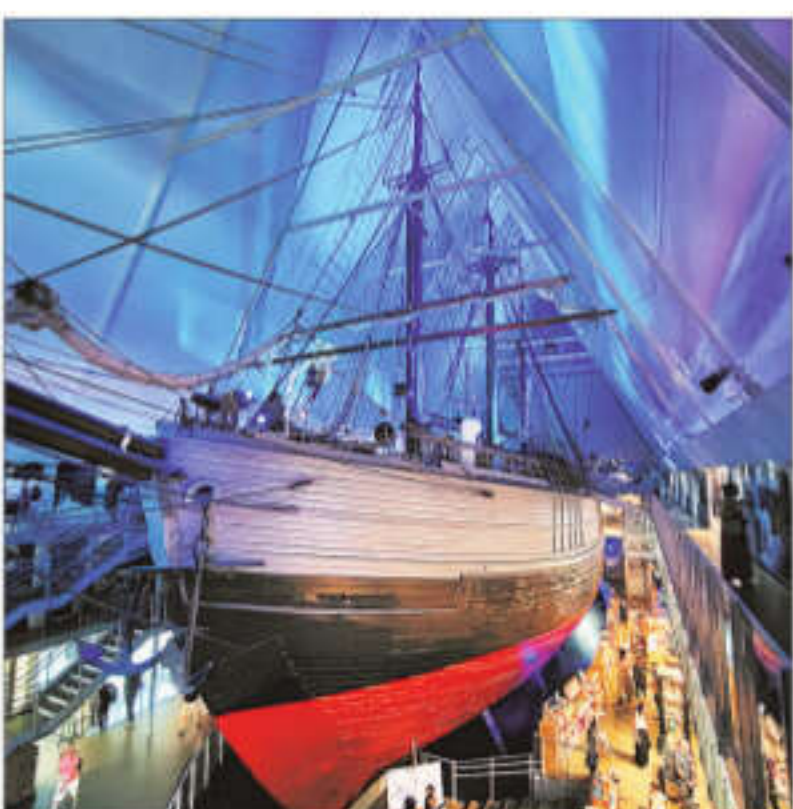
The Fram Museum sits by a waterfront, as if the legendary vessel it houses may want to slip into the sea again someday. The museum resembles a giant shed, with narrow staircases and ramps built along its walls to showcase exhibits and artefacts across multiple levels. Fridtjof Nansen and Roald

Amundsen, two of Norway's most famous sons, are recurring characters in the displays. The former was the first man to cross the Greenland ice cap (and a Nobel Peace Prize winner). And Amundsen was the first to reach the South Pole. Their exploits, and those of other explorers, fill the museum.

In some darkened corners, grainy footage of polar expeditions play on loop. Dioramas of Arctic deserts are populated with Thumbelina-sized figurines of men and dogs. There is even an ersatz cryo chamber, a kind of kitschy amusement park installation, that you can enter to get a brief taste of the polar chill. The star attraction, however, is the ship preserved at the heart of it all: the Fram.

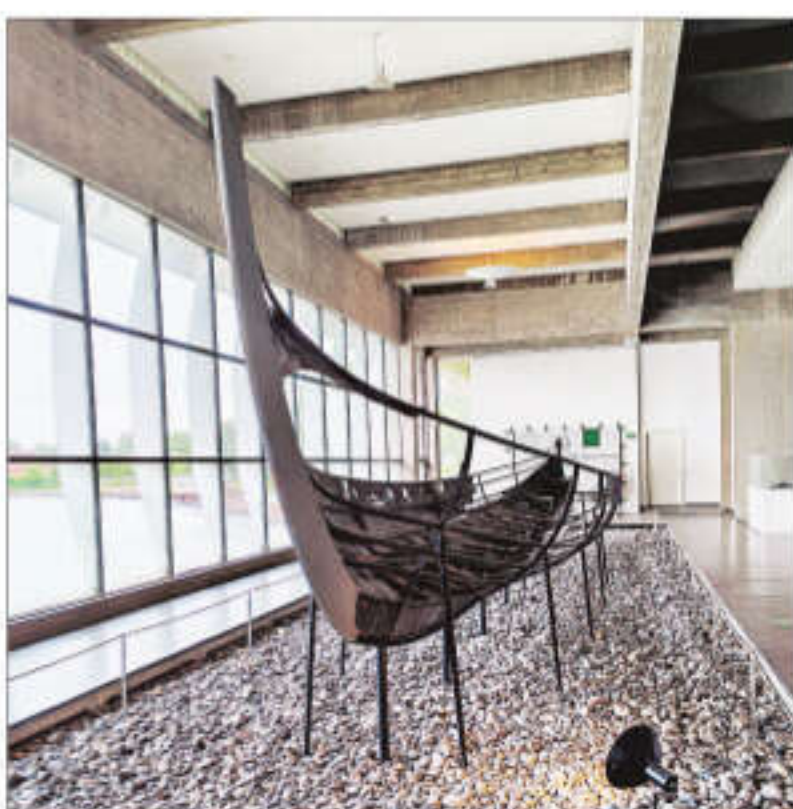
Fram, a three-masted schooner, was built to test one of Nansen's wilder theories: that if a ship could avoid being crushed by the polar icepack, it could stay afloat and be carried along by ocean drift. In 1893, he set sail to test this hypothesis and blessedly — for him, his 11 shipmates, and future visitors to the museum — the Fram survived and spent three years 'floating', trapped in the Arctic icescape.

Later, the ship would make another trip



VIKINGS AND VOYAGES
(Left) The Fram Museum in Oslo, Norway; Vikingseskibsmuseet, the Viking Ship Museum, in Roskilde, Denmark

to the Arctic and then carry Amundsen far into the Antarctic Ocean during his famous South Pole expedition (1910-1912). It feels remarkable, as you stroll on the deck and enter the belly of the boat, to envision a dozen or more crew members spending years in such cramped quarters. The Fram is not a large ship, but when you are in its bowels, space bends and folds over itself. There is the gallery with its assortment of pots and pans, the engine room, the cargo hold, and, while this may be hard to imagine, a captain's cabin that is smaller even than the typical bedroom in a Mumbai flat. Below deck, you must stoop at all times and constantly turn sideways to let other people pass. In such conditions were heroic deeds accomplished



ROHAN BANERJEE

and history made. You feel a sense of awe, certainly, but there is also an empathetic crick in your neck.

The ancient Viking ships, in comparison, may have involved the tedious business of rowing, but at least they offered better sleeping postures.

In the Danish town of Roskilde, a 30-minute train ride from Copenhagen, another ship-themed museum skirts the water's edge. This one, the Vikingseskibsmuseet, contains the re-assembled remains of five millennia-old Viking ships; though I'm sorry to report that unlike at the Fram Museum, visitors are discouraged from clambering onto the exhibits. Still, there is much to admire.

The glass-panelled walls of the room offer clear views of the Roskilde fjord, the water a slate-grey reflection of a leaden sky. Archaeologists believe the five ships were sunk, deliberately, in these very waters to create a subsea barrier against raiding sailors. After being submerged for a thousand years, the wooden ships had disintegrated into truckloads of fragments. Recovering these pieces and cobbling the ships back together was a mammoth enterprise. Thankfully, assembling tiny, sharp-edged scraps into jaw-dropping models comes naturally to the people who invented LEGO. It is thanks to these archaeologists-cum-jigsaw-enthusiasts that visitors can see the fascinating details of a resurrected Viking ship: its prow, its oar holes, its eel-like sleekness.

These ships, that are canoes on steroids, could travel to distant shores, as far afield as Ireland. This, just to clarify, is not a theoretical assumption. In 2007, a sixty-member crew sailed a reconstructed Viking vessel (modelled on the largest ship unearthed in Roskilde) from Denmark to Dublin.

The voyage was no *Survivor*-style adventure but a serious scientific experiment — much like how my daily consumption of Danish pastries in Copenhagen was driven by dispassionate research on bakeries. They undertook the voyage to get an actual taste of how the Vikings must have battled bitter winds and high-sea storms with mediaeval equipment. It was horrible, I suppose their field notes recorded, but we did get to stretch our legs when asleep.

Rohan Banerjee is a writer and lawyer based in Mumbai